

SUNDAY 9 AUGUST 2026

Nineteenth Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:
Aghyaran ♦ Ardstraw West & Castlederg ♦ Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 10 August		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 11 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 12 August			Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 13 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Friday 14 August	Mass, 7.30pm: Vigil Mass for Feast of the Assumption	Mass, Castlederg: 6.15pm: Vigil Mass for Feast of the Assumption	Mass, 7.30pm: Vigil Mass for Feast of the Assumption
Saturday 15 August	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 16 August	Mass, 11.00am: <i>First Anniversary, Mary Penrose</i>	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Drumnabey, 12.30pm <i>Mass in Castlederg on 2nd, 4th and 5th Sunday</i>	Mass, 11.00am

Saturday 15 August is the Feast of the Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary - Vigil Masses on Friday evening in Aghyaran, Castlederg and Drumquin as above. Please note there is no 10.00am Mass in Castlederg this Friday.

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £947 & €36. **Church Restoration Fund:** £1,064 & €46.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,376 & €52, made up of:

Castlederg £1,398 & €26, **Drumnabey** £494 & €21, **Dregish** £484 & €5. **DRUMQUIN:** £732.

Sincere thanks for £200 towards the church renovations in Castlederg.

PASTORAL VISITATION OF THE HOUSEBOUND will take place this week as follows:

Wednesday 12 August - Young Crescent and Drumnabey, commencing at 11.00am - Fr Thomas.

AGHYARAN - Knock Novena -14 - 22 August) - leaflets available at the back of the church.

EMBRACE THE GRACE' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026, 9.30am – 6.00pm - Legion of Mary: a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on eventbrite website - look up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed to deusetpatria@gmail.com.

Our prayers are asked for the happy repose of the souls of those recently enrolled in the Derry Diocesan Society:

Aghyaran: Peter Moss, Scraghey Road; Madge McNamee, Meelmore Drive, Omagh.

Drumquin: Paddy Gallagher, Tattysalagh Road; Finola Scott, Meelmore Drive, Omagh.

Ardstraw West and Castlederg: Charlie Logue, Castlefin Park; Christine Clarke, 120 Lenagh Road, Omagh

Ardmore Parish Newsletter

Eighteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Sunday 2nd August 2026

Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 14:13–21 – The Feeding of the Five Thousand

The miracle of the loaves and fishes begins with **compassion**. Before Jesus fed the crowd, He first recognised their suffering and their need. His heart was moved by those who were tired, hungry, and searching for hope.

In our own busy lives, God gently calls us to notice those around us who may be lonely, discouraged, forgotten, or struggling. A simple word of encouragement, a listening ear, or a small act of kindness may become someone else's miracle.

The disciples looked only at what they **didn't have**. Faced with thousands of hungry people, they saw only five loaves and two fish. Jesus, however, asked them to offer what they already possessed.

God rarely asks us for what we do not have. Instead, He asks us to place before Him our time, our talents, our compassion, and our willingness to serve. However small these gifts may seem, He is able to multiply them beyond anything we could imagine.

Before distributing the food, Jesus lifted everything to His Father in prayer. This reminds us that surrender is not a sign of weakness or defeat. Rather, it is an act of trust. We all carry burdens that feel too heavy or situations that seem impossible, yet when we place them into God's hands, what appears insufficient can become more than enough.

Finally, the twelve baskets of leftovers remind us of God's overwhelming generosity. His blessings are never intended to stop with us but to flow through us. When we forgive generously, encourage freely, and share what we have with others, God's grace continues to multiply in countless lives.

Prayer

Lord, fill our hearts with compassion. Use the little we have to accomplish great things for Your Kingdom. Teach us to trust You completely, to surrender our limitations into Your hands, and to share Your blessings generously with all whom we meet. Amen.

Readings for Next Sunday

Sunday 9th August 2026

First Reading: 1 Kings 19:9a, 11–13a

Psalm: Psalm 85:9–14

Second Reading: Romans 9:1–5

Gospel: Matthew 14:22–33

Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday

- St John Vianney, Priest

Wednesday

- The Dedication of the Basilica of St Mary Major (Rome)

Thursday

- The Transfiguration of the Lord

Friday

- St Cajetan, Priest
- St Sixtus II, Pope, and Companions, Martyrs

Saturday

- St Dominic, Priest
-

Pope's Prayer Intention for August

For Evangelisation in the City

Let us pray that in large cities, often marked by anonymity and loneliness, we may discover new ways of proclaiming the Gospel, finding creative paths to build genuine Christian communities.

Prayer for Vocations

We pray for men whom God is calling to the priesthood.

Like Jesus in today's Gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, the hungry, the vulnerable or those most in need, but always reflect the compassionate love of Christ as they nourish His people through the Word of God and the Eucharist.

Parish & Diocesan Notices

Rosary on the Coast

Today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm

 Lisfannon Beach

Praying for **peace, Ireland and our unborn children.**

Everyone is warmly welcome.

Give Blood – Save Lives

The **Northern Ireland Blood Transfusion Service** will hold a blood donor session at:

Lisneal College

70 Crescent Link

Derry BT47 5FQ

Monday 4th August

- 12.30 pm – 4.00 pm
- 5.00 pm – 7.30 pm

 Freephone: **0808 553 4653** to book.

Franciscan Friary, Rossnowlagh

Monthly Healing Service

Today (Sunday)

- Rosary – **2.45 pm**
 - Mass & Healing Service – **3.00 pm**
 - Confessions – **2.00 pm – 5.00 pm**
-

ACCORD Marriage Preparation

Marriage preparation courses are available throughout the year.

Please visit www.accordni.com for dates and booking information.

Monthly Mass for Sr Clare Crockett

Sunday 9th August

7.00 pm

Carmelite Retreat Centre
Termonbacca, Derry

Day of Healing & Prayer

House of Prayer, Clonfert

Saturday 15th August

Led by **Eddie Stone**

A bus will travel from **Letterkenny**, collecting pilgrims in **Ballybofey** and **Donegal Town**.
A priest will accompany the pilgrimage.

 **Contact: 086 393 6547**

Walk in Our Patron Saint's Footsteps

St Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk

Saturday 8th August

9.00 am – 3.00 pm

Downpatrick

Guides:

- Martina Purdy
- Elaine Kelly

Cost: £55

 **028 4461 9000**

Visit www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Youth & Young Adults

Embrace the Grace

Legion of Mary Young Adult Catholic Conference

(Ages 18–40)

Saturday 29th August

9.30 am – 6.00 pm

De Montfort House
Morning Star Avenue
Dublin D07 VA03

Tickets available through Eventbrite (search **Embrace the Grace**).

Youth 2000 Summer Festival

13th–16th August

Newbridge College, Kildare

Young people aged **16–35** are invited to enjoy:

- Inspiring talks
- Workshops
- Daily Mass
- Music and Prayer
- Fellowship
- Free buses
- All meals included

Visit **youth2000.ie** or follow **@Youth2000Ireland**.

Anam Óg Summer Scheme

3rd–7th August

12.00 pm – 4.00 pm daily

Termonbacca, Derry

For children aged **8–14**

Faith, friendship, games, arts & crafts, adventure and prayer.

Email:

termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Community & Charity

Mary's Meals

Annual Step by Step Walk

Sunday 9th August

12.00 noon

Starting from:

Sainsbury's Car Park

Strand Road, Derry

Walking the Foyle Bridge and Peace Bridge.

Everyone is welcome—even if only for part of the walk.

Mary's Meals currently provides a daily school meal to **over 3 million children across 16 countries.**

Please keep all participants in your prayers.

Family Carers Ireland

Remote one-to-one support clinics are available **every Tuesday throughout August.**

Carers can speak privately from the comfort of their own homes.

 086 836 3842

 Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Pro-Life Events

Donegal Pro Life Church Gate Collection

Saturday 15th & Sunday 16th August

Countywide Collection

Volunteers are greatly appreciated.

 Margaret:
00353 89 246 9599

Míle buíochas.

Monthly Pro-Life Witness

Friday 7th August
1.00 pm – 2.00 pm

Roundabout at Letterkenny University Hospital.

Everyone welcome.

Pilgrimages

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw

Support Station Island and help preserve this special place of pilgrimage for future generations.

Tickets

- Single: **€10**
- Book of 6: **€50**

Those returning a full book will also be entered into the **Early Bird Draw on 28th August 2026.**

Main Draw

23rd October 2026

Prizes

 €10,000

 €5,000

 €2,000

4th – €1,500

5th – €1,000

6th – €500

Lough Derg Day Retreats

As the Three-Day Pilgrimage season concludes (final day to begin is **13th August**), Day Retreats resume on:

- August: **18, 22, 23, 29 & 31**
- September: **5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19 & 20**

Take time away from the busyness of everyday life for guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal.

Advance booking is essential.

Employment Opportunity

Administrative & Financial Officer

Clonmany Parish

The **Derry Diocesan Trust** invites applications for the position of:

Administrative & Financial Officer

Hours: 9 per week

Application packs are available from:

Bishop's House
St Eugene's Cathedral
Derry BT48 9AP

 028 7126 2302

 recruitment@derrydiocese.org

Closing Date: Tuesday **11th August 2026**

Publications

Reflections Through Poetry

A beautiful collection by **Fr John P. Forbes**

Available from the **Pastoral Office**

Price: £10

All proceeds support **Children in Crossfire** and the **Cause for the Canonisation of Sr Clare Crockett**.

Sharing the Good News

Read the latest weekly Catholic e-zine featuring news, reflections and resources from across Ireland.

Visit **theway.ie/ezine-2/**.

Closing Prayer

May the Lord bless us with compassionate hearts, generous spirits, and unwavering trust in His providence. May we recognise Christ in those around us, offer Him the little we possess, and witness His abundant blessings multiplying in our families, our parish, and our community.

May Almighty God bless you, the Father, ✠ the Son, and the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Sunday, 5th July 2026 - Ardstraw East Parish Newsletter -

Parish of Ardstraw East

14th Sunday in Ordinary Time

5th July 2026

CONTACTS AND CORRESPONDENCE

Rev. Roland Colhoun, CC, 41 Moyle Road, Newtownstewart, BT78 4AP

Tel: 028-8166 1445, Email: ardstraweast@derrydiocese.org, FB: @ardstraweast

Rev. Brian Donnelly, PP, 028-8164 8283 Rev. James Devine, CC, 028-8230 2012

LITURGIES FOR THE WEEK

Sunday – Mass 11:30am, Rosary 11:10am (Oratory)

Monday – Mass 10am, Rosary 9:45am (Oratory)

Thursday – Holy Hour 6:30pm, Confessions, Rosary, Mass 7.30pm (Oratory)

REQUIESCANT IN PACE – ANNIVERSARIES

John McNamee, Jean Hobbs, Elizabeth McColgan, John-Joe Devine, Maureen Mayse Eileen Orr,

Andrew Bolton, James Bolton, Eileen Duffy, Gerald Devine

SUNDAY COLLECTION – £862. *Glenock Restoration*: £650. Thank you!

FORTY HOURS – Thanks to all who took part in the Adoration, Friday to Sunday. This is our 7th year of 40 full hours. 280 hours offered to God. Graces are flowing!

YOUTH 2000 SUMMER FESTIVAL – 13th–16th August, for youths 16–35. Newbridge College, Co. Kildare. Donation-only, free buses available across the country, all meals included. Inspiring talks and workshops, Mass, music, prayer, and plenty of opportunities to chill out and meet other young Catholics. Whether you are new to the Faith or looking to be refreshed, you are welcome. To register or find out more, visit youth2000.ie or follow @Youth2000Ireland.

LOUGH DERG – DIOCESE OF DERRY PILGRIMAGE – Friday 24th to Sunday 26th July. Three days of prayer, peace, reflection and renewal. Cost: £95 including bus transport. Booking form and full details are

available at derrydiocese.org/lough-derg

ADDICTION – MATT TALBOT PRAYER SOCIETY, MONTHLY MASS, in St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, tomorrow, Monday 6th July, 7.30pm. The Mass is offered for all those dealing with addiction and their families. Everyone is welcome to attend. Free Spiritual Protection Packs for the protection of families and homes from drugs.

PREPARATION FOR HEAVEN – 'No one will be fit to receive the life to come unless he has prepared himself in this life to receive it.' (Saint Augustine of Hippo).

LAST BULLETIN OF THE SEASON – Please note that there will be no printed bulletin for July and August. Kindly continue to send anniversary notices to the parish office, to be read out at Mass. Keep up to date on our Facebook page. Thank you for your faith, hope and love and immense support throughout the year. Blessings to you!

JOKE – Where do birds go on holidays? Somewhere cheep!

JOKE – What do you call a greedy crab? Shellfish!



BALLINASCREEN & DESERTMARTIN PARISHES

9_AUGUST_2026

No. 41 ~ NINETEENTH SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

Click or Tap on image before zooming in for greater clarity!

BALLINASCREEN & DESERTMARTIN PARISHES ~ Nineteenth Sunday In Ordinary Time ~ 9th AUGUST 2026

PARISH CONTACT DETAILS

Fr. Peter Madden PP VF
31 Sixtowns Road / Telephone: 02879628376
Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com
Fr. Michael McCaul CC
50 Tobermore Road, Desertmartin
Telephone: 02879632196
Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

PARISH OFFICES

Ballinascreen: 9 High Street
Phone: 02879628248
Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com
Opening Hours: Monday, Tuesday and Thursday 8.45am-3.30pm
Wednesday 8.45am-3pm.
Desertmartin: St Patrick's Keneage
Phone: 02879397047
Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com
Opening Hours: Wednesday and Thursday 10.30am - 3pm

FEASTS OF THE WEEK

Mon 10th Aug: St Lawrence
Tues 11th Aug: St Clare
Wed 12th Aug: St Agatha, St Muredach
Thurs 13th Aug: St Fiacre, St Pontian
Fri 14th Aug: St Maximilian Kolbe
Sat 15th Aug: The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary

MASSSES FOR THIS WEEK

Monday ~ 10th August
10.00am - Holy Rosary.
Tuesday ~ 11th August
10.00am - St Mary's, Coolcalm
Wednesday ~ 12th August
10.00am - Holy Rosary Church
Thursday ~ 13th August
10.00am - St Mary's, Coolcalm
Friday ~ 14th August
10am - St Mary's, Coolcalm
7.30pm - Holy Rosary.

SATURDAY 16th August ~ Vigil Masses

6.00pm - Holy Rosary Church
7.30pm - St Patrick's, Keneage
SUNDAY 16th August ~ Masses
9.00am - St Mary's, Coolcalm
10.00am - St Mary's, Coolcalm
11.00am - St Patrick's, Sixtowns
12.00pm - St Eugene's, Moneyneena

CONFESSIONS

Ballinascreen:
Holy Rosary 5.30pm before Vigil Mass.
Desertmartin:
Keneage, Saturday 6.30pm until 7.10pm.

SVP HELPLINE: 07710838050

SFERIN FOODBANK: 07543420639

GAMBLING HELPLINE:
Help is available by phoning 02871351329.

LIFELINE

Tel: 0800 808 8000 / Textphone 18001 0808
808 8000. www.lifelinehelpline.info
SAFE GUARDING: The Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) is: Marie O'Kane. Tel: 07596500791 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

DEATHS

We extend our prayerful sympathy to the family and relatives of:
Hugh (Sonny) McIlhennan RIP, New York and Bracklissla

MONTHS MIND MASS

The Months Mind Mass for **Bernadette Regan RIP**, St Patrick's Street, will be held on Friday 28th August at 7.30pm in the Holy Rosary Church.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS

The First Anniversary Mass for **Fr Seamus O'Neill RIP**, will be held on Friday 14th August at 7.30pm in the Holy Rosary Church.
The First Anniversary Mass for **Rory McCallion RIP**, Moykeeran, will be held on Friday 14th August at 7.30pm in the Holy Rosary Church.

ANNIVERSARIES

Ballinascreen:

First Anniversary: Paddy Gray, Corrick Road.

Larry Mulligan, Drondallagan, Trevor Campbell, Kilrea.
John Campbell, Jim O'Hagan, Woodland Hgts. Gerry Clerk, Hancran Rd. Hugh McWilliams, Fivemile Straight, Tom Hegarty, Tonagh Rd.
Paddy Joe O'Neill, Gortin, Patrick & Bridget Hegarty.

Desertmartin:

First Anniversary:
John O'Connor, Elizabeth O'Hagan, Henry Kelly, Joseph Donnelly,
Terry McEnock, Liam McGugan, Anthony Donnelly

BAPTISMS

We welcome into God's family through the Sacrament of Baptism:
Marab Eileen McIvor Gortahark Road.
Camilia Murray, Callion Rd.
Aoibheann Conery, Tirgan Rd.

PARISH COLLECTIONS

	Ballinascreen	Desertmartin
Prison Collection	£1164.30	£1052.90
Renovation Collection	£2050.10	£495.50

Thank you for your generous support which is greatly appreciated.
Total shown include July Ballinascreen Sunday Orders from Parishioners. If would like to avail of this option please contact the Parish Office.

SUMMER DRAW 2026

Winners will be announced at end of the 6pm Vigil Mass in the Holy Rosary Church. All proceeds will go to our church renovation fund for the upkeep of all our churches in the parish.

You may still purchase a ticket to be entered in the draw for the four remaining weeks.

Week 2 (15th Aug): 1st Prize-£1000, 2nd Prize-£200, 3rd Prize-£100.
Week 3 (22nd Aug): 1st Prize-£1000, 2nd Prize-£200, 3rd Prize-£100.

Week 4 (29th Aug): 1st Prize-£1000, 2nd Prize-£200, 3rd Prize-£100.
Week 5 (5th Sept): 1st Prize-£2000, 2nd Prize-£500, 3rd Prize-£100.

CHARITY FAMILY FUN DAY

In Honor of Baby Bella-Rose Moran. Sunday 9th August in Ballinascreen GAA Club from 12noon-5pm. Tractors, Lemoos and Vintage Cars welcome to pick up for £10 entry, all proceeds are for the Little Heroes Charity.

WORKSPACE RECREATION CENTRE JOB VACANCY

We are looking for Recreation Centre Assistants for evenings and weekends. All applicants must be over 18. Send your CV to info@theworkspacegroup.org or contact Workspace on 028 7962 8113 for more information. Closing date is Friday 14th August 2026.

BRADLEY'S CORNER VINTAGE TRACTOR RUN

On Sunday 16th August, Gathering from 12pm with 1.45pm departure. All proceeds to Slieve Gallion Pre-School & FACTS Autism Support Group. Small vintage tractors only!

KNOCKNAGIN HALL COMMITTEE AGM

The Committee warmly invites all members of the local community to attend the Annual General Meeting, Monday 17th August at 7.30pm Knocknagin Hall. The Hall has been at the heart of the local community since the early 1950s, and current committee members have served since 2011. It is important that a new generation of volunteers comes forward

with a wide range of skills, experience and fresh ideas to help secure the future of the hall. Whatever your experience, whether you can give a little time or a lot your involvement would be greatly valued. With your support, it can continue to be a welcoming, and sustainable community hub and continue to thrive for future generations for many years to come. We look forward to welcoming you to the AGM on Monday 17th August at 7.30 pm in Knocknagin Hall. Your attendance and support would be greatly appreciated.

Social Tea Dance - Friday 14th August, at 9pm music by Chris Dillit, Admission £7, which includes refreshments.

Sarsfield's Accordion Band. Unfortunately, due to a lack of members available to attend, the Band will not be taking part in the Feast of the Assumption Celebration in Keady, on Sunday, 16th August. Band practice has now stopped for the summer and will recommence on Thursday, 10th September at 7.30pm. We look forward to welcoming all members back and encourage anyone interested in joining the band to come along. Congratulations to Vicky McKinley, Magherafelt, Ticket No. 151, winner of the August Monthly Draw.

MICHAEL ENGLISH & BAND LIVE CONCERT

Join us for a rare and intimate evening with Michael English, one of Ireland's most popular entertainers. This exclusive acoustic performance takes place in a beautiful church setting, blending majestic architecture with uplifting music filled with hope, faith, and community spirit. All proceeds from this special fundraising concert will go toward supporting the Parish of Desertmartin. The concert takes place on Friday 2nd October, at 8pm in St. Patrick's Church, Keneage. Tickets are £10 and available to buy from Helen's Shop, Moneyneena Post Office, both Parish Offices, or online with Eventbrite.

YOUTH 2000 SUMMER FESTIVAL

11th-16th August Calling all young people aged 16-35! Join us at the Youth 2000 Summer Festival in Newbridge College, Co. Kildare. This is a donation-only event, with free buses available across the country and all meals included. Expect inspiring talks and workshops, Mass, music, prayer, and plenty of opportunities to chill out and meet other young Catholics. Whether you are new to the faith or looking to be refreshed, all are welcome. To register or find out more, visit youth2000.ie or follow @Youth2000Ireland.

JOB OPPORTUNITY, DERRY DIOCESEAN TRUST

Administrative & Financial Officer (18hours per week), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hour + £13.50 per hour. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org by 12noon Monday 24 August 2026.

LEGION OF MARY

'Embrace the Grace' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026 - 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. This event takes place on Saturday 29 August from 9.30am to 6pm with a social afterwards. Tickets cost £20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed towards douglasparish@gmail.com.

MISSING ITEM FROM STRAW GRAVEYARD

A wooden planter containing heather has been removed from a grave in Straw graveyard. This planter had been in place for years and holds deep sentimental value. Its sudden removal has caused a great deal of upset to the family. If this item was taken by mistake, or if you know where it is, please return it directly to the grave.

KILCORNAGHAN CENTRE

Vintage Rally, Craft Fair & Family Fun Day, Sat 26th September, 11am-3pm More info, see Kilcormaghan Facebook / ring 02879627826

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND

Hosted by Marriage Encounter Ireland will take place at the Focallere Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare, from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October. This Weekend is not a retreat in the traditional sense but is a positive, joy-filled experience, guided by presenting couples and a priest, in an atmosphere of warmth, prayer, and deep Christian faith. Couples are invited to register online at www.marriageencounter.ie

ABIDE IN HIS LOVE WOMEN'S CONFERENCE

The Great Northern Hotel, Bandon, 20-22 November 2026. Join women from across Ireland for a faith-filled weekend with inspiring speakers including Sarah Swafford, Danielle Noonan, Fr Mark Wharton, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Oisín Martin, the Dominican Sisters of Nashville, Bishop Fintan Gavin, and more. A conference not to be missed! Register now: <https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com/>

LOST PIONEER PIN

A Gold Pioneer pin was lost at St Eugene's Church, Moneyneena, on Friday 31st July. If found, please return it or contact the Parish Office at 028 7962 8248. Thank you.

FOUND ITEM: Ladies Fleece

A Ladies Zip up Fleece has been found in Straw Graveyard. If this Fleece belongs to you, please contact the Parish Office.

PARISH BAPTISMS 2026

All bookings to be made via Parish Office on 02879628248 or ballinascreenparish@gmail.com on the following dates:

Ballinascreen Parish	Desertmartin Parish
16 th August, Straw	30 th August, Holy Rosary
23 rd August, Moneyneena	13 th Sept, Sixtowns
Sat 5 th Sept, Sixtowns	4 th Oct, Holy Rosary
1 st Nov, Straw	Sat 17 th Oct, Sixtowns

Desertmartin Parish:

To book a baptism, contact Fr McCaul on 02879632196 or Desertmartin Parish Office on 02879397047. Baptisms can be held in either church and at 1.30 pm on the following dates:

September 6 th & 27 th 2026	November 8 th & 22 nd 2026
October 4 th & 18 th 2026	January 10 th & 24 th 2027
December 6 th & 20 th 2026	February 7 th & 21 st 2027
February 7 th & 21 st 2027	March 7 th & 14 th 2027
April 4 th & 18 th 2027	

DERRY DIOCESEAN SOCIETY

If you wish to enrol someone in the society, please contact the parish office. The fee for a living or deceased member is £20. The Vigil and Sunday Masses on 8th 9th 15th & 16th August in the Parish will be offered for the deceased members of the Derry Diocesan Society.

NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN

Notices should be received by **1pm on Wednesday**, preferably emailed to ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

PARISH ANNIVERSARY MASS & MONTH'S MIND MASSES

If you wish to have a deceased loved one prayed for at any Anniversary Friday Mass, please email their name to the Parish Office by **1pm on Wednesday** of the relevant week. Notices for First Anniversary and Month's Mind Masses should be received before **1.00 pm on Wednesday** of the previous week so that, they may be printed in the Bulletin the weekend before the Anniversary Mass.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS

For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"

PARISH OF BANAGHER

WEEKEND MASS SCHEDULE

St Joseph's Church, Church, Fincairn: Vigil 7.00pm; Every other Sunday 9.15am

St Mary's Church, Altinure: 10.30am.

St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: Every other Sunday 12.00noon

Sunday Morning	Churches
3rd September	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
10th September	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
17th September	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
24th September	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
1st October	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
8th October	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
15th October	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
22nd October	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
29th October	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
5th November	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
12th November	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
19th November	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
26th November	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
3rd December	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
10th December	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
17th December	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
24th December	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
31st December	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
7th January	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
14th January	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
21st January	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
28th January	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
4th February	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
11th February	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
18th February	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
25th February	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
3rd March	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
10th March	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
17th March	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon

24th March	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
31st March	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
7th April	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
14th April	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
21st April	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
28th April	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
5th May	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
12th May	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
19th May	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
26th May	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
2nd June	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
9th June	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
16th June	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
23rd June	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
30th June	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
7th July	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
14th July	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
21st July	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
28th July	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
4th August	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
11th August	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am
18th August	St Peter & St Paul's Church, Foreglen: 12 noon
25th August	St Joseph's Church, Fincairn: 9:15am

Sunday Mass times in Neighbouring Parishes:

St Patrick's Church, Dungiven: Vigil 6.00pm; Sunday 9.00am & 11.30am

St Matthew's Church, Drumsurn: Sunday 10.15am

Immaculate Conception, Gortnahey: Vigil 4.30pm

St Patrick's Church, Claudy: Vigil 6.30pm; Sunday 11.30am

St Mary's Bellaghy/St Joseph's Ballyscullion.
9 August 2026
Nineteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time.



Mass Times :

St Mary's, Bellaghy

Mon 10, No Mass Wed 12, 9.30am

Sat 15 is The Feast of the Assumption, Mass at 10am

Adoration, Friday, 10am—8pm (Rosary, 7.30pm)

Sat, 5.30pm (Streamed from Greenlough)

Sun, 11am (Streamed to Greenlough)

St. Oliver Plunkett, Clady:

Tues 11, 9.30am

Fri 14, 6.45pm (Vigil for Holyday)

Adoration, Thursday, 9am—5pm.

Sat, Vigil, 5.30pm (Streamed to Bellaghy)

Sun, 11am (Streamed from Bellaghy)

St. Joseph's, Ballyscullion:

Fri 14, 8pm (Vigil for Holyday)

Sun, 9.45am.

*The next printed bulletin will be on the weekend of
22/23 August.*

*Please have all notices and anniversaries in to the
Parish Office by Wednesday 19 August at 11am.*

**The Offertory
Collection**

last Sunday
amounted to
£2,199.00 **Thank You!**



For our seminarians and the men
considering priesthood that, in mo-
ments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say
what He says to the disciples in
today's gospel,

"Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"



***Bishop McKeown will be the
main celebrant of the 5:30pm
Mass in Clady on 15 August,
and will bless the new Grotto
afterwards.***

Deaths: We offer our sympathy to the family of **Tom Birt (Ballynease/Chicago)** who died recently.

ANNIVERSARIES

Sat/Sun 8/9: Mary McGlade (Anniversary Mass at 11am), James McGlade, Mary Convery, Thomas McElwee, Celine Farrar, Damian Marron, Margaret Diamond, Gerard McClafferty, Joe McErlean, Harry Downey, Alice Heaney.

Sat/Sun 15/16: Fr. Jim Smith, Tony Convery, Eva Agnew, Catherine Scullion.

May they rest in peace.

BAPTISM DATES: JULY—DECEMBER

BELLAGHY

Aug 8, 1pm
Sep 26, 1pm
Oct 10, 1pm
Nov 7, 1pm
Dec 5, 1pm

GREENLOUGH

Aug 22 4.15pm
Sep 13, 12.30pm
Oct 24, 4.15pm
Nov 21, 4.15pm
Dec 19, 4.15pm

Buncrana Parish Newsletter

ST. MARY'S HALL & CINEMA

The collection for Desertegney Graveyard Sunday totalled €7,067. The combined total of the two Graveyard Sunday Collections totalled €20,547. <i>Sincere thanks.</i>	Priest on Call 074 9361253 Email: buncranaparish@gmail.com Website: www.buncranaparish.com Nineteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time 9th August 2026	Fr Bradley 9363455 Fr Walsh 9361393 Fr Baker 9360151 Parish Office 9361253 Parish Catechist 086 785 3726	PARISH DRAW Friday 31 July: Week 7 1st Prize: €500 Pat Doherty, c/o Promoter <i>Promoter: Noeleen Tynan</i> 2nd Prize: €300 Stuart Donaghey, Clonblosk <i>Promoter: Jacinta Coyle</i> 3rd Prize: €150 Gloria McGinley, Millbrae <i>Promoter: Noeleen Tynan</i>	BUNCRANA CINEMA See all show times www.thecinemabuncrana.com SPIDER-MAN: BRAND NEW DAY 12A 145mins Saturday 8th August - 5pm & 8.15pm Sunday 9th - 3pm & 8.15pm Monday 10th - Thursday 13th 8.15pm	BINGO St Mary’s Hall Fridays at 8pm Single book €11 Double €17 Snowball: €4900
Community Corner					
ST MARY’S ORATORY Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/buncrana Monday 10 Aug - Mass at 10am John-Joe and Nancy Orohoe Tuesday 11 Aug - Mass at 10am Margaret Cutliffe (MM), plus Danny McLaughlin Wednesday 12 Aug - Mass at 10am Special Intention Thursday 13 Aug - Mass at 10am Pete Nash, plus May and Willie Diver Saturday 15 Aug - Mass at 10am Fr Jackie Fitzgerald (36th A) Saturday 15 Aug - Mass at 4:30pm Rosamund McHugh (MM) Sunday 16 Aug - Mass at 8:30am Sunday 16 Aug - Mass at 12:30pm Benny and Deirdre Barber		GARDEN FETE 2026 The Annual Garden Fete will take place on Sunday 23 August from 3pm-6pm in the grounds of Scoil Mhuire. This event can only take place because of the generosity of a team of volunteers. Please leave your details in the Parish Office if you can help out on or before the day. DRAW CARDS Draw cards for hampers and other great prizes are available from the Parish Office and promoters are required. Please contact the office to get your card or to buy a line. CALLING ALL CRAFTERS Book your table for the Garden Fete to display and sell your crafts, €20 per table. Limited tables available. For more details contact the Parish Office 074-9361253		ADORATION CHAPEL Please consider spending an hour in the Adoration Chapel Sunday 2pm - 10pm Monday - Wednesday 6am - 10pm Friday 6am - 10pm	
ST. MARY’S, COCKHILL Masses streamed on churchservices.tv/cockhill Tuesday 11 August - Mass at 7pm Kathleen Doherty (1st A) Friday 14 Aug - Mass at 7pm Sunday 16 Aug - Mass at 11am		GUIDED HOLY HOUR The Holy Hour in honour of the Holy Face of Jesus continues this Sunday at 6pm in St Mary’s Oratory. All Welcome.		ROSARY The Rosary is said in the Oratory at 9.30am before Mass Monday to Thursday.	
STAR OF THE SEA, DESERTEGNEY Masses streamed on www.youtube.com/@BuncranaParish Saturday 15 Aug - Mass at 11am Sunday 16 Aug - Mass at 9:45am		33 DAY CONSECRATION TO THE EUCHARIST Consecrate yourself to the Eucharist on the Feast of Our Lady of Knock! Human Life International Ireland will be leading a 33 Day Consecration to the Eucharist online with videos uploaded each day. Starting 19th July - 20th August, on the HLI Ireland YouTube Channel. You can participate by watching the videos, or get the book "How to Be His" by Fr Jesse Maingot OP.		DONEGAL DOWN SYNDROME ASSOCIATION Annual church-gate collection will take place on the weekend of 29 /30 Aug. Anyone interested in helping on the day can contact the Donegal Down Syndrome Association office by email at info@donegal.downsyndrome.ie or call 0857870075. Your financial support for this important fundraising event would be greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down Syndrome and their families across Donegal.	
FEAST OF THE ASSUMPTION Mass Times Friday 14 August 7pm in St Mary’s, Cockhill Saturday 15 August 10am in St Mary’s Oratory 11am in Star of the Sea, Desertegney		JOB OPPORTUNITIES Derry Diocesan Trust (1) Clonmany Parish: Administrative & Financial Officer. Hours of work: 9 hours per week. This is a job-share role. Place of work: Parish House, Clonmany. Completed applications to be returned no later than 12noon Tues 11 August 2026. (2) Waterside Parish: Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours per week), Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr. Completed applications to be returned no later than 12noon Mon 24 August 2026 For application packs for either position please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop’s House, St Eugene’s Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org <i>Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.</i>		THE NATIONAL NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF KNOCK takes place at Knock Shrine from Thurs 13 to Fri 21 August 2026. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3pm and 8pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days. This year’s theme is “Sheltered in God’s Love.” See the full programme at: https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/	
DEATHS Your prayers are asked for Liam Grant Aodhan McCallum Hugh Dick who died recently and for their families & friends saddened by their loss.		DONEGAL PRO LIFE Annual Church Gate Collection is on Sat.15th /Sun 16th Aug countywide. If you can help in taking up a collection it would be appreciated. Contact Margaret on 0892469599.		EMBRACE THE GRACE YOUNG ADULT CATHOLIC CONFERENCE 29 Aug 2026 - Legion of Mary: 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. This event is on Sat 30 August from 9.30am to 6pm with a social after. Tickets €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries email deusetpatria@gmail.com. YOUTH 2000 SUMMER FESTIVAL 13th–16th Aug Calling all young people aged 16 –35! Join us at the Youth 2000 Summer Festival in Newbridge College, Co. Kildare. This is a donation-only event, with free buses available across the country and all meals included. Expect inspiring talks and workshops, Mass, music, prayer, and plenty of opportunities to chill out and meet other young Catholics. Whether you are new to the faith or looking to be refreshed, all are welcome. To register or find out more, visit youth2000.ie or follow @Youth2000Ireland. MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND: Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Fri 2 to Sun 4 Oct 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie COFFEE MORNING being held in O’Flaherty’s Bar on Fri 14th Aug 11am - 2.30pm. Proceeds in aid of the ICU & Rehab units at Letterkenny Hospital SPORTS DAY at Cockhill Celtic Youth & Football Club. Sunday 16th August 3pm - 6pm. Adults €5 entry fee - U16s free COFFEE MORNING The final of the Team To Improve Fundraiser Coffee Mornings in St Mary’s Hall this Sunday 9 August from 11am! You can book a table on 0876482182. We would be honoured if you could stop by for some tae or coffee and fresh homemade pancakes with toppings aplenty, or just to show your support. Thank you.	
PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"		A THOUGHT... My therapist told me the way to achieve true inner peace is to finish what I start. So far I’ve finished two bags of M&Ms and a chocolate cake. I feel better already.		ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS Amazing Grace Group, Buncrana have 5 meetings per week as follows: Sun 8pm, Tues 8pm, Thurs 11.30am, Fri 8pm & Sat 11.30am. If you think you may have a problem with alcohol, come along. Meeting in St Teresa’s Room. AL-ANON GROUP (for anyone whose life is or has been affected by someone else’s drinking) meet in St Teresa’s Room on Thurs at 6:45pm. GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS weekly meeting in St Teresa’s Room each Sun 5pm-6.30pm for anyone struggling with a gambling addiction. GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS HELPLINE Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 048 7135 1329. THE PLAZA Social Dances: Sat 8 August Peter McCloskey Country Way; Sat 15 August Fanadian; Sat 22 August Michael Cleary and Jackie Bannon; Sat 29 August Trevor Loughery. Doors 9pm, Dancing 9:30pm. Admission €10. Hall available for hire & for children’s birthday parties. Contact Ursula on 0877538317 INISHOWEN MEDICAL Hearing loss? Earache? Blocked ears? It could just be wax. Inishowen Medical can help with that. We can offer both our patients and non-patients microsuction. Microsuction is a newer and more patient friendly way of clearing wax from ears. It is considered comfortable for the patient and can be used in every ear, even if there is a history of perforations. Get your hearing back today by calling Inishowen Medical to make an appointment on 074 93 61800 or 074 76173. DANCE FITNESS CLASS Every Tues 7-8pm in St Mary’s Hall, Buncrana. All welcome to this full body workout to music. PIANO LESSONS Beginner piano lessons available in the Buncrana area, contact Lauren on 0864558483 for more details. LIFELINE INISHOWEN Domestic Violence Support Services have free counselling sessions available for Women & Children. We also offer support, drop-in and outreach services. Contact us on our HELPLINE 074 9373232 or 086 0065035330 between 10am - 1.30pm SAMARITANS Call Free 116 123, Text 087 2609090.	
DIVINE MERCY DEVOTIONS will take place on Fri 14 August at 6.15pm in St. Mary’s Church, Cockhill, followed by Mass at 7pm. All Welcome		SLIMMING WORLD Buncrana: The Exchange every Tues 8am, 9.30am & 11am with Ann Marie 0860848705, 6pm with Marie 0877389059. Carndonagh: The Colgan Hall (Hippocampe) here at the centre. This wheelchair is a free service and would be ideal for family/friends visiting over the Summer, to access local beaches, scenic walks & festivals, for further information or to book this service please contact the centre 0749361742. THE CHILD BEHAVIOUR CONSULTANCY Roisín Doherty - Behaviour Analyst consults with parents of children 3-12 years of age (with or without a diagnosis) to help their child accept ‘no’, listen, regulate their big emotions etc. Contact 0894511432 to get a consultation set up. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS Amazing Grace Group, Buncrana have 5 meetings per week as follows: Sun 8pm, Tues 8pm, Thurs 11.30am, Fri 8pm & Sat 11.30am. If you think you may have a problem with alcohol, come along. Meeting in St Teresa’s Room. AL-ANON GROUP (for anyone whose life is or has been affected by someone else’s drinking) meet in St Teresa’s Room on Thurs at 6:45pm. GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS weekly meeting in St Teresa’s Room each Sun 5pm-6.30pm for anyone struggling with a gambling addiction. GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS HELPLINE Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 048 7135 1329. THE PLAZA Social Dances: Sat 8 August Peter McCloskey Country Way; Sat 15 August Fanadian; Sat 22 August Michael Cleary and Jackie Bannon; Sat 29 August Trevor Loughery. Doors 9pm, Dancing 9:30pm. Admission €10. Hall available for hire & for children’s birthday parties. Contact Ursula on 0877538317 INISHOWEN MEDICAL Hearing loss? Earache? Blocked ears? It could just be wax. Inishowen Medical can help with that. We can offer both our patients and non-patients microsuction. Microsuction is a newer and more patient friendly way of clearing wax from ears. It is considered comfortable for the patient and can be used in every ear, even if there is a history of perforations. Get your hearing back today by calling Inishowen Medical to make an appointment on 074 93 61800 or 074 76173. DANCE FITNESS CLASS Every Tues 7-8pm in St Mary’s Hall, Buncrana. All welcome to this full body workout to music. PIANO LESSONS Beginner piano lessons available in the Buncrana area, contact Lauren on 0864558483 for more details. LIFELINE INISHOWEN Domestic Violence Support Services have free counselling sessions available for Women & Children. We also offer support, drop-in and outreach services. Contact us on our HELPLINE 074 9373232 or 086 0065035330 between 10am - 1.30pm SAMARITANS Call Free 116 123, Text 087 2609090.			
SAFEGUARDING NOTICE: If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O’Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or Garda Síochána, Buncrana 074 9320540, Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or TUSLA Family & Child Agency 00353 749102233 ROI Vetting Office: 074 93 63108					

**Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Eighteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 2nd August 2026**

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (Matthew 14:13-21)

The miracle of the loaves and fishes began with **compassion**. Jesus first noticed the crowd's pain before providing for their hunger. In our busy lives, God invites us to see those who are lonely, discouraged, or forgotten. Even small acts of kindness can become someone's miracle.

The disciples focused on what they lacked, yet Jesus asked them to offer what they *did* have. God rarely asks for what we do not possess. When we offer our time, talents, and resources — however small — He multiplies them in ways we cannot imagine.

Before the food was shared, Jesus surrendered everything to the Father. We too carry burdens that feel heavy, but surrender is not giving up; it is trusting God with our limitations. What seems insufficient to us becomes more than enough in His hands. The abundance left over reminds us that God's blessings are meant to flow *through* us. When we share generously, encourage others, and forgive freely, His grace continues to multiply.

***Lord, fill us with compassion, use what little we offer, and multiply it for Your glory.
Teach us to trust You and to share Your blessings generously. Amen.***

Monthly Mass in Honour of St Pio will be celebrated on Wednesday 5th August at 7.00 pm in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane. We ask God's blessing on all through the intercession of St Pio. Everyone welcome.

Due to the Current Holiday Period, we wish to notify parishioners that there will be no newsletter until 22nd/23rd August. Apologies for any inconvenience. The office will be open as follows for the following two weeks: 10 am - 2 pm, Monday - Friday. Normal hours will resume on Monday 17th August.

The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Saturday 15th August is the Feast of the Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary and is a holy day of obligation. On this feast, we recall Mary's role in the life of Jesus and in salvation. Mass times for the holy day are as follows:

Vigil Mass on Friday 14th August at 6.30 pm in Immaculate Conception Church

Mass on Saturday 15th August at 8.30 am in Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

Mass on Saturday 15th August at 10.00 am in St Patrick's Church, Murlog.

Masses at the usual times on the evening of Saturday 15th & Sunday 16th August.

Prayer at Time of Exam Results

Dear Lord, in this moment of uncertainty, I seek Your peace and guidance.
Help me to accept the results of my efforts with grace, whether they meet
my hopes or not. Grant me the strength to learn and grow from this experience,
trusting in Your plan for my life. May I find comfort in Your love and wisdom.
May Your peace fill my heart as I walk forward in faith. Amen.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of
Harry Mullen, Victoria Rd, Strabane; Bernie Greene, Tipperary.

Anniversaries Tony Boggs, Joseph Colhoun, Willie Curran, May Doherty,
Johnny Forbes, Charlie Gallagher, Johnny Gallagher, Kevin Gallagher, Mary Gallagher,
Nellie Gallagher, David Kennedy, Susan Lafferty, Anne Maguire, Bernard McDermott,
Laurence McDermott, Emmett McGhee, Thomas McGranaghan, James O'Neill,
Martin Stevenson, Vincent Sweeney, James McDermott (60th anniversary),
Margaret McCay, Anna Morgan. May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:

Leckpatrick: £1,372.61;

Clonleigh: €1,925.66;

Camus: £1,420.06.

Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 9th August:

1st Reading: First Kings 19: 9a, 11-13a

Psalm: 85: 9, 10, 11-12, 13-14

2nd Reading: Romans 9: 1-5

Gospel: Matthew 14: 22-33

Readings 15th August (Feast of the Assumption):

1st Reading: Revelation 11: 19a; 12: 1-6a, 10ab

Psalm: 45: 10, 11, 12, 16

2nd Reading: 1st Corinthians 15: 20-27;

Gospel: Luke 1: 39-56

Readings for Sunday 16th August:

1st Reading: Isaiah 56: 1, 6-7

Psalm: 67: 2-3, 5, 6, 8

2nd Reading: Romans 11: 13-15, 29-32

Gospel: Matthew 15: 21-28

Readings for Sunday 23rd August:

1st Reading: Isaiah 22: 19-23

Psalm: 137: 1-3, 6, 8

2nd Reading: Romans 11: 33-36

Gospel: Matthew 16: 13-20

Saints of The Coming Week:

Tuesday: St John Vianney, priest;

Wed: The Dedication of the Basilica of St Mary Major in Rome;

Thurs: The Transfiguration of the Lord;

Fri: St Cajetan, priest; St Sixtus II, pope, & companions, martyrs;

Sat: St Dominic, priest

Embrace the Grace Legion of Mary Young Adult (18-40) Catholic Conference takes place on Sat 29th August from 9.30 am - 6 pm at De Montfort House, Morning Star Ave, Dublin, D07 VA03. Tickets from www.eventbrite. Search Embrace the Grace.

Pope's Prayer Intention for August *For evangelisation in the city*

Let us pray that in large cities often marked by anonymity and loneliness we find new ways to proclaim the Gospel, discovering creative paths to build community.

Rosary on the Coast takes place today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm at Lisfannon Beach, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn children. Everyone welcome.

Give Blood, Save Lives NI Blood Transfusion Service will collect blood donations at Lisneal College, 70 Crescent Link, Derry, BT47 5FQ on 4th August from 1230 pm - 4.00 pm & 5.00 pm - 7.30 pm. Please freecall 08085534653 to book.

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw to ensure Station Island remains open for future generations. Single ticket: €10. Book of 6: €50. Buy a full book and you're entered into a sellers' draw. Return a complete book for Early Bird draws on 28/8/26. Tickets from www.loughderg.org/store/c3/annualdraw or +353 (0) 719861518 or info@loughderg.org Prizes: 1st: €10,000, 2nd: €5,000, 3rd: €2,000, 4th: €1,500, 5th: €1,000, 6th: €500. Draw date: 23rd October 2026.

Job Opportunity Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of Administrative & Financial Officer at Clonmany Parish. 9 hours pw. For application pack, please contact Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP, 02871262302 or recruitment@derrydiocese.org Closing date: 11th August 2026.

Franciscan Friary, Rossnowlagh Monthly Healing Service today (Sunday). Rosary at 2.45 pm followed by Mass / Healing Service at 3 pm. Confessions 2 - 5 pm.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Courses available at www.accordni.com

Monthly Mass in Memory of Sr Clare Crockett will be celebrated on Sunday 9th August at 7 pm in Carmelite Retreat Centre, Termonbacca, Derry.

Pray for Vocations We pray for men called to priesthood. Like Jesus in today's gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, hungry, most vulnerable or those in need, but always reflect the love of Christ as they nourish and strengthen them with the Word of God. Visit <https://derryvocations.org>

A Day of Healing & Prayer in the House of Prayer, Clonfert with Eddie Stone on Sat 15th August. A bus leaves Letterkenny, collecting people in Ballybofey and Donegal Town. A priest will accompany the group. Please contact 0863936547.

Sharing the Good News Visit <https://theway.ie/ezine-2/> for the weekly ezine.

Sean Davis 4 Day Outdoor Summer Fun Soccer Academy takes place at Templemore Sports Complex, Derry from 4th - 7th August. Boys and girls aged 5 - 18 welcome. Times: 10 am - 3 pm. Please contact Sean on 07787791880.

Youth 2000 Festival | 13th–16th August Calling all young people (16 - 35). Join us in Newbridge College, Kildare. Free buses. All meals included. Inspiring talks, workshops, Mass, music, prayer, and plenty of opportunities to chill out and meet other young Catholics. Visit youth2000.ie or follow @Youth2000Ireland

Family Carers Ireland are running 1:1 support clinics remotely every Tuesday in August for carers, offering you a space and time to talk over the phone in the comfort of your own home. Contact 0868363842 or Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Lough Derg As the **3 Day Pilgrimage** season draws to a close soon (final day to start is 13th August), our **Day Retreats** recommence on August 18, 22, 23, 29 & 31 and September 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20. Take time away from the busyness of life for a day of guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal in the peaceful surroundings of Lough Derg. Booking essential. Please visit www.loughderg.org

Mary's Meals Annual Step by Step Walk takes place on Sunday 9th August at 12 noon from Sainsbury's car park, Strand Rd, Derry, walking around the Foyle Bridge & Peace Bridge. All welcome, even for a mile or two. Mary's Meals currently feeds over 3 million children a daily school meal across 16 countries. For further details / to register, please visit www.marysmeals.org.uk/step or contact Caoimhe on 07394564065. Please keep all our walkers in your prayers.

Donegal Pro Life Annual Church Gate Collection takes place on Saturday 15th / Sunday 16th August countywide. If you can help in taking up a collection, it would be appreciated. Please contact Margaret on 00353892469599. Míle buíochas.

The Monthly Pro Life Witness / Gathering takes place at the roundabout at Letterkenny Hospital on Friday 7th August from 1 pm - 2 pm. All welcome.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8 pm in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St. All welcome.

Termonbacca Derry Anam Óg Summer Scheme for those aged 8 - 14 takes place from 3rd - 7th August from 12 - 4 pm daily. Faith, friendship, arts and crafts, adventures, games and prayer. Please email termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Walk in Our Patron Saint's Footsteps St Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk, Downpatrick with guides Martina Purdy & Elaine Kelly on **8th August 9 am - 3 pm** Cost (£55). Tel 028 44619000. Visit www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Reflections Through Poetry book by Fr John P Forbes available in Pastoral Office. Cost: £10. Proceeds to Children in Crossfire and Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation.

Parish Bingo & Lucky Four A warm welcome to all to St Pat's Hall every Thursday at 8 pm. Come along for some fun, excitement and slight competition.

Strabane / Leckpatrick Draw July 2026

Prize	Winner	Promoter
£2,000	Philomena & Bosco Gallagher	Siobhan McDevitt
£1,000	Pat Gallagher	Sadie Kerlin
£500	Fr Paul Farren	Fr Michael
£500	Conal Doherty	Colette McKane
£250	Paddy Quinn	Fr Michael
£250	Brian Devine	Gabrielle Dooher
£100	Finola Kerr	Nuala Kerr
£100	Laura Burke	Paul Mullen
£100	Steven Casey	Paul Mullen
£100	Mary Barrett	Patsy Barrett
£100	Sarah McMichael	Ann McCrory

Congratulations to all the winners. Thank you for your support.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: **8.30 am** (2nd August - alternate Sundays - 16th August)

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: **8.30 am** (9th August - alternate Sundays - 23rd August)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes.

Office hours: Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am - 12.30 pm.

Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.



Sacred Heart Church

Carndonagh

*8th & 9th August 2026
(19th Sunday Ordinary Time)*

Mass Times

Friday	7.00 pm
Saturday Vigil	7.00 pm
Sunday	9.00 am & 11 am

Baptism

Saturday	6.00 pm
Sunday	12.00 noon

Rosary

Sunday	6.30pm
--------	--------



Deaths: We wish to express our deepest sympathy to the family and friends of Owen McGuinness, Malin Rd., his funeral Mass took place on Sunday.

Anniversary and Month's Mind Masses

Sat 8 th Aug	Jim O'Donnell, Glenmakee (1 st Anniv) 7pm
Sun 9 th Aug	Dela Bradley, Gortlarry 9am
Tue 11 th Aug	Patsy Doyle, Benduff 10am
Thu 13 th Aug	Gerard & Katie Harvey 10am
Fri 14 th Aug	Willie John Callaghan, Buildings 7pm
Sat 15 th Aug	Kathleen Hirrell, Tul na Ri (1 st Anniv) 7pm

Anniversaries at this time

Sarah McLaughlin, Bridge St., Jeremiah Gallagher, Glebe & Falduff,
Joe Doherty, Cregnahorna and Ann & Edward Atkinson, Cloncha Ave.

The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Saturday 15th August 2026

Mass on Friday evening at 7pm & Saturday morning at 10 am.

PARISH DRAW RETURNS are due on Tuesday 11th August at 7 pm in the Parish Office

Weekly Collection amounted to € 3,407.20 & Stg £179.20

Thank you for your generosity.



Baptisms: We welcome into God's family: Aoife Doherty, Camatha, Uisneach Lúic Sperrin-Moran, Ballyloskey, and Cece Noella & Penelope Eve McLaughlin, Meenolin.

Vocations: For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"

DONEGAL DOWN SYNDROME ASSOCIATION Annual church-gate collection will take place on the weekend of 29 /30 August. Anyone interested in helping on the day can contact the Donegal Down Syndrome Association office by email at info@donegal.downsyndrome.ie or telephone on 085 787 0075. Your financial support for this important fundraising event would be greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down syndrome and their families across Donegal.

The National Novena to Our Lady of Knock takes place at Knock Shrine from Thursday 13 to Friday 21 August 2026. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3.00pm and 8.00pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days. This year's theme is **"Sheltered in God's Love."** See the full programme at: <https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/>

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND: Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

'Embrace the Grace' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026
- Legion of Mary: 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. This event takes place on Saturday 30 August from 9.30am to 6.00pm with a social afterwards. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed towards deusetpatria@gmail.com.

Masses and Baptisms: If you wish to book Masses or Baptisms please call into the Sacristy before or after any Masses or telephone **0860577273**. Parish Office, Macartan's, Carndonagh, Co. Donegal. [Tel:\(074\)9374104](tel:0749374104) [Email:sacredheartchurchcam@gmail.com](mailto:sacredheartchurchcam@gmail.com)

SUNDAY 9 AUGUST 2026

Nineteenth Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:
Aghyaran ♦ Ardstraw West & Castlederg ♦ Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 10 August		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 11 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 12 August			Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 13 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Friday 14 August	Mass, 7.30pm: Vigil Mass for Feast of the Assumption	Mass, Castlederg: 6.15pm: Vigil Mass for Feast of the Assumption	Mass, 7.30pm: Vigil Mass for Feast of the Assumption
Saturday 15 August	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 16 August	Mass, 11.00am: <i>First Anniversary, Mary Penrose</i>	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Drumnabey, 12.30pm <i>Mass in Castlederg on 2nd, 4th and 5th Sunday</i>	Mass, 11.00am

Saturday 15 August is the Feast of the Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary - Vigil Masses on Friday evening in Aghyaran, Castlederg and Drumquin as above. Please note there is no 10.00am Mass in Castlederg this Friday.

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £947 & €36. **Church Restoration Fund:** £1,064 & €46.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,376 & €52, made up of:

Castlederg £1,398 & €26, **Drumnabey** £494 & €21, **Dregish** £484 & €5. **DRUMQUIN:** £732.

Sincere thanks for £200 towards the church renovations in Castlederg.

PASTORAL VISITATION OF THE HOUSEBOUND will take place this week as follows:

Wednesday 12 August - Young Crescent and Drumnabey, commencing at 11.00am - Fr Thomas.

AGHYARAN - Knock Novena -14 - 22 August) - leaflets available at the back of the church.

EMBRACE THE GRACE' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026, 9.30am – 6.00pm - Legion of Mary: a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on eventbrite website - look up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed to deusetpatria@gmail.com.

Our prayers are asked for the happy repose of the souls of those recently enrolled in the Derry Diocesan Society:

Aghyaran: Peter Moss, Scraghey Road; Madge McNamee, Meelmore Drive, Omagh.

Drumquin: Paddy Gallagher, Tattysalagh Road; Finola Scott, Meelmore Drive, Omagh.

Ardstraw West and Castlederg: Charlie Logue, Castlefin Park; Christine Clarke, 120 Lenagh Road, Omagh

Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick

Eighteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 2nd August 2026

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (*Matthew 14:13-21*)

The miracle of the loaves and fishes began with **compassion**. Jesus first noticed the crowd's pain before providing for their hunger. In our busy lives, God invites us to see those who are lonely, discouraged, or forgotten. Even small acts of kindness can become someone's miracle.

The disciples focused on what they lacked, yet Jesus asked them to offer what they *did* have. God rarely asks for what we do not possess. When we offer our time, talents, and resources — however small — He multiplies them in ways we cannot imagine.

Before the food was shared, Jesus surrendered everything to the Father. We too carry burdens that feel heavy, but surrender is not giving up; it is trusting God with our limitations. What seems insufficient to us becomes more than enough in His hands. The abundance left over reminds us that God's blessings are meant to flow *through* us. When we share generously, encourage others, and forgive freely, His grace continues to multiply.

Lord, fill us with compassion, use what little we offer, and multiply it for Your glory. Teach us to trust You and to share Your blessings generously. Amen.

Monthly Mass in Honour of St Pio will be celebrated on Wednesday 5th August at 7.00 pm in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane. We ask God's blessing on all through the intercession of St Pio. Everyone welcome.

Due to the Current Holiday Period, we wish to notify parishioners that there will be no newsletter until 22nd/23rd August. Apologies for any inconvenience. The office will be open as follows for the following two weeks: 10 am – 2 pm, Monday – Friday. Normal hours will resume on Monday 17th August.

Prayer at Time of Exam Results

Dear Lord, in this moment of uncertainty, I seek Your peace and guidance.

Help me to accept the results of my efforts with grace, whether they meet my hopes or not. Grant me the strength to learn and grow from this experience, trusting in Your plan for my life. May I find comfort in Your love and wisdom.

May Your peace fill my heart as I walk forward in faith. Amen.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of Harry Mullen, Victoria Rd, Strabane; Bernie Greene, Tipperary.

Anniversaries Tony Boggs, Joseph Colhoun, Willie Curran, May Doherty, Johnny Forbes, Charlie Gallagher, Johnny Gallagher, Kevin Gallagher, Mary Gallagher, Nellie Gallagher, David Kennedy, Susan Lafferty, Anne Maguire, Bernard McDermott, Laurence McDermott, Emmett McGhee, Thomas McGranaghan, James O'Neill, Martin Stevenson, Vincent Sweeney, James McDermott (60th anniversary), Margaret McCay, Anna Morgan. May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:

Leckpatrick: £1,372.61;

Clonleigh: €1,925.66;

Camus: £1,420.06.

Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 9th August:

1st Reading: First Kings 19: 9a, 11-13a

Psalms: 85: 9, 10, 11-12, 13-14

2nd Reading: Romans 9: 1-5

Gospel: Matthew 14: 22-33

Readings 15th August (Feast of the Assumption):

1st Reading: Revelation 11: 19a; 12: 1-6a,10ab

Psalm: 45:10,11,12,16

2nd Reading: 1st Corinthians 15:20-27;

Gospel: Luke 1:39-56

Readings for Sunday 16th August:

1st Reading: Isaiah 56: 1, 6-7

Psalm: 67: 2-3, 5, 6, 8

2nd Reading: Romans 11: 13-15, 29-32

Gospel: Matthew 15: 21-28

Readings for Sunday 23rd August:

1st Reading: Isaiah 22:19-23

Psalm: 137:1-3, 6, 8

2nd Reading: Romans 11:33-36

Gospel: Matthew 16:13-20

Saints of The Coming Week:

Tuesday: St John Vianney, priest;

Wed: The Dedication of the Basilica of St Mary Major in Rome;

Thurs: The Transfiguration of the Lord;

Fri: St Cajetan, priest; St Sixtus II, pope, & companions, martyrs;

Sat: St Dominic, priest

Embrace the Grace Legion of Mary Young Adult (18-40) Catholic Conference takes place on Sat 29th August from 9.30 am – 6 pm at De Montfort House, Morning Star Ave, Dublin, D07 VA03. Tickets from www.eventbrite. Search Embrace the Grace.

Pope's Prayer Intention for August *For evangelisation in the city*

Let us pray that in large cities often marked by anonymity and loneliness we find new ways to proclaim the Gospel, discovering creative paths to build community.

Rosary on the Coast takes place today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm at Lisfannon Beach, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn children. Everyone welcome.

Give Blood, Save Lives NI Blood Transfusion Service will collect blood donations at Lisneal College, 70 Crescent Link, Derry, BT47 5FQ on 4th August from 1230 pm – 4.00 pm & 5.00 pm – 7.30 pm. Please freecall 08085534653 to book.

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw to ensure Station Island remains open for future generations. Single ticket: €10. Book of 6: €50. Buy a full book and you're entered into a sellers' draw. Return a complete book for Early Bird draws on 28/8/26. Tickets from www.loughderg.org/store/c3/annualdraw or +353 (0) 719861518 or info@loughderg.org Prizes: 1st: €10,000, 2nd: €5,000, 3rd: €2,000, 4th: €1,500, 5th: €1,000, 6th: €500. Draw date: 23rd October 2026.

Job Opportunity Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of Administrative & Financial Officer at Clonmany Parish. 9 hours pw. For application pack, please contact Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP, 02871262302 or recruitment@derrydiocese.org Closing date: 11th August 2026.

Franciscan Friary, Rossnowlagh Monthly Healing Service today (Sunday). Rosary at 2.45 pm followed by Mass / Healing Service at 3 pm. Confessions 2 – 5 pm.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Courses available at www.accordni.com

Monthly Mass in Memory of Sr Clare Crockett will be celebrated on Sunday 9th August at 7 pm in Carmelite Retreat Centre, Termonbacca, Derry.

Pray for Vocations We pray for men called to priesthood. Like Jesus in today's gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, hungry, most vulnerable or those in need, but always reflect the love of Christ as they nourish and strengthen them with the Word of God. Visit <https://derryvocations.org>

A Day of Healing & Prayer in the House of Prayer, Clonfert with Eddie Stone on Sat 15th August. A bus leaves Letterkenny, collecting people in Ballybofey and Donegal Town. A priest will accompany the group. Please contact 0863936547.

Sharing the Good News Visit <https://theway.ie/ezone-2/> for the weekly ezine.

Sean Davis 4 Day Outdoor Summer Fun Soccer Academy takes place at Templemore Sports Complex, Derry from 4th – 7th August. Boys and girls aged 5 – 18 welcome. Times: 10 am – 3 pm. Please contact Sean on 07787791880.

Youth 2000 Festival | 13th–16th August Calling all young people (16 – 35). Join us in Newbridge College, Kildare. Free buses. All meals included. Inspiring talks, workshops, Mass, music, prayer, and plenty of opportunities to chill out and meet other young Catholics. Visit youth2000.ie or follow @Youth2000Ireland

Family Carers Ireland are running 1:1 support clinics remotely every Tuesday in August for carers, offering you a space and time to talk over the phone in the comfort of your own home. Contact 0868363842 or Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Lough Derg As the **3 Day Pilgrimage** season draws to a close soon (final day to start is 13th August), our **Day Retreats** recommence on August 18, 22, 23, 29 & 31 and September 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20. Take time away from the busyness of life for a day of guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal in the peaceful surroundings of Lough Derg. Booking essential. Please visit www.loughderg.org

Mary's Meals Annual Step by Step Walk takes place on Sunday 9th August at 12 noon from Sainsbury's car park, Strand Rd, Derry, walking around the Foyle Bridge & Peace Bridge. All welcome, even for a mile or two. Mary's Meals currently feeds over 3 million children a daily school meal across 16 countries. For further details / to register, please visit www.marysmeals.org.uk/step or contact Caoimhe on 07394564065. Please keep all our walkers in your prayers.

Donegal Pro Life Annual Church Gate Collection takes place on Saturday 15th / Sunday 16th August countywide. If you can help in taking up a collection, it would be appreciated. Please contact Margaret on 0892469599. Míle buíochas.

The Monthly Pro Life Witness / Gathering takes place at the roundabout at Letterkenny Hospital on Friday 7th August from 1 pm – 2 pm. All welcome.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8 pm in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St. All welcome.

Termonbacca Derry Anam Óg Summer Scheme for those aged 8 – 14 takes place from 3rd – 7th August from 12 – 4 pm daily. Faith, friendship, arts and crafts, adventures, games and prayer. Please email termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Walk in Our Patron Saint's Footsteps St Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk, Downpatrick with guides Martina Purdy & Elaine Kelly on **8th August 9 am – 3 pm** Cost (£55). Tel 028 44619000. Visit www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Reflections Through Poetry book by Fr John P Forbes available in Pastoral Office. Cost: £10. Proceeds to Children in Crossfire and Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation.

Parish Bingo & Lucky Four A warm welcome to all to St Pat's Hall every Thursday at 8 pm. Come along for some fun, excitement and slight competition.

Strabane / Leckpatrick Draw July 2026

Prize	Winner	Promoter
£2,000	Philomena & Bosco Gallagher	Siobhan McDevitt
£1,000	Pat Gallagher	Sadie Kerlin
£500	Fr Paul Farren	Fr Michael
£500	Conal Doherty	Colette McKane
£250	Paddy Quinn	Fr Michael
£250	Brian Devine	Gabrielle Dooher
£100	Finola Kerr	Nuala Kerr
£100	Laura Burke	Paul Mullen

£100	Steven Casey	Paul Mullen
£100	Mary Barrett	Patsy Barrett
£100	Sarah McMichael	Ann McCrory

Congratulations to all the winners. Thank you for your support.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: **8.30 am** (2nd August – alternate Sundays – 16th August)

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: **8.30 am** (9th August – alternate Sundays – 23rd August)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes.

Office hours: Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am – 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am – 12.30 pm. Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please

contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.



clonmanyparish.ie

PARISH MASS AND PRAYER SCHEDULE

ST MARY’S CHURCH, CLONMANY

- Monday—Thursday 9:30am Mass
- Friday 7:30pm Vigil Mass (Aug 15th)
- Confessions from 7pm
- Saturday 11:30am Mass & 6:30pm Vigil Mass
- Confessions from 6pm
- Sunday 11:30am
- Wednesday: *Exposition of The Blessed Sacrament 2:30pm—3:30pm in the room behind the Sanctuary*

ST MICHAEL’S CHURCH, URRIS

- Saturday (Aug 15) 10am Mass
- Sunday: 10am Mass
- Friday: *Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament 3-6pm*

ORATORY OF THE ASSUMPTION, BALLYLIFFIN

- Tuesday: *Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament 7:30—8:30pm*

MASS INTENTIONS THIS WEEK

6:30pm Vigil Mass—Mary Harkin, Upper Glebe
10am Mass, St Mary’s—Sheila & Louise Joyce
10am Mass, St Michael’s—Neil & Eddie Friel, Dunaff

ANNIVERSARIES

Corney Conaghan, Letter; Daniel Toland, Gaddyduff;
Patrick McGonigle, Cloontagh; Nellie Doherty & Mary O’Keefe.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS

7:30pm Vigil Mass in St Mary’s Church on Friday August 14 will be offered for Patrick Gallen, Main Street, Clonmany, on the first anniversary of his death. May he RIP.

CHANGE OF MASS TIME THIS SUNDAY

Mass in St Mary’s Church on Sunday August 9 will be at the earlier time of 10am instead of 11:30am.

VOCATIONS

For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"

SAINTS OF THE WEEK

Monday: St Lawrence, Deacon & Martyr
Tuesday: St John Clare
Wednesday: St Jane Frances de Chantal, St Muredach, St Attracta, & St Lelia. Thursday: St Pontian & St Fachtna
Friday: St Maximilian Kolbe
Saturday: The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary

SYMPATHY

We offer sincere sympathy to the families and friends of Sarah McGonigle, Roxtown and John Doherty, Cregnagore who died during the week. May they rest in peace.

BAPTISM

We welcome into God’s family through holy baptism Thea Bridie Coulson, Cloontagh.



Clonmany Parish Newsletter

Fr John McDevitt PP Tel 0749376273 or 085 8237119

Fr Karl Haan CC Tel 0749379107

Parish Office Tel 0749376114 Email: clonmanyparish1@outlook.com



40 HOURS ADORATION

Will take place in St Michael’s Church, Urris this weekend, Sat Aug 8 & Sun Aug 9 opening with 9:30am Mass on Saturday until 5pm. Continuing after 10am Mass on Sunday and closing with a holy hour from 6-7pm. We invite people to offer some time in adoration during the two days. There is a sheet on the table at the back of the church where volunteers can fill in their name on whatever day or time suits to spend some time in the presence of the Blessed Sacrament. There should always be someone present in the Church while the Blessed Sacrament is exposed.



DAY OF PRAYER FOR MARRIAGE AND FAMILY LIFE

Friday August 14 is our Day of Prayer for Marriage & Family Life. The theme is praying for all single people and highlighting their vocation. Every baptised person, from the youngest baby to the oldest woman and man, has an important vocation which comes from the wonderful gift of baptism that each of us has been called to. In August we can focus on how this applies to those who are single and maybe even living alone.

COLLECTION

Parish collection last weekend amounted to €2,405. Thank you for your continued generosity.

DONEGAL PRO LIFE

Annual Church Gate Collection will be taken up on Saturday Aug 15 & Sunday Aug 16 countywide. If you can help in taking up a collection it would be appreciated. Contact Margaret on 0892469599. Míle buíochas.

BLESSING OF GRAVES

Annual Blessing of Graves will take place on Sunday August 16 in Clonmany Cemetery at 3pm, Cleagh Cemetery 4pm & Urris Cemetery 5pm. A collection will be taken up to support the upkeep of the cemeteries.

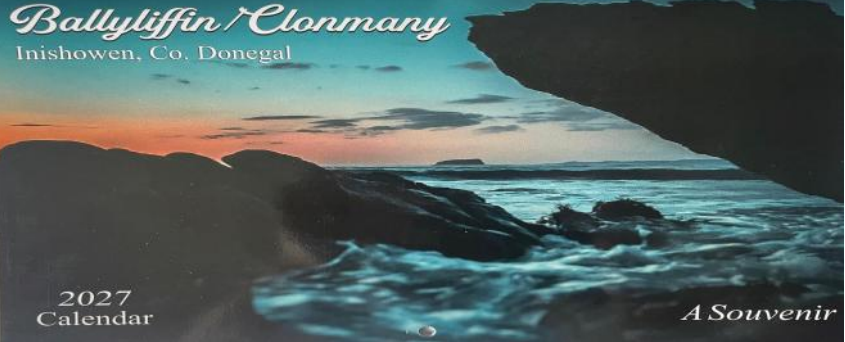
SLIABH SNEACHT CENTRE NOTES

Drumfries Walking Group will be meet on Friday Aug 14 at the car park in Ballyliffin village at 10am—everyone welcome. Wheelchair (Hippocampe) here at the centre, free service and ideal for family/friends visiting over the summer, to access local beaches, scenic walks and festivals. To book this service please Tel 0749361742.

ROSARY

The Rosary continues on Wednesday at 8:30pm at the Grotto in St Mary’s Church, Clonmany—All welcome as we pray for peace.

NOWDOC—6pm Friday—8am Monday—Call 0818400911



BALLYLIFFIN TIDY TOWNS 2027 CALENDAR

Twelve stunning photographs of beautiful Inishowen! Only €7 100% local production. Ideal present to be posted around the world to your family and friends! Available for sale locally at Centras, Nacey’s Barn, Atlantic Stores, Maple, Ballyliffin, & Clonmany Post Office. We can also post to you, or anywhere in the world on your behalf! Contact us at ballyliffintidytown@gmail.com to order.

JOB OPPORTUNITY:

Derry Diocesan Trust - Clonmany Parish: Administrative & Financial Officer. Hours of work: 9 hours per week. This is a job-share role. Place of work: Parish Office, Clonmany. For full details and application pack, email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop’s House, St Eugene’s Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12noon Tuesday 11 August 2026. *Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.*

PARISH DRAW RESULTS FOR JULY

- | | |
|--|-------------------|
| 1st €1,000 Marie Coady, Riverside Park | PROMOTERS |
| 2nd €150 Margaret Grant, Annaugh | Sarah Doherty |
| 3rd €150 Hubert Doherty, Coolcross | Fearghal Harkin |
| 4th €150 Ellen Doherty, 32 Gaddyduff | Charlie McGroarty |
| 5th €150 Michael & Roisin Toland, Rashenny | Bridie McDaid |
| 6th €150 Michelle Smyth, Leenan | Nora Ivers |
| 7th €100 Cian McConologue, Australia | Elizabeth Doherty |
| 8th €100 Coyle Family, Cleagh | Sarah Doherty |
| 9th €100 Anne Noone, Ard, Cloontagh | Bridie McDaid |
| 10th €100 Patrick Friel, Dunaff | Nora Ivers |

Thank you to our promoters and everyone who supports the parish draw. Profit for the month of July was €740. Anyone who wishes to join contact a promoter or the Parish Office Tel 074 9376114.



Saturday August 15—The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary

7:30pm Vigil Mass in St Mary’s Church on Fri Aug 14

10am Mass in St Michael’s Church, Urris on Sat Aug 15

11:30am Mass in St Mary’s Church on Sat Aug 15

The Feast of the Assumption is a day of joy. God has won. Love has won. It has won life. Love has shown that it is stronger than death, that God possesses the true strength in goodness and love. Mary was taken up body and soul into heaven. We have a Mother in heaven, the Mother of God, the Mother of the Son of God, is our Mother. He himself has said so. He made her our Mother when he said to the disciples and to all of us: ‘Behold, your Mother!’ We have a Mother in heaven.

Heaven is open, heaven has a heart. Mary spoke with God’s words, she thought with God’s words, her thoughts were God's thoughts, her words, God’s words. She was penetrated by divine light and this is why she was so resplendent, so good, so radiant with love and goodness. Being in God and with God, she is close to each one of us, knows our hearts, can hear our prayers, can help us with her motherly kindness and has been given to us, as the Lord said, precisely as a ‘mother’ to whom we can turn at any moment. She always listens to us, she is always close to us, and being Mother of the Son, participates in the power of the Son and in his goodness. We can always entrust the whole of our lives to this Mother, who is not far from any one of us.



Culdaff
Fr. John McDevitt P.P. 9376273 / 0858237119

Fr. Karl Haan C.C. 9379107

www.culdaffparish.com

email: culdaffnotes@gmail.com

Daily Mass

Monday 7.30 pm; **Tuesday & Wednesday**, 10 am
[Blessed Sacrament Exposition after 10 am Mass until 2 pm]; **Thursday** 7.30 pm;

Saturday, Feast of the Assumption,

Vigil Mass Friday, 7.30 pm,

Saturday 11 am [Rosary will be recited in the old cemetery in Culdaff after 11 am Mass on Saturday]..

Saturday Vigil 8 pm
Sunday 10 am.

Anniversary Mass next weekend

Sunday, 10 am Seamus McDermott, Leitrim, Gleneely

Weekly Offering €865

Development Collection €220

We acknowledge the receipt of €120 from the Whist Club; and €200 donation from the Defibrillator Group.

Envelopes can be left in McGuinness' shop.

First Reading

1 Kings 19:9a, 11-13a

The Lord appears to Elijah in a whisper.

Second Reading

Romans 9:1-5

Paul speaks of the blessings that have come to the Israelites.

Gospel Reading

Matthew 14:22-33

Jesus walks on water, and the disciples acknowledge him as the Son of God.



The National Novena to Our Lady of Knock takes place at

Knock Shrine from Thursday 13 to Friday 21 August 2026.

Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3.00pm and 8.00pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days.

This year's theme is "Sheltered in God's Love."

See the full programme at: <https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/>

Carrowmenagh Community Centre Tel 074 93 67061

Cream Teas available at the Centre every Tuesday 2-4pm, during August. Cost €5. No need to book - just call in.

Carrowmenagh Community Centre will host The Holiday Hop, a special summer Sunday night dance for regulars, holiday makers and visitors, on Sunday 16th August at 8pm. Admission €5, including supper. Everyone is very welcome.

Celebrate Carrowmenagh – Join Carrowmenagh Community Centre, Carrowmenagh Residents Association and Tremone Historical Society for a special afternoon celebrating the heritage, people and stories of Carrowmenagh. The event will take place on **Sunday 30th August at 2pm**. It includes a guided historical village walk, talks on the stories behind the new memorial plaques in the recently renovated memorial garden and at the Centre, a cream tea, and entry into a prize draw to win an original painting by local artist Jenny Craven. All proceeds will support the Carrowmenagh Residents Association and the Memorial Garden Renovation Fund. **Tickets €10 children €5. Booking is essential through Carrowmenagh Community Centre.**

We have lots of great **courses** coming up for the autumn including beauty therapy, upholstery, plumbing, phone photography, dressmaking and alterations, pottery, creative painting, guitar lessons, tablet and smartphone for beginners, crafts, silversmithing, line dancing, glass fusion and Internet Skills. Contact the Centre for more information and to book.

UPDATE ON THE TRIP TO BALLYCASTLE. The Men's Shed Carn is looking for expressions of interest in travelling to the Ould Lammass Fair in Ballycastle on Tuesday August 25th. We will travel by wheelchair friendly coach there and back. Collection and drop off at **Carndonagh, Quigely's Point and Muff**. Tickets are €30. Please email mens.shed.carn@gmail.com if you are interested in joining us on this great day out, or call 087 4611571. **The Men's Shed Carn is hosting "DROP IN WEDNESDAYS"** for men every Wednesday from 11 am -1 pm. Pop in for a coffee and a chat and see what we do here at the shed, a place to connect, learn and create. Bring a friend, meet new people. All ages welcome email mens.shed.carn@gmail.com or call 087 4611571.

A Feast of Folk with Patsy Cavanagh and friends every Tuesday evening at 8pm during July and August in The Cairn Greencastle. Enquiries tel 074 9381104



"Donegal Pro Life Annual Church Gate Collection is on Sat.15th /Sun 16th Aug Countywide. If you can help in taking up a collection it would be appreciated.. Contact Margaret on .0892469599. Mile buíochas."

" Also reminder of the monthly Pro Life Witness/Gathering at the Roundabout at Letterkenny Hospital on Fri.7th Aug from 1 p, to 2 00 pm"

The Deep End: Eyes on the real mission

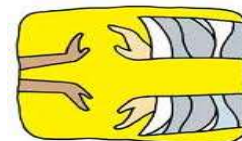
Jane Mellett

Jesus said: 'You asked to be out here. If you can't handle the wind and waves that's your problem!' And Peter drowned that night in the Sea of Galilee. No? Oh sorry, that's not how the story ends. Do the disciples not realise by now that if they leave the shore without Jesus in the boat, the waters become very choppy indeed? In fact, they had gone so far, that they didn't even recognise him when he did catch up to them.

Those of you sitting in the nave of a church and reading this may like to look up above you [notice to clergy: parishioners looking at the ceiling may not be listening]. The word nave comes from the Latin, *navis*, literally meaning ship and sometimes used to refer to the ship of St Peter, i.e. the Church. So perhaps bearing that in mind this story can take on an even deeper significance as we read of Peter's brief walk on the water.

It is important to remember one thing – at least he got out of the boat. The situation was very serious, the disciples as fishermen knew how quickly conditions could change and soon they'd be in, well...in over their heads!

There was no great surfing culture in Galilee at the time so one has to appreciate Peter's courage as he steps out onto the stormy water in a real leap of faith and cries 'Lord, save me'. The reply is not the bureaucratic response above, but 'Jesus immediately reached out his hand....'



INVITATION

Fr. John and Fr. Karl invite people who would be interested in becoming involved in an Altar Society for the Parish. Their main work will be the upkeep of our church and enhancing its beauty. For those who are interested there will be a short meeting on Monday 10 August at 8pm in the Bocan Parish Hall.

VOCATIONS: For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"

Famous Quotes: "Yesterday is gone. Tomorrow has not yet come. We have only today. Let us begin." – **Mother Teresa**

<http://www.culdaffparish.com>
The Good as New Shop in G & S is now

closed. On behalf of the Parish, we extend a big thank you to the ladies who willingly gave of their time to manage the shop; to everyone who donated items for sale, to all who visited the shop and bought items or raffle tickets your support is very much appreciated. The total raised was €4,146, a welcome boost to Parish Funds.



POINTS TO PONDER

The storm at sea is Jesus' response to the problem of storms in our lives. First, Jesus shows that he is present even where we least expect him. When the disciples saw Jesus walking on the sea he identified himself with the words, It is I, ego eimi in Greek, the same words God used to identified himself to Moses on Mt Sinai.

Next, the story teaches us a powerful prayer: 'Lord, save me.' St Peter's cry occurs only once in the whole bible, but it goes to the heart of our helplessness. True to his name, Peter 'the rock', he begins to sink like a stone. Peter cries out: 'Lord, save me.' At Mass we repeat the litany, 'Lord, have mercy.' In our private prayers we might say with the publican: 'Lord, be merciful to me a sinner.' But, Peter's short pray includes them all: 'Lord, save me.'

Finally, the story teaches how Jesus helps us. He brings us back to the boat. That's the climax of Matthew's story: Jesus saves by bringing us into the praying community. Separated from the boat, from the people of God, we are exposed to being overwhelmed by the wind and the waves. The Christian assembly gathered in church at the Eucharist is the boat that carries us safely to the other shore. To this day the long central part of our Church buildings, where the community gathers to pray, is called a nave, from the Latin word *navis*, which means a boat.

As successors of the first Christians, with grateful love and one voice, we proclaim our faith together saying, 'Jesus, truly, you are the Son of God.'

Fr Stephen Verbest

Culmore Parish Newsletter

Eighteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Sunday 2nd August 2026

Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 14:13–21 – The Feeding of the Five Thousand

The miracle of the loaves and fishes begins with **compassion**. Before Jesus fed the crowd, He first recognised their suffering and their need. His heart was moved by those who were tired, hungry, and searching for hope.

In our own busy lives, God gently calls us to notice those around us who may be lonely, discouraged, forgotten, or struggling. A simple word of encouragement, a listening ear, or a small act of kindness may become someone else's miracle.

The disciples looked only at what they **didn't have**. Faced with thousands of hungry people, they saw only five loaves and two fish. Jesus, however, asked them to offer what they already possessed.

God rarely asks us for what we do not have. Instead, He asks us to place before Him our time, our talents, our compassion, and our willingness to serve. However small these gifts may seem, He is able to multiply them beyond anything we could imagine.

Before distributing the food, Jesus lifted everything to His Father in prayer. This reminds us that surrender is not a sign of weakness or defeat. Rather, it is an act of trust. We all carry burdens that feel too heavy or situations that seem impossible, yet when we place them into God's hands, what appears insufficient can become more than enough.

Finally, the twelve baskets of leftovers remind us of God's overwhelming generosity. His blessings are never intended to stop with us but to flow through us. When we forgive generously, encourage freely, and share what we have with others, God's grace continues to multiply in countless lives.

Prayer

Lord, fill our hearts with compassion. Use the little we have to accomplish great things for Your Kingdom. Teach us to trust You completely, to surrender our limitations into Your hands, and to share Your blessings generously with all whom we meet. Amen.

Readings for Next Sunday

Sunday 9th August 2026

First Reading: 1 Kings 19:9a, 11–13a

Psalm: Psalm 85:9–14

Second Reading: Romans 9:1–5

Gospel: Matthew 14:22–33

Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday

- St John Vianney, Priest

Wednesday

- The Dedication of the Basilica of St Mary Major (Rome)

Thursday

- The Transfiguration of the Lord

Friday

- St Cajetan, Priest
- St Sixtus II, Pope, and Companions, Martyrs

Saturday

- St Dominic, Priest
-

Pope's Prayer Intention for August

For Evangelisation in the City

Let us pray that in large cities, often marked by anonymity and loneliness, we may discover new ways of proclaiming the Gospel, finding creative paths to build genuine Christian communities.

Prayer for Vocations

We pray for men whom God is calling to the priesthood.

Like Jesus in today's Gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, the hungry, the vulnerable or those most in need, but always reflect the compassionate love of Christ as they nourish His people through the Word of God and the Eucharist.

Parish & Diocesan Notices

Rosary on the Coast

Today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm

 Lisfannon Beach

Praying for **peace, Ireland and our unborn children.**

Everyone is warmly welcome.

Give Blood – Save Lives

The **Northern Ireland Blood Transfusion Service** will hold a blood donor session at:

Lisneal College

70 Crescent Link

Derry BT47 5FQ

Monday 4th August

- 12.30 pm – 4.00 pm
- 5.00 pm – 7.30 pm

 Freephone: **0808 553 4653** to book.

Franciscan Friary, Rosstown

Monthly Healing Service

Today (Sunday)

- Rosary – **2.45 pm**
 - Mass & Healing Service – **3.00 pm**
 - Confessions – **2.00 pm – 5.00 pm**
-

ACCORD Marriage Preparation

Marriage preparation courses are available throughout the year.

Please visit www.accordni.com for dates and booking information.

Monthly Mass for Sr Clare Crockett

Sunday 9th August

7.00 pm

Carmelite Retreat Centre
Termonbacca, Derry

Day of Healing & Prayer

House of Prayer, Clonfert

Saturday 15th August

Led by **Eddie Stone**

A bus will travel from **Letterkenny**, collecting pilgrims in **Ballybofey** and **Donegal Town**.
A priest will accompany the pilgrimage.

 **Contact: 086 393 6547**

Walk in Our Patron Saint's Footsteps

St Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk

Saturday 8th August

9.00 am – 3.00 pm

Downpatrick

Guides:

- Martina Purdy
- Elaine Kelly

Cost: £55

 **028 4461 9000**

Visit www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Youth & Young Adults

Embrace the Grace

Legion of Mary Young Adult Catholic Conference

(Ages 18–40)

Saturday 29th August

9.30 am – 6.00 pm

De Montfort House
Morning Star Avenue
Dublin D07 VA03

Tickets available through Eventbrite (search **Embrace the Grace**).

Youth 2000 Summer Festival

13th–16th August

Newbridge College, Kildare

Young people aged **16–35** are invited to enjoy:

- Inspiring talks
- Workshops
- Daily Mass
- Music and Prayer
- Fellowship
- Free buses
- All meals included

Visit **youth2000.ie** or follow **@Youth2000Ireland**.

Anam Óg Summer Scheme

3rd–7th August

12.00 pm – 4.00 pm daily

Termonbacca, Derry

For children aged **8–14**

Faith, friendship, games, arts & crafts, adventure and prayer.

Email:

termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Community & Charity

Mary's Meals

Annual Step by Step Walk

Sunday 9th August

12.00 noon

Starting from:

Sainsbury's Car Park

Strand Road, Derry

Walking the Foyle Bridge and Peace Bridge.

Everyone is welcome—even if only for part of the walk.

Mary's Meals currently provides a daily school meal to **over 3 million children across 16 countries.**

Please keep all participants in your prayers.

Family Carers Ireland

Remote one-to-one support clinics are available **every Tuesday throughout August.**

Carers can speak privately from the comfort of their own homes.

 086 836 3842

 Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Pro-Life Events

Donegal Pro Life Church Gate Collection

Saturday 15th & Sunday 16th August

Countywide Collection

Volunteers are greatly appreciated.

 Margaret:
00353 89 246 9599

Míle buíochas.

Monthly Pro-Life Witness

Friday 7th August
1.00 pm – 2.00 pm

Roundabout at Letterkenny University Hospital.

Everyone welcome.

Pilgrimages

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw

Support Station Island and help preserve this special place of pilgrimage for future generations.

Tickets

- Single: **€10**
- Book of 6: **€50**

Those returning a full book will also be entered into the **Early Bird Draw on 28th August 2026.**

Main Draw

23rd October 2026

Prizes

 €10,000

 €5,000

 €2,000

4th – €1,500

5th – €1,000

6th – €500

Lough Derg Day Retreats

As the Three-Day Pilgrimage season concludes (final day to begin is **13th August**), Day Retreats resume on:

- August: **18, 22, 23, 29 & 31**
- September: **5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19 & 20**

Take time away from the busyness of everyday life for guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal.

Advance booking is essential.

Employment Opportunity

Administrative & Financial Officer

Clonmany Parish

The **Derry Diocesan Trust** invites applications for the position of:

Administrative & Financial Officer

Hours: 9 per week

Application packs are available from:

Bishop's House
St Eugene's Cathedral
Derry BT48 9AP

 028 7126 2302

 recruitment@derrydiocese.org

Closing Date: Tuesday **11th August 2026**

Publications

Reflections Through Poetry

A beautiful collection by **Fr John P. Forbes**

Available from the **Pastoral Office**

Price: £10

All proceeds support **Children in Crossfire** and the **Cause for the Canonisation of Sr Clare Crockett**.

Sharing the Good News

Read the latest weekly Catholic e-zine featuring news, reflections and resources from across Ireland.

Visit **theway.ie/ezine-2/**.

Closing Prayer

May the Lord bless us with compassionate hearts, generous spirits, and unwavering trust in His providence. May we recognise Christ in those around us, offer Him the little we possess, and witness His abundant blessings multiplying in our families, our parish, and our community.

May Almighty God bless you, the Father, ✠ the Son, and the Holy Spirit. Amen.

Parish of Dunboe, Macosquin and Aghadowey

Sunday 9th August 2026
Year A Psalter Week III



Rev Neil Farren PP, Chapelfield, 59 Laurel Hill Road, Coleraine BT51 3PY Tele: 028 7034 3130
Parish Secretary: Clare White at Chapelfield

Office hours This week:
Monday 10th Aug – 09.30 – 1.15pm
Tuesday 11th Aug – 09.30 – 1.15pm
Thursday 13th Aug – 09.00 – 1.00pm

Parish Email: cpdma@btinternet.com
Parish Website: www.dmaparish.com

SVP Helpline: Tel: 07752017340
Safeguarding Officer: Mrs Bernadette Eastwood

Emergency Calls: Father Neil Farren - 07710860966

Age Concern Tele 02870357966
Good morning, Causeway For elderly and vulnerable people. Tele 02870558005
Lifeline Crisis Response Helpline 0808 808 8000
North Coast Community Transport Tele 02870321234
Samaritans Tele 116123
St Vincent de Paul Tele 07752017340
Wave Trauma Centre for Mental Health and Wellbeing Tele 0282766990 Women’s Aid Tele 02870356
Onus –Men & Women affected by domestic or sexual abuse in NI – 0808 802 1414 (Freephone 24hr)

Recently deceased

Lorraine Moore (Dunboe)

Months Mind

Bridie Clyde (Saturday st Johns 6pm)

Derry Diocesan Society

Gerard Cuning, Robert Howard, George Laverty
Gerard (Gerry) McIlwaine, Bernadette Duncan

Anniversaries

Brian Laverty, John Henry, John Fleming

Parish Collections 1st & 2nd August 2026

	St Johns	Aghadowey	Dunboe
Weekly:	£662.61	£369.40	£110.00
Loose:	£389.40	£68.05	£68.05
Priests:	£635.00	£150.00	£235.00
Total:	£ 2708.06		

Masses - week commencing 10th August

Church	St Johns	Dunboe	Aghadowey
Monday	10am		
Tuesday	10am		
Wednesday			
Thursday	10am		
Friday Feast of the assumption vigil	6pm	7.30pm	
Saturday Feast of the assumption	6pm		9.45am
Sunday	11am		

Dunboe Reader/ Offertory Rota

Saturday 8th August – Marie / Offertory – Peter & Geraldine

Saturday 15th August – Ann / Offertory – Martin & Marian

Saturday 22nd August – Brenda / Offertory – Liam & Ann

Dunboe Eucharistic Minister Rota

Saturday 8th August – Vincent

Saturday 15th August – Linda

Saturday 22nd August – Karen

Saturday 29th August - Maggie

Dunboe Cleaning & Flowers Rota

August– Martina Doherty

St Johns Eucharistic Minister

Saturday 15th August – Colette Martin

Sunday 16th August – Marie Therese Fleming

St Johns Minister of the Word August

Vigil: Carmel

Sunday Mass: Phaedra

Aghadowey Offertory

Sunday 9th August – Kathleen & Eva McBride

Sunday 16th August – Bill & Eilish

Sunday 23rd August – Christopher & Kathleen Owens

Sick Visitation

Thursday - Aghadowey



PARISH TRIP

Our Parish Day trip is now fully booked.

Taking place on Friday 21st August. we will travel to Glenveagh National Park in Co. Donegal, followed by a visit to Ards Friary in Creeslough.

The bus will depart West Bann community centre at 8am and is scheduled to return by 8.00 – 8.30pm

Coffee shops and facilities will be available at each location for people’s convenience.

Last week to pay £35 – must be received by Friday 14th August.

If you have not yet made your meal choice, please either contact the Parish Office or call in to the Sacristy in St Johns to select choice of evening meal –

Main course

*Atlantic tempura battered Cod with chips & either mushy peas or side salad.

*Beef Lasagne with chips & side salad

Dessert

*Warm apple pie served with either custard, ice cream or fresh cream

*Homemade lemon posset served with shortbread

Tea / Coffee

AMRI

Leaders of missionaries & religious of Ireland.

Representatives from AMRI will be talking at Masses on the weekend of 15th/16th August to speak of their missionary work and appeal for donations

We Pray

For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"

SAVE CAUSEWAY HOSPITAL

UNISON Causeway Branch

CAUSEWAY HOSPITAL

LET’S PROTECT AND RESTORE VITAL SERVICES AT CAUSEWAY HOSPITAL

PROTECT EMERGENCY SERVICES

SUPPORT OUR STAFF & COMMUNITY

SAFE CARE CLOSE TO HOME

PUBLIC MEETING

THURSDAY 13TH AUGUST 2026

7.30PM

COLERAINE TOWN HALL

OB OPPORTUNITY, DERRY DIOCESAN TRUST: Administrative & Financial Officer

(18 hours per week), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr.

For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop’s House, St Eugene’s Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24 August 2026.

Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

BABY MASSAGE & REFLEXOLOGY CLASSES

Next Block of Classes start in September 2026. Taster Session available on 28th & 29th July (£10 per session)

Reflexology Treatments Available for all ages. Location: Ballerin.

Contact Diane on 07761054666 or diane@groundedsoles.org for more information

SUNDAY 9 AUGUST 2026

Nineteenth Sunday Ordinary Time

NEWSLETTER FOR THE PARISHES OF THE WEST TYRONE PASTORAL AREA:
Aghyaran ♦ Ardstraw West & Castlederg ♦ Drumquin

REV PAUL FRASER PP, Tel:028 816 71393; REV THOMAS CANNING CC, Tel: 028 82831 225

SCHEDULE FOR THIS WEEK:

DAY	AGHYARAN	ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG	DRUMQUIN
Monday 10 August		Mass, Castlederg: 7.30pm	Mass, 10.00am Rosary, 8.00pm at Grotto
Tuesday 11 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Wednesday 12 August			Mass, 10.00am
Thursday 13 August	Mass, 10.00am		
Friday 14 August	Mass, 7.30pm: Vigil Mass for Feast of the Assumption	Mass, Castlederg: 6.15pm: Vigil Mass for Feast of the Assumption	Mass, 7.30pm: Vigil Mass for Feast of the Assumption
Saturday 15 August	Vigil Mass, 7.30pm	Vigil Mass, Castlederg, 6.15pm	Vigil Mass: 5.00pm
Sunday 16 August	Mass, 11.00am: <i>First Anniversary, Mary Penrose</i>	Mass: Dregish, 9.30am Drumnabey, 12.30pm <i>Mass in Castlederg on 2nd, 4th and 5th Sunday</i>	Mass, 11.00am

Saturday 15 August is the Feast of the Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary - Vigil Masses on Friday evening in Aghyaran, Castlederg and Drumquin as above. Please note there is no 10.00am Mass in Castlederg this Friday.

THANK YOU for your generosity in last week's collection:

AGHYARAN: £947 & €36. **Church Restoration Fund:** £1,064 & €46.

ARDSTRAW WEST & CASTLEDERG: £2,376 & €52, made up of:

Castlederg £1,398 & €26, **Drumnabey** £494 & €21, **Dregish** £484 & €5. **DRUMQUIN:** £732.

Sincere thanks for £200 towards the church renovations in Castlederg.

PASTORAL VISITATION OF THE HOUSEBOUND will take place this week as follows:

Wednesday 12 August - Young Crescent and Drumnabey, commencing at 11.00am - Fr Thomas.

AGHYARAN - Knock Novena -14 - 22 August) - leaflets available at the back of the church.

EMBRACE THE GRACE' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026, 9.30am – 6.00pm - Legion of Mary: a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on eventbrite website - look up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed to deusetpatria@gmail.com.

Our prayers are asked for the happy repose of the souls of those recently enrolled in the Derry Diocesan Society:

Aghyaran: Peter Moss, Scraghey Road; Madge McNamee, Meelmore Drive, Omagh.

Drumquin: Paddy Gallagher, Tattysalagh Road; Finola Scott, Meelmore Drive, Omagh.

Ardstraw West and Castlederg: Charlie Logue, Castlefin Park; Christine Clarke, 120 Lenagh Road, Omagh

**Eighteenth Sunday in
Ordinary Time**

2nd August 2026



Parish of Drumragh

**Sacred Heart Church, Omagh
St Mary's Church, Drumragh
028 82242092**

Weekend Mass Schedule

Sacred Heart Church, Omagh Vigil: 5.30pm Sunday Mass: 10am & 12.30pm	<u>Weekday Mass Times this week</u> 10.00am Monday, Tuesday & Wednesday in St. Mary's, Killyclogher 10.00am Wed, Thurs, Fri & Sat. in Sacred Heart Church 7.30pm Wednesday Sacred Heart <u>Eucharistic Adoration on Wednesday from 10am until 6.45pm.</u> <u>Rosary before 7.30pm Mass</u>
St. Mary's Church, Drumragh Sunday Mass: 10.30am	
Confessions: Sacred Heart Church: Saturday's after morning Mass unless there is a funeral. Christ the King, Strathroy: Saturday 6.15pm-6.45pm	

REST A WHILE

In our day-to-day life's journey, oftentimes we are overwhelmed with our daily routines, individual tasks as well as duties and responsibilities. It seems that the 24 hours of the day are not enough because we are too busy with so many things. We do not have time to "stop and smell the roses." We do not have time to relax and to take time out of our busy schedules to appreciate and enjoy God's gift of the beauty of life. We need time to rest, to recognise our human limitations that we need essential respite to prevent us from being exhausted and to avoid the possible danger of breakdown. According to the mechanical engineers, even machines need cooling-off time to prevent overheating. When we approach our "hallowed space" like spending time praying in front of the Blessed Sacrament or lighting candles inside the church, we are refreshed and strengthened. We will be inspired to go on despite all the burdens, challenges, and obstacles in life. That is why after the tiresome and successful mission of the Apostles the Lord told them, "Come away by yourselves to a deserted place and rest a while." Following Jesus' command, these first followers were spiritually and physically recharged to do the next job. We also badly need to have some "refreshment" of the Lord and to spend time with Him in silent prayer to find meaning in every life's situation. In this way, we are far from being "worn out" and preventing ourselves from "falling apart." And so, let us all find time to relax and rest for a while with Him.



Mass times for Sat. 15th August (Feast of the Assumption)

Vigil 7.30pm Friday 14th – Christ the King, Strathroy

10am Saturday 15th Sacred Heart Church & St Mary's, Killyclogher

Fr Kevin McElhennon P.P: 028 8225 8108 / k.mcelhennon@derrydiocese.org
 Fr Malachy Gallagher C.C: 028 8225 1055 / malachy.gallagher@derrydiocese.org
 Parish Office, Omagh 028 8224 2092 / info@drumraghparish.com
 Cappagh Parish Office 028 8224 3375 / info@cappaghparish.com

Parish Office Closed until Monday 24th August

Parish email: info@drumraghparish.com

Sacred Heart Church Mass Intentions

Wednesday 5th August	7.30pm	Louise Rodgers - Month Mind Kevin McCrory - 1st Anniversary Martin McDonagh - 5th Anniversary
Saturday 8th August	5.30pm	Marie Chesters - 6th Anniversary
Wednesday 12th August	7.30pm	Brenda Drumm - Month Mind
Wednesday 19th August	7.30pm	Eamon McAlynn - 2nd Anniversary
Thursday 20th August	10.00am	Joseph Martin - 3rd Anniversary

ST. MARY'S, DRUMRAGH Mass Intentions

Sunday 16th August 10.30pm Paddy (Patricia) Doherty – 1st Anniversary

VOCATIONS

We pray for the men called to priesthood. Like Jesus in today's gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, the hungry, the most vulnerable, or those in need, but always reflect the love of Christ for them as they nourish and strengthen them with the Word of God.

Sacrament of Baptism

We welcome new members of our Parish Community who received the

Sacrament of Baptism:

Mabel Frances McGale

Callen Brendan Gray

Tadhg Michael Drumm

Poppy Leslie Paula Marshall

Cadhla Jacqueline Finnegan



Recently Deceased

Patricia Daly

Louisa Brochet (nee Kelly)

May they rest in peace



Recent Weddings

We congratulate the following couple who were married here recently



Kerrie Anne O'Hagan & Ronan Grogan

May the grace of the sacrament remain with them all their lives.



Eucharistic Ministers will bring Holy Communion to the sick and housebound next **Sunday 9th August**

Derry Diocesan Society

The following names have been added to the list of Deceased Members of the Derry Diocesan Society

Martin Gerard Rodgers

Rene Colton

Charles (Edmund) Fisher

James (Anthony) McCauley

William (Billy) Wilson

Michelle McElhill

Seamus McGlone

Ann Marie Taggart

Alice Oddy

Mary Maguire

Padriag Doherty

Veronica Conroy

Kevin McCaskie

Shareen McNamee

Gary Oddy

Carmel Rippington

Edward McGlinchey

We pray that all who sleep in Christ find in your presence, light, happiness and peace.

BINGO in St. Joseph's Hall continues on Tuesday's during August at 8.30pm

Parish Draw

The July draw takes place this week. Promoters are asked to please make their returns before **7.30pm on Tuesday 4th August**. Please note, the deadline of 7.30pm is strict and late returns may not be accepted.

The List of August winners will be published on the noticeboard in the porch at the main door.

The Royal National institute of the deaf are holding their bimonthly free drop in event in Omagh Methodist church hall on **Thursday 27th August from 10-30 to 12.30**. Come along and have your hearing checked and new batteries provided plus advise on how to get the best from your aids.

Parish Notice – Holiday Closure

During the parish holiday closure, anyone wishing to book an Anniversary Mass, or arrange a baptism or wedding, is asked to please contact **Orla (Monday to Thursday)** in the Cappagh Office on **02882243375** or **info@cappaghparish.com**.

She will be happy to assist with all bookings during this period.

Please note there are **no** available dates in August for Baptisms in Omagh or Killyclogher.

SONGS FROM HOME

Come together with **Harmonise** and fellow local singers as we share Songs from Home. Participants must attend FREE five week choir practice followed by the Final Song Trail 10th October at Ulster American Folk Park. Refreshments provided.

EVERYONE WELCOME - Contact Claire Sharkey for more details 07751371800

Dates

August 19th	7.30pm-9.30pm – Silverbirch Hotel
August 30th	1pm-4pm – Dromore Sports Complex
September 23rd	7.30-10pm – Silverbirch Hotel
September 30th	7.30-10pm – Dromore Sports Complex
October 7th	7.30pm-9.30pm – Silverbirch Hotel

Omagh Library

Tuesday 4th August 2:00pm - 3:00pm

Create your own Comic - whether you're into superheroes or cute animals you can create your very own comic to take home with you.

For children aged 5 - 11 Years old

Children under 8 must be accompanied by an adult. Booking Essential

Monday 10th August 9:30am - 5:00pm

Calling all budding detectives! Can you help us solve the library mysteries?

Crack the code, solve the clues, and earn your detective badge.

For children aged 4 - 11 years old

Children under 8 must be accompanied by an adult. Everyone Welcome

Weekly Bulletin

Please note that throughout the month of August the parish newsletter will be published on **23rd August only**. The Parish Office will be closed until 24th August.

PUBLIC OPENING 2026 ST JOSEPH'S HALL

The Uniform Exchange will be open to the public in St Joseph's Hall from Wednesday 5th August until Sunday 9th August from 10am – 4pm each day.

For everyone – All schools from Castlederg to Ballybofey.

Good quality pre-loved uniforms, for all ages and all local schools.

NO COST / NO CHARGE The service is completely free
REUSE RELOVE REDUCE WAST



Al-Anon Family Group	028 9068 2368
Alcoholics Anonymous	028 9035 1222
Aware	028 7126 0602
Care for Cancer	028 8224 6599
Gamblers Anonymous	028 7135 1329
Drug Awareness	0800 7766 00
Legion of Mary	07733551846/07864926719
Pioneers	07775 810297
Safeguarding Team	07596 500793
Samaritans	028 8224 4944
SVDP Thrift Shop	028 8225 2000
SVDP Helpline	07738837991

**DIOCESAN SAFEGUARDING
REPRESENTATIVE**
Marie O’Kane DLP 07596500793
dlp@derrydiocese.org

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS:

Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

Walk in the footsteps of our Patron Saint on Saint Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk in Downpatrick with Martina Purdy and Elaine Kelly on **8th August**. Begin at Saint Patrick's Centre with the fabulous 180° IMAX film of St Patrick. Price includes entrance fees, internal bus transfers, pilgrimage lunch at the famous Saul Barn, plus a stamped Camino passport and a 6-mile pilgrimage walk, finishing at Saint Patrick's grave. Come and Be Amazed!

(Duration 9am-approx 3pm, all for just £55) To book ring 02844 619000 or go to website www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Celebration of Christian Marriage

Any couple intending to celebrate their marriage in the church are advised to have their

(1) Pre-nuptial Enquiry Forms (canonical church papers) completed no later than 3 months prior to their wedding.

(2) Your pre-marriage course with Accord should also be completed before your papers are signed (info@accordni.com).

(3) The Marriage Schedule (civil documents) (Ref GRO 446 v06/22) should also be “served with the Registrar at least 28 days before the date of the intended marriage”. (It is recommended that all civil and canonical papers are completed no later than 3 months prior to the wedding).

9th August 2026 Dungiven Parish Bulletin No 1855

Fr. Gerard Sweeney P.P. Tel: 777 41219.

Parish Office Tel: 777 40702. Email address

dungivenparish@derrydiocese.org

Parish Website <https://www.parishofdungiven.com>**SUNDAY MASS TIMES****Sat. 4.30 pm. - Gortnaghey****Sat. 6.00 pm. - Dungiven****Sun. 9.00 am. - Dungiven****Sun. 10.15 am. - Drumsurn****Sun. 11.30 am. - Dungiven****THE FEAST OF THE ASSUMPTION OF
OUR LADY INTO HEAVEN.****SATURDAY 15TH AUGUST****DUNGIVEN****Mass - Saturday at 10.00 am.****WEEKDAY MASS TIMES****St. Patrick's:** Monday, Tuesday & Wednesday 10.00 am. **Thursday 7.00 pm.** Friday 10.00 am.**FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS**For Attracta McGuigan on Thursday 13th August at 7.00 pm. in St. Patrick's.**MONTHS MIND MASS**For Eamon McCann today Sunday 9th August at 10.15 am. in St. Matthew's.**CONFESSIONS - Please Note! No Confessions in St. Patrick's on Saturday 15th August.****THE ROSARY** - Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday & Friday at 9.30 am. in St. Patrick's.**LAST WEEK'S COLLECTION: £3,111***Thank you to all who contributed.***CHARISMATIC PRAYER GROUP**There will be **no meeting** on Thursday on 13th August.**CLEANERS - ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH**

Voluntary cleaners required to clean the church on a monthly rota basis. Please leave your name in the parish office.

**BAPTISM** - We welcome into our Christian Community: Meabh Cait McGowan, Drumsurn Road.**BAPTISM - Godparents must be over 16 years of age, one male and one female and a practicing Catholic.****Baptisms** will take place in St. Patrick's Church at 3.00 pm. **Two weeks' notice must be given for all Baptism bookings.****The Baptism Course:** Places must be booked through the Parish Office. **Next Course: Wednesday 12th August at 7.30 pm. in the Committee Room.****DEATH**

We extend our sympathy to the McCallion family circle on the death of Jimmy McCallion, Finvola Park. May he rest in peace.

LEGION OF MARYThe Legion of Mary hopes to organise a Day Pilgrimage to Knock Shrine on **Sun. 28th Sept.**, subject to sufficient interest.If you would like to travel, please register your interest by texting **Mary McKnight** on **07548 887 853**, or by leaving your name with the Parish Office. The approximate bus fare will be **£25 per person.****VOCATIONS**

For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"

S.V.P. HELPLINE 079 2792 9923**PARISH PILGRIMAGE TO LOURDES -
PETITIONS**As our Parish Pilgrimage to Lourdes begins on **Monday 10th August**, parishioners are welcome to send their petitions to Our Lady.If you would like your petition(s) to be taken to Lourdes, please place them in a sealed envelope and post them into **Fr Sweeney's** post-box before **9.00 pm. on Sunday 9th August.****ALTAR SERVER - ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH**

If there are any children (In P5 and those who made their First Communion) who would like to be an Altar Server. Please make contact with Fr. Sweeney.

KEVIN LYNCH H.C.Lotto no's: 16, 22, 23 & 24. Lucky dip: Bridget O'Kane. Jackpot: £2,075. *Bingo: Fridays 8.00 pm. in Wanes World.***PARISH OFFICE****Will be CLOSED on Tuesday
Thursday and Friday.**

Please have all notices for the bulletin in the parish office by Wednesday lunchtime. Thank you.

**THE NATIONAL NOVENA TO OUR LADY
OF KNOCK**Takes place at Knock Shrine from Thursday 13th - Friday 21st August 2026. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3.00 pm. and 8.00 pm. with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days.This year's theme is "**Sheltered in God's Love.**" See the full programme at:<https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/>**JOB OPPORTUNITY, DERRY
DIOCESAN TRUST:**Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours per week), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Rd., Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr. - £13.50 per hr. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or Tel: 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St. Eugene's Cathedral, Francis St., Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24th August 2026.**SOCIAL DANCING GROUP**Thank you to all who supported our recent afternoon Tea Dance, (Wanes World) in aid of local charities. Looking forward to seeing you all again at our next Tea Dance on Wed. 16th September. All welcome.**HOPE SUMMER CAMP - THANK YOU**

The HOPE Summer Camp Committee would like to sincerely thank our parish community for your generosity during our recent weekend collection. Your support helps make our camp possible and is greatly appreciated.

We also extend our heartfelt thanks to all parishioners for your patience and understanding throughout camp week, as our young people participated in services and activities in and around the church. We appreciate that this may have caused some disruption, and we are grateful for your encouragement and support as we help our young people grow in faith, friendship and community.

A special word of thanks to **Fr. Sweeney & Fr. Kelly** for helping us celebrate our faith throughout the week. We are also very grateful to **Annie Jo, Geraldine, Louise and Laura** for taking the time to prepare the chapel facilities and ensure everything was ready for our young people.

Finally, thank you to our entire parish community for your continued generosity, support and prayers. Your kindness enables HOPE Summer Camp to provide a memorable and faith-filled experience for the young people of our parish. We are truly grateful.

Nineteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time (Year A)

Errigal Parish News - 9th August 2026

Weekday Masses: St. Mary's Church: - Monday, and Tuesday. **Assumption Vigil** - Friday at 7pm.

St. Joseph's Church: - Wednesday at 10am. **Assumption Day** - Saturday at 10am.

St. Mary's Church - (Vigil): Anniversary Mass -

Month's Mind Mass: For Dessie Judge on Sunday 16th August at 10am.

St. Joseph's Church - (Vigil) - Anniversary Mass: For Susan O'Hagan on Saturday 8th August at 6pm.

Month's Mind Mass: For Damian O'Kane on Sunday 2nd August at 11.30am.

Saturday Vigil Mass 6pm - St. Joseph's Church in August.

Eucharistic Adoration: - Adoration on Monday after Mass until 2.30pm.

.....

Parish Newsletter: There will be no printed parish newsletter for the next few weeks. Parish notices will be available on the parish Facebook page and the website.

Parish Mission: Parishioners may have heard that the parish will hold a mission in September of this year. It will be delivered by the Dominican Order. As you know it has been some time since the last Mission in the parish. Whilst members of the Parish Pastoral Group continue to organise it, it would be helpful to have a few interested individuals from each end of the parish to help with the organisation. Time commitment should not be great - a few hours between now and September and some input during the week itself. This is a great opportunity to get involved in a significant event for the parish, and if you are interested, please contact Fr. Crowley.

Parish Mission - Sunday 27th September - Friday 2nd October.

Errigal: Through Our Eyes - Summer Youth Photography Project: Starting Monday 6th July, all young people under 18 are invited to join Errigal: Through Our Eyes, a summer photography project. The theme is "See what matters. See where God is." This will celebrate the beauty, faith, kindness, and everyday life of our parish.

Pick up an entry form, then send up to three photos taken within the parish boundaries and a short reflection to the parish email (with parent/guardian consent for under 16s). Entries close Sunday 9th August at 9pm. There are 1st, 2nd and 3rd place prizes in both Primary and Secondary categories, with certificates for everyone. Winners will be announced/celebrated on Saturday 15th August after Vigil Mass in Glenullin.

Parish Collections - Thank you. 184 boxes of envelopes in circulation.

Standing Orders for July (in brackets)

Returns (Pink/Yellow - 112 White - 82)

St. Mary's - Parish: £685 (£646.50) Renovation: £270 (£83)

St. Joseph's - Parish: £535 (£1247) Renovation: £630 (£1025)

Ballerin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 3, 10, 22, 29. Jackpot is £2100. Lucky Dip Winner £50 - Mary T. Bradley.

Glenullin GAA Lotto: There was no winner of the lotto jackpot the numbers are 8, 23, 25, 30. Jackpot £10,000. £25 winners - Majella McCloskey, Carol Hunter, Damian Hasson, and Anna McGuigan.

Readers & Eucharistic Ministers

St. Mary's Church - Church Readers - 15th/16th August

Saturday Vigil -

Sunday Morning - Paul Mullan.

If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Mary's Church, please give your name to Fr. Crowley training will be provided.

Eucharistic Ministers - 15th/16th August

Saturday Vigil -

Sunday Morning - Josephine McKeown & Gillian O'Neill.

.....

Readers & Eucharistic Ministers

St. Joseph's Church - Church Readers - 15th/16th August

Saturday Vigil - Nadine McNicholl.

Sunday Morning - Mairead McNicholl.

If anyone is interested in becoming a Reader in St. Joseph's Church, please give your name to Fr. Crowley or Mairead McNicholl (Lector Co-Ordinator), training will be provided.

Eucharistic Ministers - 15th/16th August

Saturday Vigil - Clare Mullan & Meabh Close.

Sunday Morning - Grainne O'Kane Declan McNicholl.

Gift Aid/Census Cards: Can we please request the return of Gift Aid and Census cards recently circulated so that parish records can be updated during the summer months.

Monday Adoration Adorers: We request if you are available on Monday from after the morning Mass to participate in the rota for Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament which takes place until 2.30pm. If interested, please leave your name/contact number in the sacristy and we will follow up.

Feasts during the Week: Monday - St. Lawrence: He died in 258, is seen as a cheerful giver since he was one of the seven deacons of the Roman Church in charge of the material needs of the faithful. Gifted with a sense of humour, he met his death cheerfully on a gridiron. He is patron saint of the poor. **Tuesday - St. Clare:** Born in Assisi in 1193, died in 1253. She followed St. Francis in his life of poverty and was founder and ruler of the Poor Clares. She led an austere life, abounding in works of piety and charity. **Wednesday - St. Jane Frances de Chantal (1572 - 1641):** At the age of twenty married Baron de Chantal but after nine years she was left a widow with four children. Her friendship with St. Francis de Sales led to the foundation of the Congregation of the Visitation. **Thursday - St. Fachtna:** Founder of the monastery of Ross Carbery (Ross Ailithir). He died around 600. His monastery became the principal monastery of west Cork and later had a famous Scripture school. **Friday - St. Maximilian Kolbe: (1894 - 1941)** A Conventual Franciscan who worked in the apostolate of the press in Poland and Japan and died in Auschwitz. **Saturday - Solemnity of the Assumption:** Honours the fullness that was her destiny, the glorification of her immaculate soul and virginal body that completely conformed her to the risen Christ. This is a celebration that offers to the Church and to all humanity an exemplar and a consoling message, teaching us the fulfilment of our highest hopes. Their own future glorification is happily in store for all those whom Christ has made his own brothers and

sisters by taking on their flesh and blood. (Marialis Cultus) Patronal Day of France, India, Malta and Paraguay.

Diocesan Vocations: For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"

For further information, please contact the Diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, at pgoh2111@gmail.com

The Net: As always, it features a wide variety of news, interesting and inspiring interviews, articles, and photos from parishes across the diocese. You can read the Diocesan newspaper on-line at. or a paper copy is available at the back of the church. Donations welcome.

Church Safeguarding: If you have any concerns regarding Safeguarding children or vulnerable adults in need of protection within the Church please contact: Mrs Marie O'Kane (DLP) on 07596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org (Designated Liaison Person), Diocesan Pastoral Centre, 164 Bishop Street, Derry. - Or PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 or Social Services Tel: 02871-314090.

Parish Representatives - Tracey McGilligan and Clare Mullan.

St. Joseph's Church: We present a dual gauge to initiative funds in our parish for the on-going costs associated with the renovation of St. Joseph's Church. The gauge on the left indicates the funds we require to complete the refurbishment. The gauge on the right reflects the loans we have received from other parishes. (Gauge also available on website and Facebook page). Thanks - Donations - Current figure £235.000.00.

Sick Visitation: Fr. Crowley will attend the sick in his care on Thursday in the morning in Glenullin and the afternoon in Ballerin/Garvagh.

Errigal Parish Bingo: On Sunday 27th July at 8pm. Sponsors for future autumn months would be greatly appreciated. Contact Charlie or Brian on 29558225.

St. Mary's - August Altar Society: Lee-Ann McKay, Louise Mullan, Bernie McGilligan, and Gemma Faulkner.

St. Mary's - August Collectors - (Sunday) Seamus O'Kane & Charlie O'Kane.

St. Joseph's - August Altar Society: Emma Niblock, Jane Leadon and Orla Mullan.

St. Joseph's - August Counters: Keith and Katherine Anderson and Margaret Rose Hasson.

St. Joseph's August Collectors: (Vigil) Gerard McCloskey and Kieran Quigg.

(Sunday) Shane O'Kane and Gerard O'Kane Snr.

Baptism Dates: The next Baptism dates are Saturday 8th August in St. Mary's Church at 4.30pm and St. Joseph's Church on Sunday 16th August at 12.30pm. The Baptismal Programme for parents/guardians will take place in the Parochial House on Wednesday 5th August at 7pm. Please register to attend the Baptismal Programme by Saturday 1st August using the parish email address, this will indicate to the Baptismal Team the numbers who will attend the Baptismal Programme.

Parish Readers/Eucharistic Ministers: If you are unable to attend the schedule allocated to you, it would be much appreciated if you can get a replacement to step in for you. (It may be possible to exchange a rotation with another group member - there is also the opportunity to seek cover via the Whatsapp messaging facility if available to your group). I also ask Readers please to conclude the readings with - '**The Word of the Lord**' as directed in the Missalette, and not 'This is the Word of the Lord' as stated in the Lectionary. We have previously discussed this at our reader meetings.

DEATHS Your prayers are asked for Liam Grant, Gollan, Fahan, and Paddy McGrory, Tooban. We pray for their families and friends saddened by their loss.
ADORATION IN ST MURA’S PARISH CHURCH on Friday after the 10am Mass. All welcome. PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!" YOUTH 2000 SUMMER FESTIVAL 13th–16th August Calling all young people aged 16–35! Join us at the Youth 2000 Summer Festival in Newbridge College, Co. Kildare. This is a donation-only event, with free buses available across the country and all meals included. Expect inspiring talks and workshops, Mass, music, prayer, and plenty of opportunities to chill out and meet other young Catholics. Whether you are new to the faith or looking to be refreshed, all are welcome. To register or find out more, visit youth2000.ie or follow @Youth2000Ireland. MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND hosted by Marriage Encounter Ireland takes place at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare, from Fri 2 to Sun 4 October. This is not a retreat in the traditional sense but is a positive, joy-filled experience, guided by presenting couples and a priest, in an atmosphere of warmth, prayer, and deep Christian faith. Couples are invited to register online at www.marriageencounter.ie EMBRACE THE GRACE Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026 - Legion of Mary: 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. This event is on Sat 30 August from 9.30am to 6pm with a social afterwards. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed towards deusetpatria@gmail.com. DONEGAL PRO LIFE Annual Church Gate Collection is on Sat.15th /Sun 16th Aug countywide. If you can help in taking up a collection it would be appreciated. Contact Margaret on 0892469599 ABIDE IN HIS LOVE WOMENS CONFERENCE The Great Northern Hotel, Bundoran, 20–22 Nov. Join women from across Ireland for a faith-filled weekend with inspiring speakers including Sarah Swafford, Danielle Noonan, Fr Mark Wharton, Fr Barry Braum, Fr Oisín Martin, the Dominican Sisters of Nashville, Bishop Fintan Gavin, and more. A conference not to be missed! Register now: https://abideinhislove.eventbrite.com/ THE NATIONAL NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF KNOCK takes place at Knock Shrine from Thursday 13 to Friday 21 August. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3pm and 8pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days. This year’s theme is “Sheltered in God’s Love.” See the full programme at: https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/ DONEGAL DOWN SYNDROME ASSOCIATION Annual church-gate collection will take place on the weekend of 29 /30 Aug. Anyone interested in helping on the day can contact the Donegal Down Syndrome Association office by email at info@donegal.downsyndrome.ie or call 0857870075. Your financial support for this important fundraising event would be greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down Syndrome and their families across Donegal. BURT BINGO every Tuesday in St. Marys Hall, Burt at 9pm. BURT GAA LOTTO 14-15-17-23-24 Maureen Doherty and Sean Doherty €50 each LINE DANCING CLASS in St. Mary’s Hall Burt every Thursday at 7.30pm. €7 per class. SWILLY CEP are looking, for grounds worker for Burt, Inch and Fahan graveyard. For information ring 0879392767 A FEAST OF FOLK MUSIC every Tuesday at 8pm. Song, story and Irish dance in the Cairn Greencastle Tel 074 9381104
PRIVACY NOTICE: The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A Privacy Notice is available on the Parish Website or by contacting The Parish Office. Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in St Mura’s Church and St Aengus’ are available online. Parishioners should note that the first two rows of seats are visible online for both Churches.

http://www.fahanparish.com		
Weekly Collection Burt €1052 Inch €314 Fahan €1215 <i>Sincere Thanks</i>	fahanparish@derrydiocese.org www.fahanparish.com 9th August 2026 Nineteenth Sunday In Ordinary Time	Fr Bradley 9363455 Fr Baker 9360151 Parish Office 9360151 (Mon-Thurs 10am-12:30pm)
Mass Schedule		
<u>St. Aengus' Burt</u> (churchservices.tv/burt) Monday 10 Aug Mass at 10am Friday 14th Aug Mass at 6:30pm Saturday 15th Aug Mass at 6.30pm Sunday 16th Aug Mass at 10.15am <u>Our Lady of Lourdes, Inch</u> Saturday 15th Aug Mass at 9am Sunday 16th Aug Mass at 9am	<u>St Mura's Church, Fahan</u> (churchservices.tv/fahan) Wednesday 12th Aug NO MASS Thursday 13th Aug Mass at 7pm Willie McLaughlin Month Mind Mass Friday 14th Aug Mass at 10am Saturday 15th Aug Mass at 11am Sunday 16th Aug Mass at 11:30am <u>Chapel Of Ease, Fahan</u> Thursday 13th Aug Mass at 10am	
<u>PLEASE NOTE THERE IS NO 7PM MASS ON WEDNESDAY EVENING IN ST MURA'S CHURCH FAHAN</u>		
<u>THE FEAST OF THE ASSUMPTION</u> ST AENGUS' CHURCH, BURT, VIGIL MASS FRIDAY 14TH AUGUST AT 6.30PM OUR LADY OF LOURDES, INCH, SATURDAY 15TH AUGUST MASS AT 9AM ST MURA'S CHURCH, FAHAN, SATURDAY 15TH AUGUST MASS AT 11AM		
<u>JOB OPPORTUNITIES</u> Derry Diocesan Trust - Clonmany Parish: Administrative & Financial Officer. Hours of work: 9 hours per week. This is a job-share role. Place of work: Parish House, Clonmany. For full details and application pack, email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org . Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12noon Tuesday 11 August 2026. Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours per week), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 048 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24 August 2026. <i>Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.</i>		
<u>SAFEGUARDING NOTICE:</u> If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding Children or adults in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) at 0044 7596500793, or at dlp@derrydiocese.org or Garda Sióchána , Buncrana 074 9320540 Letterkenny HQ 074 9167100 or TUSLA Family & Child Agency 07491 02233		

Rev. Chris McDermott. Adm.

Tel: (028) 79401236

Email: christopher.mcdermott@derrydiocese.org

www.granaghanparish.com

MASS TIMES FOR THE

COMING WEEK:

Monday, Wednesday & Friday Mass

at 09:15am

Saturday (Vigil) at 4pm

Sunday Mass at 11am

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? *We would like to help you.* Please pick up your phone and make contact - Tel: 028 7135 1329.

.....
The National Novena to Our Lady of Knock
Takes place at Knock Shrine from
Thursday 13 to Friday 21 August 2026.
Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at
3.00pm and 8.00pm,
With workshops and guided prayer sessions also
taking place throughout the nine days.
This year's theme is "Sheltered in God's Love."

.....
See the full programme:
<https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/>
.....

Adult Céili Dancing - Fitness, Fun, Friendship
The Marian Hall, Kilrea
Further Details - 07821054402
Wednesday Evenings, 7pm - £5.00 per week

A fun way to keep active, learn Céili dancing & meet new people.

EVERYONE WELCOME

No need to book - Just come along.



Nineteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Sunday 9th August 2026

PARISH OF GRANAGHAN

St Vincent De Paul Helpline: 07927900310

We welcome
Eva Vera Devine
as a member of God's Family



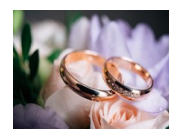
We welcome
Conor Michael McCready
as a member of God's Family



We welcome
Aisling Ellen Brolly
as a member of God's Family



.....
CONGRATULATIONS to
James Mellon & Mary Ann Tohill
on your recent wedding
Saturday 8th August 2026
.....



GRANAGHAN & DISTRICT WOMEN'S GROUP

We are delighted to confirm that we will be delivering three sessions of **Mat-based Pilates** and three of **Chair-based Pilates** with local tutor, Janette, **Thursdays AUGUST: 13th, 20th and 27th.** **Mat-based at 9.30 and Chair-based at 10.40ish.** Three places currently available for both sessions but you need to be quick!
Ann McNicholl to enquire / book: 07714757643

KENYA SCHOOL AID PROJECT - Annual Carn Walk on Sunday 16th August at 12 noon. Meeting at **Cotters Row Car Park** before walking the **CARN MOUNTAIN** to support 2 local men travelling to remote Kenya - **September 2026** to build toilet blocks & carry out much needed repairs at **NARA MURO NATIONAL SCHOOL** - Your support is greatly appreciated. Organisers: Pat Mullan & Aidan McGlade - <https://gofund.me/0137727FG>

.....
For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!" **Fr. Pat O'Hagan**
.....

An Carn

Film Screening: TRAD - An Carn is delighted to present **Trad** as part of the **Fleadh at Queen's** programme. This crowd-pleasing film will be screened in **An Coire**; and join us afterwards for a session of Traditional Irish music. Free refreshments for all musicians! **Date: Friday 14 August. Doors at 6:30pm. Cost: £5.**

Live Music: Na Leanai - The children and grandchildren of the **Sands Family**, a name synonymous with **Irish folk music** for generations, are joining us at **An Coire** for a special night of music you don't want to miss!
Date: Saturday 12 September. Doors at 7pm. Cost: £16. Under 16s: Free

Drumnaph Nature Reserve

Forest Bathing - Join us at Drumnaph for an immersive experience through **guided sensory meditations**, reconnect with the natural world and weave yourself back into nature!

Date: Saturday 29 August. Time: 10am - 12pm. Cost: £10

Weekly Collection for Sunday 2nd August 2026 - Weekly: £1,515.09



for your generous support

GREENLOUGH PARISH. Mass Schedule/Notices: 10 to 16 August**GREENLOUGH****Tuesday 11 August:** 9.30am Mass; 7.30pm: Rosary**Thursday 13 August:** 9.00am - 5.00pm Adoration**Twentieth Sunday in Ordinary Time****Saturday 15 August:** 5.30pm (*Streamed to Bellaghy*)

Bishop McKeown will be the main celebrant of the 5.30pm Mass in Clady on Saturday 15 August, and will bless the New Grotto afterwards. *We invite you all to join us after the Blessing for refreshments in the Bann Valley Hall.*

Sunday 16 August: 11.00am (*Streamed from Bellaghy*)**BELLAGHY****Wednesday 12 August:** 9.30am**Friday 14 August** Adoration 10am - 8pm; Rosary at 7.30pm**Saturday 15 August:** 5.30pm (*Streamed from Greenlough*)**Sunday 16 August:** 11.00am (*Streamed to Greenlough*)**BALLYSCULLION****Sunday 16 August:** 9.45am**Feast of The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary****Friday 14 August:** Greenlough - 6.45pm; Ballyscullion - 8.00pm**Saturday 15 August:** Bellaghy - 10.00am

Anniversaries: Bishop Edward Daly, Fr. Isaac McCready, Maura Clarke, Mary Marron, Kathleen Boyle, Ann Cushnahan, Jennie Kearney, James Joseph Kearney, Patrick Toner

Vocations: For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"

Collections: 2/08/2026. Weekly/Mthly/Cash: £1255.60; July Standing Orders: £950.

Collection Counters: we still need help with the counting of the collection in August.

Please contact, Fr. Pat, Declan in the Sacristy or email the parish office. Thank You.

No Printed Newsletter until the end of August: Please send Notices & Anniversaries in writing or via email to the parish office by 10.00am on Wednesday or leave into the Sacristy before Mass on Saturday night.

St Conor's College Kilrea Site: Couples, one of the official Uniform Suppliers will be in school on Tuesday 11 August from 9.30 - 3.00pm for the purchase of uniform. Alternatively, uniform is available from Tommie McGrath of Maghera.

Marriage Enrichment Weekend: Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit: www.marriageencounter.ie

Greenlough Parish Office is closed but you can contact us via phone: 028 2582 1190.

Email: greenloughparish@gmail.com or via Facebook.

OUR LADY OF MONTLIGEON PRAYER GROUP- praying for all the souls in Purgatory meets in Termonbacca, on the last Wednesday each month at 12:30pm. Also in St Joseph's Church Galliagh every Monday after 11am Mass.

RACHEL'S VINEYARD: Have you been hurt by abortion? Tel Michelle 07871765181.

GAMBLERS ANONYMOUS: Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

Accord Derry Marriage Preparation Workshops September 25th/26th November 20th/21st 2026 These courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com

'Embrace the Grace' Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026 - Legion of Mary: 'Embrace the Grace' is a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. This event takes place on Saturday 30 August from 9.30am to 6.00pm with a social afterwards. Tickets cost €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Any queries can be directed towards deusetpatria@gmail.com.

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND: Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

SAFEGUARDING Any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children and Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland emergency services PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland) 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker) Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust 028 9442 4459 Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 99

PRIVACY NOTICE The Diocese of Derry complies with GDPR regulations. A privacy notice is available on the Parish Website Live stream and recordings of Mass and Services in Holy Family Church are available on line. Parishioners should note that the first 2 rows of seats are visible on line.

HOLY FAMILY CHURCH



MASSES

Saturday Vigil 6.00pm

Sunday 9.30am, 11.00am, 12.30pm

Mon ,Wed ,Fri, Sat 10.00am Tues and Thurs 7.15pm

CONFESSIONS

Saturdays from 10.30am-11.30am & 5.15pm-5.50pm

Tues ,Thurs 6.45pm – 7.10pm

Divine Mercy 3pm Monday– Friday

BAPTISMS

Saturday at 4.30pm

MARRIAGES

Three months notice and marriage preparation necessary

PAROCHIAL HOUSE

71267070

1 Aileach Road Ballymagroarty BT48 0AZ

Email: office@holyfamily-parish.com

Website: www.holyfamily-parish.com

Webcam: Click on website and follow the links

Parish Office 9.45am-1.45pm Mon– Fri

Parish Priest:
Fr Joseph Gormley

Curate
Fr Kevin Mulhern

JESUS IS WITH US IN THE STORMS OF LIFE

Every Christian experiences storms. We naturally ask the Lord to remove our difficulties, yet the Gospel reveals that Jesus often offers something even greater: His presence. Rather than simply calming the storm around us, He seeks to deepen our trust in Him within it.

The greatest miracle in this Gospel is not that Jesus walked on water, nor even that Peter briefly did the same. The true miracle is that frightened, faltering disciples became worshippers who recognised Jesus as the Son of God.

Perhaps our prayer should be less, "Lord, make my life easier," and more, "Lord, whatever storm I must face, keep my eyes fixed on You." When we do stumble, as Peter did, we can be confident that Christ's saving hand is already reaching out to lift us up

FEAST OF THE ASSUMPTION Saturday is the Feast of the Assumption and is a holy day of obligation. Masses will be Vigil Mass on Friday at 7.15pm, Saturday 10am and 6.00pm Vigil Mass. Saturday Vigil Mass covers obligation for either Feast Day or Sunday but **NOT** both

ADORATION OF THE BLESSED SACRAMENT will not take place in August but will resume in September

BAPTISMS Our Parish family welcomes:

Finn Ryan McCleary St, Eithne's Pk, Leo Anthony McCartney, Templegrove
Eden Lura McNeil Grangewood Drive, Kadie Katherine Maguire Beraghvale

ANNIVERSARIES We pray for those whose anniversaries occur at this time Marian McMonagle, Eileen McDonagh, John Paul Stokes, Bishop Edward Daly, Fr Neal Carlin, Denis Hooper, Celine Doherty, Martin Tope, Frankie O'Donnell, Maureen O'Hagan, Philip McDermott

SUNDAY COLLECTION 2nd August £2310.40 Standing Orders £400 and €183.33 Thank you for your generosity

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT Fr Gormley wishes to acknowledge anonymous Donation of £500

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS TO THE DIOCESAN PRIESTHOOD For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"

LEGION OF MARY meets on Wednesday evenings at 5.45pm. Anyone willing to do Our Lady's work is asked to call Patricia on 02871417867

YOUTH 2000 SUMMER FESTIVAL | 13th–16th August Calling all young people aged 16–35! Join us at the Youth 2000 Summer Festival in Newbridge College, Co. Kildare. This is a donation-only event, with free buses available across the country and all meals included. Expect inspiring talks and workshops, Mass, music, prayer, and plenty of opportunities to chill out and meet other young Catholics. Whether you are new to the faith or looking to be refreshed, all are welcome. To register or find out more, visit youth2000.ie or follow @Youth2000Ireland.

THE NATIONAL NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF KNOCK takes place at Knock Shrine from Thursday 13 to Friday 21 August 2026. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3.00pm and 8.00pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days. This year's theme is "**Sheltered in God's Love**". See the full programme at: <https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/>

JOB OPPORTUNITY, DERRY DIOCESAN TRUST: Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours per week), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24 August

MARY'S MEALS – STEP BY STEP WALK Mary's Meals is currently feeding over 3 million children a daily school meal across 16 countries. Our Annual Step by Step to Feed the Next Child 2 Bridges walk (Foyle and Peace Bridges Derry) takes place today Sunday 9th of August. Starting Point is at Sainsbury's Car Park, Strand Road at 12 noon. All Welcome to participate even for a mile or two. For further details and to register online visit www.marysmeals.org.uk/step or contact Caoimhe on 07394564065.

A NEW BOOK IS BEING WRITTEN ABOUT FATHER PADDY O'KANE'S LIFE. Since his death in 2022, many stories have been shared about the impact Father Paddy had on so many people. The book, which is planned to be published next year, will combine stories about Father Paddy, along with his own words through the weekly column he wrote for the Derry News for many years. The author of the book, Ciaran O'Neill, is keen to hear from anyone who would like to share their story of Father Paddy. Ciaran can be contacted at caoneill1971@gmail.com or on 07875904354.

**IMPORTANT NOTICE - OUR DIOCESAN DESIGNATED PERSON
SAFEGUARDING REPRESENTATIVE IS: Marie O'Kane**

Telephone: (044)7596500793. Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

EXPOSITION OF THE BLESSED SACRAMENT: After the 10.00 a.m. Mass in Iskaheen on Tuesday until 2.00 p.m. **CHAPLET OF DIVINE MERCY:** After the 10.00 a.m. Mass in Muff on Wednesday.

PARISH DRAW RESULTS - WEEK 41: €300 - Patrick Doherty, Sappagh, €200 - Oran Hegarty, Sappagh, €100 - James Doherty, Iskaheen.

Community Employment Scheme - One Worker needed for Drung Graveyard. If you are interested in this position, please ring (074) 9385875 or 0863400163.

MOVILLE BRIDGE CLUB: Names are now being taken for bridge classes, commencing mid-September. To register for classes or for further information please contact Margaret on 086 3936255 as soon as possible.

The Men's Shed, Carn is hosting "DROP IN WEDNESDAYS" for men every Wednesday from 11.00 a.m. to 1.00 p.m. Email mens.shed.carn@gmail.com or call 0874611571.

DONEGAL DOWN SYNDROME ASSOCIATION Annual church-gate collection will take place on the weekend of 29/30 August. Anyone interested in helping on the day can contact the Donegal Down Syndrome Association office by email at info@donegal.downsyndrome.ie or telephone on 085 787 0075. Your financial support for this important fundraising event would be greatly appreciated and will help in continuing to provide vital services and supports to children and adults with Down syndrome and their families across Donegal.

**SIGNED MASS CARDS AND MASS BOUQUETS AVAILABLE IN
ISKAHEEN PAROCHIAL HOUSE AND DRUNG SACRISTY.**

To book Weddings, Baptisms, Month's Mind Masses, Anniversary Masses, contact Anne at the Parish Office on 9384037.

**PARISH OF ISKAHEEN
& UPPER MOVILLE**

Iskaheen, Drung & Muff Churches
(St. Patrick's, St. Columba's & Sacred Heart)

Nineteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Parish Priest: Fr. John Farren P.P. - Tel: 9384037
Parish Secretary: Mrs Anne Clarke 10.00 a.m. - 2.00 p.m.
(Tuesday to Friday - Tel: 9384037)
E-mail: iskaheenparish@derrydiocese.org
Websites: www.iskaheenparish.com & www.stcolumbasdrung.net
Live Streaming www.mcn.live
Scoil Naomh Fionán, Principal: Mr Patrick Patton - Tel: 9383228.
Scoil Naomh Bríd, Principal: Mr Gary Foster - Tel: 9384136.
(Drung Saint Vincent de Paul Telephone Number: 086 4079904)
(Muff Saint Vincent de Paul Telephone Number: 086 3040627)

9th August 2026 - Year A - Schedule for the Coming Week

MASS TIMES:	DRUNG	ISKAHEEN	MUFF
Saturday: (Vigil):	5.00 p.m.	-----	6.30 p.m.
Sunday: (Morning)	10.15 a.m.	9.00 a.m.	11.30 a.m.

DRUNG	ISKAHEEN	MUFF
Monday 10 th August: 10.00 a.m.	-----	-----
Tuesday 11 th August: -----	10.00 a.m.	-----
Wednesday 12 th August: -----	-----	10.00 a.m.
Thursday 13 th August: 10.00 a.m.	-----	-----
Friday 14 th August: 1.00pm / 5.00pm	-----	6.30 p.m.
Saturday 15 th August: 5.00 p.m.	10.00 a.m.	6.30 p.m.

CONFESSIONS: DRUNG Before 5.00 p.m. Mass on Saturday
CONFESSIONS: MUFF Before 6.30 p.m. Mass on Saturday

**NB THE NEXT ST. PEREGRINE NOVENA MASS & BLESSING
WITH THE RELIC WILL BE HELD ON FRIDAY 11th SEPTEMBER IN
ST. PATRICK'S CHURCH, ISKAHEEN AT 7.00 P.M.**

Parish of Kilrea & Desertohill

Rev. Christopher McDermott
Parish Secretary: Mrs Kim Convery



Nineteenth Sunday of The Year

9th August 2026

www.parishofkilrea.com

E-mail: parishofkilrea@btinternet.com

Facebook: *Parish of Kilrea & Desertohill*

Telephone: 028 29540343

Errigal: 028 29558251

Vigil Mass (Sat) 7pm at Saint Anne's Oratory – Sunday 10am at Drumagarner – Sunday 12noon at Craigavole

Weekday Masses

Monday, Thursday and Friday at 10am in Saint Anne's Oratory.

Sacrament of Reconciliation (Confessions) available each Saturday after 7pm Mass in St Anne's Oratory.

In Remembrance of

Susan McKendry, Murt McGill, Kathleen Judge, Helen Fidgeon and Ronnie O'Kane

whose anniversaries occur at this time.

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord.

St Conor's College Kilrea site: School Uniforms

Couples, one of the official Uniform Suppliers will be in school on Tuesday 11th August from 9.30 - 3.00pm for the purchase of uniform.

Alternatively, uniform is available from Tommie McGrath of Maghera.

Kilrea GAC News

Lottery result 30th July: 2, 20, 21, 24.

No Winner £3,700

£50– Odhran Darragh

Next Jackpot is £3,750.

Tickets on Klubfunder.

Last week's collection amounted to £2,150.

July Standing Orders £1,485.

Thank You

We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of **Frankie McEldowey (nee Diamond), Ballymoney** who died recently.
May she rest in peace and rise in glory

Adult Ceili Dancing every Wednesday at 7pm in The Marian Hall Kilrea
New members welcome No previous experience required Fun, Fitness & Friendship
No need to book, PAYG £5 per week.

Our parish family welcomes **Conn Emmett McCamphill, Orla Maeve McAllister & Patrick Eoghan Doherty** who were baptised recently.



May they always walk as children of the light!

Vocations Prayer: For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"

Readers for

15th Aug/ 16th Aug

7pm:

Sinead McAllister

10am:

Alice Kearney

12noon:

Pauline McKeefry

Eucharistic Adoration

Monday Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will pause during July & August for the summer break.

Weekly adoration resumes on Monday 7th September.

Mass Times
Sundays:
Vigil: 6.00pm
Morning:
9am & 11am

Weekdays:
Mon - Fri:
9.15am

Baptisms
Sundays
11.45am

Telephone
No's
Fr. Graham
028 7964 2458

Parish Office:
028 7964 2458

SVP Helpline
07596971627

St. Brigid's PS.
028 7964 2014

Lavey Early
Years
028 7964 5464

Neighbouring
Parishes

Maghera
Fr. Doherty
028 7964 2496

Kilrea
Fr. McDermott
028 2954 0343

JOB OPPORTUNITY, DERRY DIOCESAN TRUST

Administrative & Financial
Officer (18 hours per week),
Waterside Parish, Parochial
House, 32 Chapel Road,
Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per
hr - £13.50 per hr. For
application packs please
email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel **028
7126 2302**. Completed applications must be
returned to **Personnel, Bishop's House, St
Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48
9AP** or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org
no later than **12 noon Monday 24th August 2026**.

*Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal
Opportunities Employer.*

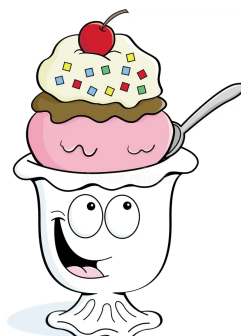


ICE-CREAM SUNDAY

*Saturday 5th &
Sunday 6th September*

*All Weekend Masses will be
celebrated in
Lavey/Termoneeny Centre.*

All Welcome!



Parish Details

Please have all Anniversaries
names & News Items in **by
1.00 pm on WEDNESDAY**
this week.



The Parish Office is open
Monday - Thursday from 10.00 am.

Thank-You



Lavey Parish

Tel: (028) 7964 2458

E-Mail: laveyparish@derrydiocese.org

Web: www.laveyparish.com



Jesus said to his disciples: **"Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid."** Fear is identified in the Scriptures as the single greatest enemy of life and love. It affects everything we do and everything we hope for. Courage, on the other hand, is one of the qualities we most need to develop if we are to live and love and hope to the full. It takes courage for any woman and man to pledge their love for the rest of their lives in marriage. It takes even more courage to live that out any way fully. It takes courage for parents to have children and even more so to bring them up to be people of hope and confidence. And it takes courage to believe in Christ and to live out that belief in everyday life. This kind of courage, for the sake of all that is best in our lives, means making decisions that are in favour of what we hold dear. These decisions can often mean denying ourselves things for a greater good. They can also mean going against the norm that is around us.

Father Johnny Doherty, C.Ss.R.



Monday 10th August **9.15 am Mass**
 Wednesday 12th August **9.15 am Mass**
 Thursday 13th August **9.15 am Mass**
 Friday 14th August **9.15 am Mass**

Adoration will begin *after morning Mass*
 and conclude at **5.00 pm.**



Feast of the Assumption

Saturday 15th August **9.15 am Mass**

20th Sunday in Ordinary Time

Saturday 15th August **5:15 pm - 5:45 pm - Confessions**
6:00 pm Mass

Sunday 16th August **9:00 pm Mass**
11:00 am Mass

Sick and the Housebound

Fr. Graham will attend the sick and the
 housebound this **Wednesday 12th and**
Thursday 13th August.



Sunday 9th August - 19th Sunday in Ordinary Time

Feasts during the Week

Monday 10th August

St Lawrence

Tuesday 11th August

St Clare

Friday 14th August

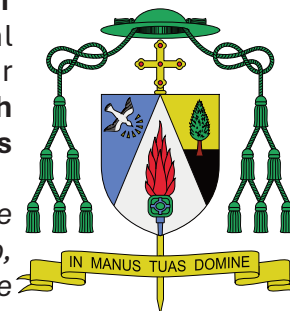
St Maximilian Kolbe



Installation of Bishop Michael Router

The celebration of Mass for the Episcopal
 Installation of Bishop Michael Router as our
 new Bishop will take place on **Sunday 20th**
September at 3.00 pm in St. Eugene's
Cathedral, Derry.

*Let us keep Bishop Router in our prayers as he
 begins this important ministry of leadership,
 service, and pastoral care throughout the
 diocese.*



Lavey Parish St. Vincent de Paul

School holidays can be stressful for many
 families, especially in these times of rising
 household costs. Back-to-school expenses
 can also add to the pressure on families. If
 you feel we can be of assistance in such
 situations, please contact us on our helpline
07596971627 and leave a message.
 Someone will get back to you in confidence.



Parish Collections: Sunday 2nd August

Weekly: **£1,136.50**

Building: **£1,005.00**

Loose Coin: **£500.43**

Thank you for your continued support!



**Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Eighteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 2nd August 2026**

Parish Clergy

Fr Michael McCaughey, PP: (028) 71882274 / (028) 71882215

Fr Declan Boland (priest in residence)

Email: leckpatrickparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.leckpatrickparish.com

Email: strabaneparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.camusparish.com

Email: clonleighparish@derrydiocese.org; **Website:** www.clonleighparish.com

Thoughts on the Gospel (Matthew 14:13-21)

The miracle of the loaves and fishes began with **compassion**. Jesus first noticed the crowd's pain before providing for their hunger. In our busy lives, God invites us to see those who are lonely, discouraged, or forgotten. Even small acts of kindness can become someone's miracle.

The disciples focused on what they lacked, yet Jesus asked them to offer what they *did* have. God rarely asks for what we do not possess. When we offer our time, talents, and resources — however small — He multiplies them in ways we cannot imagine.

Before the food was shared, Jesus surrendered everything to the Father. We too carry burdens that feel heavy, but surrender is not giving up; it is trusting God with our limitations. What seems insufficient to us becomes more than enough in His hands. The abundance left over reminds us that God's blessings are meant to flow *through* us. When we share generously, encourage others, and forgive freely, His grace continues to multiply.

***Lord, fill us with compassion, use what little we offer, and multiply it for Your glory.
Teach us to trust You and to share Your blessings generously. Amen.***

Monthly Mass in Honour of St Pio will be celebrated on Wednesday 5th August at 7.00 pm in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane. We ask God's blessing on all through the intercession of St Pio. Everyone welcome.

Due to the Current Holiday Period, we wish to notify parishioners that there will be no newsletter until 22nd/23rd August. Apologies for any inconvenience. The office will be open as follows for the following two weeks: 10 am - 2 pm, Monday - Friday. Normal hours will resume on Monday 17th August.

The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Saturday 15th August is the Feast of the Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary and is a holy day of obligation. On this feast, we recall Mary's role in the life of Jesus and in salvation. Mass times for the holy day are as follows:

Vigil Mass on Friday 14th August at 6.30 pm in Immaculate Conception Church

Mass on Saturday 15th August at 8.30 am in Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

Mass on Saturday 15th August at 10.00 am in St Patrick's Church, Murlog.

Masses at the usual times on the evening of Saturday 15th & Sunday 16th August.

Prayer at Time of Exam Results

Dear Lord, in this moment of uncertainty, I seek Your peace and guidance.
Help me to accept the results of my efforts with grace, whether they meet my hopes or not. Grant me the strength to learn and grow from this experience, trusting in Your plan for my life. May I find comfort in Your love and wisdom.
May Your peace fill my heart as I walk forward in faith. Amen.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of Harry Mullen, Victoria Rd, Strabane; Bernie Greene, Tipperary.

Anniversaries Tony Boggs, Joseph Colhoun, Willie Curran, May Doherty, Johnny Forbes, Charlie Gallagher, Johnny Gallagher, Kevin Gallagher, Mary Gallagher, Nellie Gallagher, David Kennedy, Susan Lafferty, Anne Maguire, Bernard McDermott, Laurence McDermott, Emmett McGhee, Thomas McGranaghan, James O'Neill, Martin Stevenson, Vincent Sweeney, James McDermott (60th anniversary), Margaret McCay, Anna Morgan. May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:

Leckpatrick: £1,372.61;

Clonleigh: €1,925.66;

Camus: £1,420.06.

Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 9th August:

1st Reading: First Kings 19: 9a, 11-13a

Psalm: 85: 9, 10, 11-12, 13-14

2nd Reading: Romans 9: 1-5

Gospel: Matthew 14: 22-33

Readings 15th August (Feast of the Assumption):

1st Reading: Revelation 11: 19a; 12: 1-6a, 10ab

Psalm: 45:10,11,12,16

2nd Reading: 1st Corinthians 15:20-27;

Gospel: Luke 1:39-56

Readings for Sunday 16th August:

1st Reading: Isaiah 56: 1, 6-7

Psalm: 67: 2-3, 5, 6, 8

2nd Reading: Romans 11: 13-15, 29-32

Gospel: Matthew 15: 21-28

Readings for Sunday 23rd August:

1st Reading: Isaiah 22:19-23

Psalm: 137:1-3, 6, 8

2nd Reading: Romans 11:33-36

Gospel: Matthew 16:13-20

Saints of The Coming Week:

Tuesday: St John Vianney, priest;

Wed: The Dedication of the Basilica of St Mary Major in Rome;

Thurs: The Transfiguration of the Lord;

Fri: St Cajetan, priest; St Sixtus II, pope, & companions, martyrs;

Sat: St Dominic, priest

Embrace the Grace Legion of Mary Young Adult (18-40) Catholic Conference takes place on Sat 29th August from 9.30 am - 6 pm at De Montfort House, Morning Star Ave, Dublin, D07 VA03. Tickets from www.eventbrite. Search Embrace the Grace.

Pope's Prayer Intention for August *For evangelisation in the city*

Let us pray that in large cities often marked by anonymity and loneliness we find new ways to proclaim the Gospel, discovering creative paths to build community.

Rosary on the Coast takes place today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm at Lisfannon Beach, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn children. Everyone welcome.

Give Blood, Save Lives NI Blood Transfusion Service will collect blood donations at Lisneal College, 70 Crescent Link, Derry, BT47 5FQ on 4th August from 1230 pm - 4.00 pm & 5.00 pm - 7.30 pm. Please freecall 08085534653 to book.

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw to ensure Station Island remains open for future generations. Single ticket: €10. Book of 6: €50. Buy a full book and you're entered into a sellers' draw. Return a complete book for Early Bird draws on 28/8/26. Tickets from www.loughderg.org/store/c3/annualdraw or +353 (0) 719861518 or info@loughderg.org Prizes: 1st: €10,000, 2nd: €5,000, 3rd: €2,000, 4th: €1,500, 5th: €1,000, 6th: €500. Draw date: 23rd October 2026.

Job Opportunity Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of Administrative & Financial Officer at Clonmany Parish. 9 hours pw. For application pack, please contact Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP, 02871262302 or recruitment@derrydiocese.org Closing date: 11th August 2026.

Franciscan Friary, Rossnowlagh Monthly Healing Service today (Sunday). Rosary at 2.45 pm followed by Mass / Healing Service at 3 pm. Confessions 2 - 5 pm.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Courses available at www.accordni.com

Monthly Mass in Memory of Sr Clare Crockett will be celebrated on Sunday 9th August at 7 pm in Carmelite Retreat Centre, Termonbacca, Derry.

Pray for Vocations We pray for men called to priesthood. Like Jesus in today's gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, hungry, most vulnerable or those in need, but always reflect the love of Christ as they nourish and strengthen them with the Word of God. Visit <https://derryvocations.org>

A Day of Healing & Prayer in the House of Prayer, Clonfert with Eddie Stone on Sat 15th August. A bus leaves Letterkenny, collecting people in Ballybofey and Donegal Town. A priest will accompany the group. Please contact 0863936547.

Sharing the Good News Visit <https://theway.ie/ezine-2/> for the weekly ezine.

Sean Davis 4 Day Outdoor Summer Fun Soccer Academy takes place at Templemore Sports Complex, Derry from 4th - 7th August. Boys and girls aged 5 - 18 welcome. Times: 10 am - 3 pm. Please contact Sean on 07787791880.

Youth 2000 Festival | 13th–16th August Calling all young people (16 - 35). Join us in Newbridge College, Kildare. Free buses. All meals included. Inspiring talks, workshops, Mass, music, prayer, and plenty of opportunities to chill out and meet other young Catholics. Visit youth2000.ie or follow @Youth2000Ireland

Family Carers Ireland are running 1:1 support clinics remotely every Tuesday in August for carers, offering you a space and time to talk over the phone in the comfort of your own home. Contact 0868363842 or Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Lough Derg As the **3 Day Pilgrimage** season draws to a close soon (final day to start is 13th August), our **Day Retreats** recommence on August 18, 22, 23, 29 & 31 and September 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20. Take time away from the busyness of life for a day of guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal in the peaceful surroundings of Lough Derg. Booking essential. Please visit www.loughderg.org

Mary's Meals Annual Step by Step Walk takes place on Sunday 9th August at 12 noon from Sainsbury's car park, Strand Rd, Derry, walking around the Foyle Bridge & Peace Bridge. All welcome, even for a mile or two. Mary's Meals currently feeds over 3 million children a daily school meal across 16 countries. For further details / to register, please visit www.marysmeals.org.uk/step or contact Caoimhe on 07394564065. Please keep all our walkers in your prayers.

Donegal Pro Life Annual Church Gate Collection takes place on Saturday 15th / Sunday 16th August countywide. If you can help in taking up a collection, it would be appreciated. Please contact Margaret on 00353892469599. Míle buíochas.

The Monthly Pro Life Witness / Gathering takes place at the roundabout at Letterkenny Hospital on Friday 7th August from 1 pm - 2 pm. All welcome.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8 pm in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St. All welcome.

Termonbacca Derry Anam Óg Summer Scheme for those aged 8 - 14 takes place from 3rd - 7th August from 12 - 4 pm daily. Faith, friendship, arts and crafts, adventures, games and prayer. Please email termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Walk in Our Patron Saint's Footsteps St Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk, Downpatrick with guides Martina Purdy & Elaine Kelly on **8th August 9 am - 3 pm** Cost (£55). Tel 028 44619000. Visit www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Reflections Through Poetry book by Fr John P Forbes available in Pastoral Office. Cost: £10. Proceeds to Children in Crossfire and Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation.

Parish Bingo & Lucky Four A warm welcome to all to St Pat's Hall every Thursday at 8 pm. Come along for some fun, excitement and slight competition.

Strabane / Leckpatrick Draw July 2026

Prize	Winner	Promoter
£2,000	Philomena & Bosco Gallagher	Siobhan McDevitt
£1,000	Pat Gallagher	Sadie Kerlin
£500	Fr Paul Farren	Fr Michael
£500	Conal Doherty	Colette McKane
£250	Paddy Quinn	Fr Michael
£250	Brian Devine	Gabrielle Dooher
£100	Finola Kerr	Nuala Kerr
£100	Laura Burke	Paul Mullen
£100	Steven Casey	Paul Mullen
£100	Mary Barrett	Patsy Barrett
£100	Sarah McMichael	Ann McCrory

Congratulations to all the winners. Thank you for your support.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: **8.30 am** (2nd August - alternate Sundays - 16th August)

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: **8.30 am** (9th August - alternate Sundays - 23rd August)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes.

Office hours: Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am - 12.30 pm.

Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.

Fr. Patrick Doherty 79642496 / Fr. Kieran O'Doherty 79642359
 Sacristans: Glen 79643131/Maghera 79643061 Web Cam www.mcnmedia.live
 Baptisms: 79642983(Notification by Thursday) Pastoral Centre:79642983
 Pilgrim Statue: 79642983 / St Vincent de Paul Helpline: 07752111032
 PARISH FACEBOOK PAGE – www.facebook.com/magheraparish

It's a useful way to stay up to date with all our parish events. Please hit the 'Follow' button and we would be grateful if you could like and share our posts.

Sunday:	St Patrick's	9.30am
	St Mary's	Vigil 6.30am and Sunday 11.30am
		Wednesday 7.30pm and Friday 10.00am
Daily Mass	St Patrick's	Monday to Thursday 9.30am
		Friday 7.30pm (Mass for all deceased)
		Daily Rosary at 9.10am

That those who may be anxious or worried about feeling called to priesthood will trust the Lord and hear the One who is "gentle and humble in heart" promising them rest and the peace that comes from knowing He is with them carrying their burdens alongside them.

Rev. Pat O'Hagan

HOLY FACE OF JESUS – Prayers every Tuesday after 9.30am Mass and Divine Mercy.

The 9.30am Mass in Glen Church on Thursday 16 July will be offered for all deceased DDS members.

IRISH MASS AT GRANAGHAN MASS ROCK – on Tues 7 July at 7pm. Join us to celebrate Mass through Irish. Light refreshments will be served. Parking at adjacent field.

MATT TALBOT PRAYER SOCIETY MONTHLY MASS will take place in St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, tomorrow, Monday 6 July at 7.30pm. The Mass is offered for enrolled members, all those dealing with addiction and their families. Everyone is welcome to attend. Free Spiritual Protection Packs will be available after Mass. These are for the protection of families and homes from drugs.

DIOCESE OF DERRY – LOUGH DERG PILGRIMAGE 2026: The Three-Day Pilgrimage will take place from Fri 24 to Sun 26 July. Lough Derg welcomes people seeking prayer, peace, reflection and renewal, offering an opportunity to step away from the pace of daily life and make space for God. For those availing of the bus transport (from St Eugene's Cathedral via Strabane and Lifford) the cost is £95/110Euros, including bus transport. Booking form and full details are available at derrydiocese.org/lough-Derg.

Fr. MIKE SCHMITZ PARABLES TOUR FOR YOUNG PEOPLE -20th JULY-DUBLIN: Derry Youth Ministry are inviting young people aged 16+ to join them for the Fr. Mike Schmitz Parables Tour taking place on 20 July 2026 in the National Stadium, Dublin. Fr. Mike is an American priest and digital evangelist, who will present the message of the Gospel in a novel, energetic and engaging style that speaks into young people's lives today. There will be a special Mass for youth attending from all over Ireland to begin the evening celebrations. Cost is £45 for ticket and transport. Bus departs Derry at 12Noon, with pick-ups in Strabane and Omagh. To secure your place or for more information contact bethany.doherty@derrydiocese.org or call 028 71264087.

ENVELOPE COLLECTION -Thank you for last week's envelope collections of £3,176.00. We appreciate your support to the church and for bringing your envelopes and donations church and pastoral centre. May your generosity be rewarded. Anyone wishing to donate to Maghera parish may do so by visiting website: magheraparishderry.com and using donate button.

ROARY ON THE COAST – today (Sunday) 5 July at 3pm at Lisfannon Beach

ATU St Angela's is inviting applications for the following programme beginning Autumn 2026: **Part-Time Certificate in Religious Education for Primary School**, with Online Delivery. The programme is open to: Qualified primary school teachers: Qualified post-primary school teachers who wish to transfer to primary school teaching. Parents, sacramental preparation teams and parish catechists who have a specific interest in the area of primary religious education may also apply. Closing date for Applications is Friday 14 August 2026. For further information contact: Mary Kearns, Senior Administrator, Education Department, ATU St Angelas, Lough Gill, Sligo. mail: mary.kearns@atu.ie or visit Website: www.atu.ie

SENIORS TUESDAY CLUB –on Tuesdays in Yough Club at 1030am.

All welcome! There will no Tuesday Club on 14th, 21st and 28 July. Re-opens- Tues 4 August.

GLEN GAA Website www.wattvgrahamsac.com Lotto Numbers 45:43:34:29: No winner. Next week £6,000. One £50 winner – Damian McElroy. Flyover next week £16,100 in 45 Nos or less.

ALLAGHLOON HALL: BINGO-Sunday night 7.30pm. Jackpot £500 in 45 numbers.

THIRD WORLD SHOP 24/6/26 - Since the last notice in the bulletin, £12,500 has been gratefully received by the following. The Columban Missionaries were so thankful for £2,000 to help fund a higher Education Centre where Fr. Neil Magill worked in Myanmar. Sr. Kay O'Neill got £1,500 for Little Assisi School Project which they are planning to open later this year. Fr. Danny Monaghan and his brother Fr. Mark at home from a very difficult Mission caring for the poor in slums in Lagos Nigeria got £1,500 each. Sr. Brigid Quinn retired but still supports a hospital and school in a very poor area in Cameroon got £1,000. Fr. Brian O'Kane also retired gets several requests from Zambia for help. He got £1,000. Anne and Brian Holloway on pilgrimage got £1,000 to help the poor in Medjugorje. Oblates of Mary Immaculate are celebrating 200 years of Missionary work. They got £1,500 to help some of the poorest in many parts of the world. Fr. Martin Mulholland was so grateful for £1,500 which he used to support schools, orphanages and the needy and vulnerable in areas he is familiar with. We will also be supporting other Missionaries who come home for summer. This would not be possible without your great support for the shop and St Joseph's Shrine. Your donations of good saleable clothes etc. and our faithful customers are so appreciated by all.

PILGRIMAGE TO FATIMA: - Flying direct from Belfast. 7 nights F/B -Avenida Hotel – 14/21 August. Spiritual Director: Fr. Andrew McMahon PP. Convenient Flight times – Cost: £845pp. For further details contact Joe 07776425631.

MEDIJUGORJE TRIPS – with local group in 2026 through Marian Pilgrimages. Wed 29 July – Wed 4 August. Be in Medjugorje for the Youth Festival(all ages welcome!) £705 including discount. Or choose quieter time of the year – Wed 28 Oct – Wed 4 Nov. All Saints Day and All souls Day in Medjugorje - £710 including discount. 0759600793 or email: dip@derrydiocese.org

AN CARN – Get creative this Spring with workshops at An Carn!

15th Sunday in Ordinary Time (Year A)

12 July 2026

The Soil of Our Lives

This Sunday Jesus tells us the parable of the sower. It is one of the most familiar stories in the Gospels. A farmer scatters seed. Some falls on the path, some on rocky ground, some among thorns, and some on rich soil. Only the rich soil produces a harvest.

Anyone who has ever grown anything in soil knows that you can have the best seed in the world, but if the ground isn't ready, nothing will come of it. The work is in the preparation. The digging, the clearing, the weeding. It is slow and unspectacular, and nobody sees it. But it makes all the difference.

Isaiah reminds us this weekend that God's Word never returns to Him empty. Like the rain and the snow that water the earth, His word always accomplishes what it was sent to do. The seed is never the problem. God is endlessly generous. He scatters His grace everywhere, on all of us, without measure and without favourites. The question the parable puts to each of us is a simple one: what kind of ground is He landing on?

Every one of us has been planted with gifts. Gifts of faith, of kindness, of patience, of prayer. Some of them are lying dormant because the soil of our lives has become hardened, or crowded, or shallow. The worries of the week, the busyness, the old hurts we haven't let go of — these are the thorns and the stones. They don't destroy the seed. They just stop it growing.

The good news is that soil can always be worked: A little time in prayer each day. An honest look at what is choking the Word in us. A return to the Sacraments. Small, quiet acts of clearing the ground! When we do

that, our roots go down deeper into God, and we find a steadiness that the heat of life cannot wither.

St Paul tells us the whole of creation is groaning, waiting to be set free. That freedom begins in small plots of ground, that is in hearts like yours and mine that let the Word take root and grow.

So this week, ask the Lord: what needs clearing in me? Then let Him in with the spade! The harvest He promises is thirty, sixty, a hundredfold.

Fr Sean

FATIMA PILGRIMAGE

I'm in Fatima with Fr Stephen Baxter (our newly ordained) and 60 others from our Parishes and others in Fatima. Please be assured of our prayers at all our Masses, Rosaries and Processions for you all and your intentions, and I ask for yours for us as well. Thanks to Fr Michael Canny PP, Fr Patrick Lagan CC and Fr Joshy Parokkaran CC from Waterside for providing cover while I'm away.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Lottie Kimberley Jowett

Remy Petroosbabakhan

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Gerard O'Connell, 60 Belldoo

Bernard O'Brien, 2 Mourne Park

Jackie Begley, 217 Ballycolman Estate

Jim Harley, 1 Melmount Park

Thomas Martin Roulston, 89 Carlton Drive

Anniversaries

Sr. Monica O’Kane, Mary Kate Mullen, William Robinson

Conor McCarron, Tony McAleer, Susan Logue

Vincent Gormley, Betty McColgan, Ellen Jane McCormick

John Ellis, Frances O’Connor, Tommy McGarrigle

Gerard Blake, Joe Millar, Tom Skehan

Kay McGuigan, William Devine, Jude Crotty

Frank Molloy, Maureen Devine, Eunan Herron

Tommy Finlay, Harry McCrossan, Anne McCay

Magdalene Curry, Molly McDaid, David Coyle

Deirdre Drumm Pearce, Dessie Drumm, Grace Drumm

Noel Brennan, Joe McNulty, Alice Alexander

Robert Brennan, George Fitzpatrick, Francis Moss

Margaret Quigley, Packie Duncan, Frank McElwee

Michael McDaid, Ann McShane, Patrick Early

George Early, Sarah Early, George Devenney

David McDaid, Marie Henderson

Announcements

Last week’s collections amounted to: **Melmount:** £3373.00; **Sion Mills:** £1465.00. Thank you. Those who pay to the weekly collection or any special collections, including Priest’s Collection by cheque are asked that all cheques should be made payable to ‘*Melmount Parish*’ or ‘*Sion Mills Parish*’ depending on the Parish. This is a banking requirement. *Parishioners can still leave their contributions in the Parish Office. If the Office is closed, please use the letterbox.*

Parish Bulletin This is the last bulletin until September.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 13 July after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm.

Vocations We pray for the men called to serve the Church as priests of our diocese, that their hearts will be the fertile soil Jesus needs to receive the seed which is His Word, and that they will spread His Word, His Good News, by their preaching and by the example of their lives.

Adoration Everyday The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Baptism Dates Melmount

July: Sunday 19; Saturday 25; Sunday 26.

August: Saturday 8; Saturday 29.

September: Saturday 5; Sunday 13; Saturday 19.

October: Sunday 4; Saturday 10; Saturday 17; Saturday 24.

November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14; Saturday 21; Saturday 28.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

To book a Baptism contact the Parish Office on 71383777 during office hours.

Accord Marriage Preparation Courses (Pre-Marriage Courses) will take place in September 25/26 and November 20/21. All courses are now online for booking at

Www.Accordni.Com

Please Note: These courses are in person and not online courses.

Accord Derry will NOT be facilitating courses during October or December.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church please contact Marie O’Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email@

Dlp@Derrydiocese.Org

. *Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI on 101; Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 71314090 and ask for the Duty Social Worker. Regional Emergency Social Work Services 0800 1979 995.*

The Parish Draws for July and August took place on Wednesday 8 July. The winners are as follows:

July Draw

£500: 1027 Genevieve O’Neill – *Genevieve O’Neill*

£250: 1350 Concepta McGarrigle – *Ann Donaghey*

£250: 1708 Thomas Moore – *Teresa Quigg*

£250: 1338 Marianne Patton – *Carol-ann Stewart*

£150: 1995 Tammy McNulty – *Irene Callan*

£150: 1304 Ina O’Neill – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£150: 1719 Christine McHugh – *Teresa Quigg*

£100: 1243 Bronagh Lynch – *Declan Duffy*

£100: 1669 Declan McColgan – *Madeleine McColgan*

£100: 1702 Terrie Logue - *Genevieve O’Neill*

August Draw

£500: 1756 Vincent McCarron – *Katrina Houston*

£250: 1626 Anne Neeson – *Madeleine McColgan*

£250: 1379 Gary McNicholl – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£250: 1862 Emma Lynch – *Elizabeth O'Hare*

£150: 1825 Susan McGuinness – *John Donohoe*

£150: 1684 Teresa Boggs – *Katrina Houston*

£150: 1380 Bridget McCrory – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£100: 1010 Mya McNulty – *Dolores Houston*

£100: 1258 Corrine Hannigan – *Elizabeth O'Hare*

£100: 1507 Jacintha Gillespie - *Elizabeth O'Hare*

Forty Hours Adoration – St Mary's Melmount

Join us for **Forty Hours Adoration** in **St Mary's Melmount** between **26th and 27th October 2025**.

You can view or download the full programme by opening the link below. *To open in a new tab, right-click and select "Open link in new tab", or hold **Ctrl** (Windows) / **Cmd** (Mac) and click.*



[View Forty Hours Adoration PDF](#)



[Sign-Up Sheet \(PDF\)](#)

40 Hours Adoration St Mary's, Melmount

26th – 27th October 2025

*You are invited to commit to a period of prayer before the Lord.
Please let us know what period you will cover by filling out a
Commitment Card and posting in the Box here or by posting into
Fr Sean or the Parish Office or send details by email*

Sunday 26th October 2025

8.00am Morning Prayer
11.30am Mass
3.00pm Divine Mercy Chaplet
6.00pm Holy Hour: Angelus, Evening Prayer
and Stations of the Cross
9.00pm Rosary (Glorious Mysteries)
9.30pm Night Prayer



Monday 27th October 2025

12.00am Rosary (Mysteries of Light)
3.00am Rosary (Sorrowful Mysteries)
6.00am Angelus and Chaplet for Priests
8.00am Morning Prayer & Rosary (Joyful Mysteries)
10.00am Mass
12.00pm Angelus and Midday Prayer
3.00pm Divine Mercy Chaplet
6.00pm Angelus and Chaplet for Priests
8.00pm Holy Hour: Evening Prayer and Rosary
9.30pm Night Prayer
12.00am Solemn Benediction to conclude the 40 Hours



Mourne Pastoral Area – Melmount and Sion Mills Parishes
41 Melmount Road, Strabane, BT82 9EF. Office: 028 7188 3777 Fr Sean: 028 7188 2648
Office: parishoffice@melmountparish.com Fr Sean: sean.odonnell@derrydiocese.org

The Parish of Moville

St Pius X, Moville St Mary's, Ballybrack

St Columba's, Ballinacrae St Joseph's Oratory, Shrove



Parish Priest: Fr Colm O'Doherty (074) 9382057

Parish Office: (074) 9382057/0899421375

emails: movilleparish@derrydiocese.org
movilleparish@gmail.com

Bulletin email address: movillebulletin@gmail.com

Parish website: www.movilleparish.com

CALENDAR FOR THE WEEK AHEAD

Sunday 9th For Elijah, the Lord was not the mighty wind but the gentle breeze. Peter's faith fails in the face of the of the wind and the sea. 'Lord! Save me' is a prayer for all in times of fear and opposition.

Monday 10th St Lawrence, deacon, one of the most venerated saints of the Church of Rome. Remembered for his generosity to the poor and for his faithfulness as a martyr.

Tuesday 11th St Clare (1193-1253). Born in Assisi, she followed St Francis in his life of poverty and founded the Poor Clares

Wednesday 12th St Jane Frances de Chantal (1572-1641) at the age of twenty married Baron de Chantal but after nine years was left a widow with four children. Her friendship with St Francis de Sales led to the foundation of the Congregation of the Visitation.

St Lelia, who is said to have been baptized by St Patrick.

Thursday 13th St Pontian and St Hippolytus, Martyrs. Pontian became bishop of Rome in 230; Hippolytus was a Roman priest and a learned and influential theologian. Both were exiled to the mines of Sardinia at a time of persecution.

Friday 14th St Maximilian Kolbe (1894-1941), a Franciscan who worked in the apostolate of the press in Poland and Japan. He returned to Poland in 1936 but was later arrested by the Nazis and sent to Auschwitz. There he offered to take the place of a married man with a family who had been sentenced to death. He died in Auschwitz on 14th August 1941.

Vigil Mass of the Assumption in Ballybrack at 7.30pm.

Saturday 15th The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary. At the end of her life Mary was glorified by God in body and soul, conformed completely to the risen Christ. Today's feast celebrates her blessed state in all its fullness. Holyday of Obligation. **Mass in St Pius X at 10am and Vigil for Sunday at 7.00pm.**

Sunday 16th 11.30am Mass will be celebrated in Ballybrack.

Mass this week in St Pius X: Monday to Friday 10am. Saturday 6.30pm; Sunday 10am. **Confessions** in St. Pius X Church: Saturday 5.45pm to 6.15pm. **The Rosary and the Divine Mercy Chaplet** will be recited in St. Pius X Church, Moville, at 7.30 pm every day, from Sunday – Friday. **Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament** on Monday, 2-9pm; Wednesday, 6-9pm.

Thank you for your generous financial support to the parish in the past week, which amounted to €3425.

Baptism: We welcome into God's Family **Sophie Ella Treacy Daly**, Gulladuff and **Rían Oscar Gillespie**, Gulladuff Heights who were baptised recently.

Prayer for Vocations: For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!" We pray to the Lord.

"It is to the glory of my Father that you should bear much fruit and then you will be my disciples." Are you being called to love the Lord and His people as a priest, sister or brother? Anyone interested in serving the Church as a priest of the diocese of Derry should contact the diocesan Vocations Director, Fr Pat O'Hagan, PP Bellaghy and Greenlough, at 0487938 6259 or at pgoh2111@gmail.com

Music continues on Thursday evenings at 8pm in Moville Men's Shed. Love Music? Just Show Up! Singers, players, and socialisers alike are all welcome for a relaxing evening at one of the few Shed activities open to both men and women.

A Feast of Folk with Patsy Cavanagh and friends in The Cairn, at 8pm every Tuesday during July and August. Ballads and Folk songs from Ireland and further afield as seating is limited, please call 9381104.

Summer Teas in the Glencrow Hall on Saturday 22 August from 11am to 4.00pm. Scones, cakes and good company. Also, a stall of pre-loved items for sale. Admission €8, children free. Proceeds to ongoing work in war-torn Myanmar.

Donegal Down Syndrome Association Annual church-gate collection will take place on the weekend of 29 /30 August.

The National Novena to Our Lady of Knock takes place at Knock Shrine from Thursday 13 to Friday 21 August. Ceremonies celebrated daily at 3pm and 8pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions. This year's theme is "Sheltered in God's Love." Full programme at: <https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/>

Carrowmena Community Centre (9367061) Cream Teas every Tuesday during August from between 2 and 4pm. Cost €5. Special summer dance (The Holiday Hop), for regulars, holiday makers and visitors, on Sunday 16 August at 8pm. Admission €5, including supper. All welcome. Carrowmena Community Centre, Carrowmena Residents Association and Tremone Historical Society will hold an afternoon celebrating the heritage, people and stories of the area on Sunday 30 August at 2pm. It will include a guided historical walk, talks about the memorial garden and a draw for a painting by Jenny Craven followed by tea in the Centre. Proceeds to the Residents Association and the Memorial Garden Renovation Fund. Tickets €10. Booking essential.

Congratulations to the winners of the August Parish Draw.

Prize	Number	Name	Promoter
€700	253	Ellie McDermott	Agnes Cavanagh
€400	227	Seamus & Mary Bovaird	Agnes Cavanagh
€250	108	Fr Pat O'Hagan	Bridget McGhee
€150	147	Margaret Lynch	Helen Gillen
€100	188	Siobhan Price	Kay Doherty

Safeguarding If you have any concerns with regards to Safeguarding children or adults, please contact Marie O'Kane, The Diocesan Designated Liaison Person at 00447596500793 or dlp@derrydiocese.org. Local Safeguarding Representatives are Mary McGranaghan and Brídín Hannaway

15th Sunday in Ordinary Time (Year A)

12 July 2026

The Soil of Our Lives

This Sunday Jesus tells us the parable of the sower. It is one of the most familiar stories in the Gospels. A farmer scatters seed. Some falls on the path, some on rocky ground, some among thorns, and some on rich soil. Only the rich soil produces a harvest.

Anyone who has ever grown anything in soil knows that you can have the best seed in the world, but if the ground isn't ready, nothing will come of it. The work is in the preparation. The digging, the clearing, the weeding. It is slow and unspectacular, and nobody sees it. But it makes all the difference.

Isaiah reminds us this weekend that God's Word never returns to Him empty. Like the rain and the snow that water the earth, His word always accomplishes what it was sent to do. The seed is never the problem. God is endlessly generous. He scatters His grace everywhere, on all of us, without measure and without favourites. The question the parable puts to each of us is a simple one: what kind of ground is He landing on?

Every one of us has been planted with gifts. Gifts of faith, of kindness, of patience, of prayer. Some of them are lying dormant because the soil of our lives has become hardened, or crowded, or shallow. The worries of the week, the busyness, the old hurts we haven't let go of — these are the thorns and the stones. They don't destroy the seed. They just stop it growing.

The good news is that soil can always be worked: A little time in prayer each day. An honest look at what is choking the Word in us. A return to the Sacraments. Small, quiet acts of clearing the ground! When we do that, our roots go down deeper into God, and we find a steadiness that the heat of life cannot wither.

St Paul tells us the whole of creation is groaning, waiting to be set free. That freedom begins in small plots of ground, that is in hearts like yours and mine that let the Word take root and grow.

So this week, ask the Lord: what needs clearing in me? Then let Him in with the spade! The harvest He promises is thirty, sixty, a hundredfold.

Fr Sean

FATIMA PILGRIMAGE

I'm in Fatima with Fr Stephen Baxter (our newly ordained) and 60 others from our Parishes and others in Fatima. Please be assured of our prayers at all our Masses, Rosaries and Processions for you all and your intentions, and I ask for yours for us as well. Thanks to Fr Michael Canny PP, Fr Patrick Lagan CC and Fr Joshy Parokkaran CC from Waterside for providing cover while I'm away.

We welcome into God's Family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Lottie Kimberley Jowett

Remy Petroosbabakhan

May they Rest in Peace

Deaths

Gerard O'Connell, 60 Belldoo

Bernard O'Brien, 2 Mourne Park

Jackie Begley, 217 Ballycolman Estate

Jim Harley, 1 Melmount Park

Thomas Martin Roulston, 89 Carlton Drive

Anniversaries

Sr. Monica O'Kane, Mary Kate Mullen, William Robinson

Conor McCarron, Tony McAleer, Susan Logue

Vincent Gormley, Betty McColgan, Ellen Jane McCormick

John Ellis, Frances O'Connor, Tommy McGarrigle

Gerard Blake, Joe Millar, Tom Skehan

Kay McGuigan, William Devine, Jude Crotty

Frank Molloy, Maureen Devine, Eunan Herron

Tommy Finlay, Harry McCrossan, Anne McCay

Magdalene Curry, Molly McDaid, David Coyle

Deirdre Drumm Pearce, Dessie Drumm, Grace Drumm

Noel Brennan, Joe McNulty, Alice Alexander

Robert Brennan, George Fitzpatrick, Francis Moss

Margaret Quigley, Packie Duncan, Frank McElwee

Michael McDaid, Ann McShane, Patrick Early

George Early, Sarah Early, George Devenney

David McDaid, Marie Henderson

Announcements

Last week's collections amounted to: **Melmount:** £3373.00; **Sion Mills:** £1465.00. Thank you. Those who pay to the weekly collection or any special collections, including Priest's Collection by cheque are asked that all cheques should be made payable to 'Melmount Parish' or 'Sion Mills Parish' depending on the Parish. This is a banking requirement. *Parishioners can still leave their contributions in the Parish Office. If the Office is closed, please use the letterbox.*

Parish Bulletin This is the last bulletin until September.

Exposition of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in St. Mary's, Melmount tomorrow, Monday 13 July after 10.00am Mass until 6.30pm.

Vocations We pray for the men called to serve the Church as priests of our diocese, that their hearts will be the fertile soil Jesus needs to receive the seed which is His Word, and that they will spread His Word, His Good News, by their preaching and by the example of their lives.

Adoration Everyday The Blessed Sacrament can be adored in the Adoration Room, St. Theresa's, Sion Mills anytime while the church is open.

Baptism Dates Melmount

July: Sunday 19; Saturday 25; Sunday 26.

August: Saturday 8; Saturday 29.

September: Saturday 5; Sunday 13; Saturday 19.

October: Sunday 4; Saturday 10; Saturday 17; Saturday 24.

November: Sunday 8; Saturday 14; Saturday 21; Saturday 28.

Baptisms will be at 3.30pm on a Saturday and 12.45pm on a Sunday.

To book a Baptism contact the Parish Office on 71383777 during office hours.

Accord Marriage Preparation Courses (Pre-Marriage Courses) will take place in September 25/26 and November 20/21. All courses are now online for booking at www.accordni.com

Please Note: These courses are in person and not online courses.

Accord Derry will NOT be facilitating courses during October or December.

Safeguarding Notice If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email@ dlp@derrydiocese.org. *Northern Ireland emergency services:* PSNI on 101; *Social Services:* Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust, 028 71314090 and ask for the Duty Social Worker. *Regional Emergency Social Work Services* 0800 1979 995.

The Parish Draws for July and August took place on Wednesday 8 July. The winners are as follows:

July Draw

£500: 1027 Genevieve O'Neill – *Genevieve O'Neill*

£250: 1350 Concepta McGarrigle – *Ann Donaghey*

£250: 1708 Thomas Moore – *Teresa Quigg*

£250: 1338 Marianne Patton – *Carol-ann Stewart*

£150: 1995 Tammy McNulty – *Irene Callan*

£150: 1304 Ina O'Neill – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£150: 1719 Christine McHugh – *Teresa Quigg*

£100: 1243 Bronagh Lynch – *Declan Duffy*

£100: 1669 Declan McColgan – *Madeleine McColgan*

£100: 1702 Terrie Logue - *Genevieve O'Neill*

August Draw

£500: 1756 Vincent McCarron – *Katrina Houston*

£250: 1626 Anne Neeson – *Madeleine McColgan*

£250: 1379 Gary McNicholl – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£250: 1862 Emma Lynch – *Elizabeth O'Hare*

£150: 1825 Susan McGuinness – *John Donohoe*

£150: 1684 Teresa Boggs – *Katrina Houston*

£150: 1380 Bridget McCrory – *Sheelagh McKelvey*

£100: 1010 Mya McNulty – *Dolores Houston*

£100: 1258 Corrine Hannigan – *Elizabeth O'Hare*

£100: 1507 Jacintha Gillespie - *Elizabeth O'Hare*



CATHOLICIRELAND.NET
CAITLICIGH AR AN NGRÉASÁN

[Click here to view Daily Readings from CatholicIreland.net](#)

[Click here to view Sunday Readings from CatholicIreland.net](#)

Site Links

1 Latest News

2 Remembering our Dead.

3 WEBCAM

4 Prayers For Protection

5 Mass Times

6 Getting Married

A short reflection on today's Gospel Matthew 14:22-33

In today's Gospel, the disciples find themselves struggling against strong winds while Jesus comes to them, walking on the water. At first, they are filled with fear, but Jesus reassures them with the simple yet powerful words: "Take courage! It is I. Do not be afraid."

Like the disciples, we all encounter storms in our lives - times of uncertainty, anxiety, illness, or loss. Peter's experience reminds us that faith is not about never doubting, but about keeping our eyes fixed on Christ. When Peter focuses on Jesus, he walks on the water; when he focuses on the wind and waves, he begins to sink. Yet even then, Jesus immediately reaches out His hand to save him.

This Gospel is a beautiful reminder that the Lord is always present, even when He seems distant. He does not promise a life free from storms, but He does promise that we will never face them alone. As we gather around the Lord's table this Sunday, may we hear His reassuring voice, trust in His presence, and reach out to Him in faith, knowing that His hand is always extended towards us.

Prayer for Vocations to the Priesthood: For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"

On Saturday 15th August, the Church celebrates the Solemnity of the Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary, a Holy Day of Obligation. We gather to give thanks to God for the gift of Our Lady, who was assumed body and soul into heavenly glory, and to renew our hope in the promise of the Resurrection.

Mass times are as follows:

Friday 14th August – 6.15pm and 7.30pm

Saturday 15th August – 7.00am, 9.30am, 11.00am, and 12.30pm.

The Collection on the Feast of the Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary will be for Parish Youth Ministry. All parishioners are warmly encouraged to join us in celebrating this joyful feast.

“Bishop Daly - A Man for all Seasons” 2026 Exhibition celebrates the life, influence, work and legacy of Bishop Edward Daly opens on Saturday 8th August at 11.00am. Exhibition times are 11.00am to 4.00pm in the Conference Room above the Sacristy in Saint Eugene's Cathedral, Creggan Street, Derry, BT48 9AP. The Exhibition will run until 18th August and everyone is welcome.

On 14th August, the Church celebrates the Memorial of St Maximilian Kolbe, a Polish Franciscan priest and martyr of charity. Imprisoned in Auschwitz during the Second World War, he freely offered his life in place of a fellow prisoner who had been selected to die. His extraordinary act of self-sacrificing love reflects Christ's own words: "No one has greater love than this, to lay down one's life for one's friends" (John 15:13).

St Maximilian had a deep devotion to the Blessed Virgin Mary and dedicated his priesthood to spreading the Gospel through prayer, the media, and missionary work. His courage, faith, and love continue to inspire Christians throughout the world.

As we honour St Maximilian Kolbe, may we ask for his intercession, that we too may grow in faith, charity, and the courage to bear witness to Christ in our daily lives.

Anniversaries

Please pray for the repose of the souls of:

Mary Theresa (Maureen) O'Doherty

Seamus Mullan

Cissie McLaughlin

Brother Gabriel McKinney S.J.

Richard Gillespie

Peggy Carlin

May they rest in peace

Baptisms

We welcome as a member of God's family:

Cora Doyle

To book a Baptism contact the Parish Office 02871 262894

Sacrament of Marriage

We congratulate

Cara McLaughlin &

Alexander Gittings

who celebrated the Sacrament of Marriage recently in the Cathedral

May God bless you abundantly in love, joy and happiness

Collection

Weekly Collection: £5,362

Parish Development: £ 986

Thank you for your generosity

Thank you

Fr Farren acknowledges with thanks the following donations for:

Smile Train: £20 £60 £20

Sightsavers: £100

Mary's Meals: £60

Trócaire: £10

SVdP: £20

Readers for 14th/15th August

6.15pm Mary Feeney

7.30pm Mary Morrison

9.30am Marie Canning

11.00am Helen Sweeney

12.30pm Eilish Friel

Readers for 15th/16th August

6.15 pm Claire O'Kane

7.30 pm Amulya George

9.30 am Barry McDaid/
Caragh McSheffrey

11.00 am Angela McCallion

12.30 pm Rosemary Finan

7.00 pm Anna Begley

Lunchtime Concert - Grúpa Ceoil Beag, a group of young traditional Irish music students and performers will be performing in The Cathedral Hall on Wednesday 12th August at 1.30pm. Entry is free, and everyone is welcome. With thanks to Derry City & Strabane District Council for supporting this event.

Job Opportunity, Derry Diocesan Trust: Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours per week), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or telephone 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24 August 2026. *Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.*

The National Novena to Our Lady of Knock takes place at Knock Shrine from Thursday 13th to Friday 21st August 2026. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3.00pm and 8.00pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days. This year's theme is "Sheltered in God's Love." See the full program at www.knockshrine.ie.

Mary's Meals – Step by Step Walk - Mary's Meals is currently feeding over 3 million children a daily school meal across 16 countries. Our Annual Step by Step to Feed the Next Child 2 Bridges Walk (Foyle and Peace Bridges Derry) takes place on Sunday 9th August. Starting Point is at Sainsbury's Car Park, Strand Road at 12 noon. All Welcome to participate even for a mile or two. For further details and to register online visit www.marysmeals.org.uk/step or contact Caoimhe on 07394564065. Please do keep all our walkers in your prayers.

Accord Derry – Marriage Preparation Workshops 2026 - Accord Derry is pleased to announce upcoming Marriage Preparation Workshops taking place in 2026. These courses are designed to support couples as they prepare for the Sacrament of Marriage.

The remaining available dates for 2026 are as follows:

- **September:** 25th–26th 2026
- **November:** 20th–21st 2026

All courses are now available for online booking at: www.accordni.com.

Please note that **Accord Derry will not be facilitating Marriage Preparation Courses during October or December 2026.** Couples are encouraged to book early to secure a place on their preferred date.

ATU St Angela's is now accepting applications for the Part-Time Certificate in Religious Education for Primary School (online delivery), beginning in Autumn 2026.

The programme is open to qualified primary school teachers, qualified post-primary teachers wishing to transfer to primary teaching, and parents, sacramental preparation teams, and parish catechists with an interest in primary religious education. The closing date for applications is **Friday, 14th August 2026.** For further information, contact Mary Kearns, Senior Administrator, Education Department, ATU St Angela's, Lough Gill, Sligo, at mary.kearns@atu.ie, or visit www.atu.ie.

St Eugene's Cathedral is monitored by CCTV cameras and by two live streaming cameras. Live streaming can be viewed online at www.churchservices.tv, www.watchmcnmedia or the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Cathedral notice board, or you may obtain a copy from the Parish Office.

Safeguarding Notice: If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker), Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459, Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995. Republic of Ireland emergency services: Garda Síochána Buncrana: 00353 749 320 540 Letterkenny: 00353 749 167 100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency: 00353 749 102 23

*Vol 54 No 31
Nineteenth Sunday
in Ordinary Time
9th August 2026*

Priests: Fr Paul Farren, Fr Shaun Doherty

 Bulletin

 Donate

 Call Us

- [HOME](#)
- [SACRAMENTS](#)
- [ABOUT](#)
- [WEBCAM](#)
- [NEWS/EVENTS](#)
- [SCHOOLS](#)

Sunday 9th August
Sunday 2nd August
Sunday 26th July
Sunday 19th July
Sunday 12th July
Sunday 5th July
Sunday 28th June
Sunday 21st June
Sunday 14th June
Sunday 7th June
Sunday 31st May
Sunday 24th May
Sunday 17th May
Sunday 10th May
Sunday 3rd May
Sunday 26th April
Sunday 19th April
Sunday 12th April
Sunday 5th April
Sunday 29th March
Sunday 15th March
Sunday 8th March
Sunday 1st March
Sunday 22nd February
Sunday 15th February
Sunday 8th February
Sunday 1st February
Sunday 25th January
Sunday 18th January
Sunday 11th January
Sunday 4th January
Sunday 28th December
Sunday 21st December
Sunday 14th December
Sunday 7th December
Sunday 30th November
Sunday 23rd November
Sunday 16th November
Sunday 9th November
Sunday 2nd November

Sunday 26th October
Sunday 19th October
Sunday 12th October
Sunday 5th October
Sunday 28th September
Sunday 21st September
Sunday 14th September
Sunday 7th September
Sunday 31st August
Sunday 24th August
Sunday 17th August
Sunday 10th August
Sunday 3rd August
Sunday 27th July
Sunday 20th July
Sunday 13th July
Sunday 6th July
Sunday 29th June

Sunday 22nd June

Sunday 15th June

Sunday 8th June

Sunday 1st June

Sunday 25th May

Sunday 18th May

Sunday 11th May

Sunday 4th May

Sunday 27th April

Sunday 20th April

Sunday 13th April

Sunday 6th April

Sunday 30th March

Sunday 23rd March

Sunday 16th March

Sunday 9th March

Sunday 2nd March

Sunday 23rd February

Sunday 16th February

Sunday 9th February

Sunday 2nd February

Sunday 26th January

Sunday 19th January

Sunday 12th January

Sunday 5th January

Sunday 22nd December

Sunday 15th December

Sunday 8th December

Sunday 1st December

Sunday 24th November

Sunday 17th November

Sunday 10th November

Sunday 3rd November
Sunday 27th October
Sunday 20th October
Sunday 13th October

Saint Mary's Creggan

📍 ADDRESS: 1 Fanad Dr, Derry BT48 9QE | 📞 PHONE: 02871263152

Copyright © 2025 . All rights reserved. Derry

Steelstown Parish Newsletter

Eighteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Sunday 2nd August 2026

Thoughts on the Gospel

Matthew 14:13–21 – The Feeding of the Five Thousand

The miracle of the loaves and fishes begins with **compassion**. Before Jesus fed the crowd, He first recognised their suffering and their need. His heart was moved by those who were tired, hungry, and searching for hope.

In our own busy lives, God gently calls us to notice those around us who may be lonely, discouraged, forgotten, or struggling. A simple word of encouragement, a listening ear, or a small act of kindness may become someone else's miracle.

The disciples looked only at what they **didn't have**. Faced with thousands of hungry people, they saw only five loaves and two fish. Jesus, however, asked them to offer what they already possessed.

God rarely asks us for what we do not have. Instead, He asks us to place before Him our time, our talents, our compassion, and our willingness to serve. However small these gifts may seem, He is able to multiply them beyond anything we could imagine.

Before distributing the food, Jesus lifted everything to His Father in prayer. This reminds us that surrender is not a sign of weakness or defeat. Rather, it is an act of trust. We all carry burdens that feel too heavy or situations that seem impossible, yet when we place them into God's hands, what appears insufficient can become more than enough.

Finally, the twelve baskets of leftovers remind us of God's overwhelming generosity. His blessings are never intended to stop with us but to flow through us. When we forgive generously, encourage freely, and share what we have with others, God's grace continues to multiply in countless lives.

Prayer

Lord, fill our hearts with compassion. Use the little we have to accomplish great things for Your Kingdom. Teach us to trust You completely, to surrender our limitations into Your hands, and to share Your blessings generously with all whom we meet. Amen.

Readings for Next Sunday

Sunday 9th August 2026

First Reading: 1 Kings 19:9a, 11–13a

Psalm: Psalm 85:9–14

Second Reading: Romans 9:1–5

Gospel: Matthew 14:22–33

Saints of the Coming Week

Tuesday

- St John Vianney, Priest

Wednesday

- The Dedication of the Basilica of St Mary Major (Rome)

Thursday

- The Transfiguration of the Lord

Friday

- St Cajetan, Priest
- St Sixtus II, Pope, and Companions, Martyrs

Saturday

- St Dominic, Priest
-

Pope's Prayer Intention for August

For Evangelisation in the City

Let us pray that in large cities, often marked by anonymity and loneliness, we may discover new ways of proclaiming the Gospel, finding creative paths to build genuine Christian communities.

Prayer for Vocations

We pray for men whom God is calling to the priesthood.

Like Jesus in today's Gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, the hungry, the vulnerable or those most in need, but always reflect the compassionate love of Christ as they nourish His people through the Word of God and the Eucharist.

Parish & Diocesan Notices

Rosary on the Coast

Today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm

 Lisfannon Beach

Praying for **peace, Ireland and our unborn children.**

Everyone is warmly welcome.

Give Blood – Save Lives

The **Northern Ireland Blood Transfusion Service** will hold a blood donor session at:

Lisneal College

70 Crescent Link

Derry BT47 5FQ

Monday 4th August

- 12.30 pm – 4.00 pm
- 5.00 pm – 7.30 pm

 Freephone: **0808 553 4653** to book.

Franciscan Friary, Rosstown

Monthly Healing Service

Today (Sunday)

- Rosary – **2.45 pm**
 - Mass & Healing Service – **3.00 pm**
 - Confessions – **2.00 pm – 5.00 pm**
-

ACCORD Marriage Preparation

Marriage preparation courses are available throughout the year.

Please visit www.accordni.com for dates and booking information.

Monthly Mass for Sr Clare Crockett

Sunday 9th August

7.00 pm

Carmelite Retreat Centre
Termonbacca, Derry

Day of Healing & Prayer

House of Prayer, Clonfert

Saturday 15th August

Led by **Eddie Stone**

A bus will travel from **Letterkenny**, collecting pilgrims in **Ballybofey** and **Donegal Town**.
A priest will accompany the pilgrimage.

 **Contact: 086 393 6547**

Walk in Our Patron Saint's Footsteps

St Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk

Saturday 8th August

9.00 am – 3.00 pm

Downpatrick

Guides:

- Martina Purdy
- Elaine Kelly

Cost: £55

 **028 4461 9000**

Visit www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Youth & Young Adults

Embrace the Grace

Legion of Mary Young Adult Catholic Conference

(Ages 18–40)

Saturday 29th August

9.30 am – 6.00 pm

De Montfort House
Morning Star Avenue
Dublin D07 VA03

Tickets available through Eventbrite (search **Embrace the Grace**).

Youth 2000 Summer Festival

13th–16th August

Newbridge College, Kildare

Young people aged **16–35** are invited to enjoy:

- Inspiring talks
- Workshops
- Daily Mass
- Music and Prayer
- Fellowship
- Free buses
- All meals included

Visit **youth2000.ie** or follow **@Youth2000Ireland**.

Anam Óg Summer Scheme

3rd–7th August

12.00 pm – 4.00 pm daily

Termonbacca, Derry

For children aged **8–14**

Faith, friendship, games, arts & crafts, adventure and prayer.

Email:

termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Community & Charity

Mary's Meals

Annual Step by Step Walk

Sunday 9th August

12.00 noon

Starting from:

Sainsbury's Car Park

Strand Road, Derry

Walking the Foyle Bridge and Peace Bridge.

Everyone is welcome—even if only for part of the walk.

Mary's Meals currently provides a daily school meal to **over 3 million children across 16 countries.**

Please keep all participants in your prayers.

Family Carers Ireland

Remote one-to-one support clinics are available **every Tuesday throughout August.**

Carers can speak privately from the comfort of their own homes.

 086 836 3842

 Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Pro-Life Events

Donegal Pro Life Church Gate Collection

Saturday 15th & Sunday 16th August

Countywide Collection

Volunteers are greatly appreciated.

 Margaret:
00353 89 246 9599

Míle buíochas.

Monthly Pro-Life Witness

Friday 7th August
1.00 pm – 2.00 pm

Roundabout at Letterkenny University Hospital.

Everyone welcome.

Pilgrimages

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw

Support Station Island and help preserve this special place of pilgrimage for future generations.

Tickets

- Single: **€10**
- Book of 6: **€50**

Those returning a full book will also be entered into the **Early Bird Draw on 28th August 2026.**

Main Draw

23rd October 2026

Prizes

 €10,000

 €5,000

 €2,000

4th – €1,500

5th – €1,000

6th – €500

Lough Derg Day Retreats

As the Three-Day Pilgrimage season concludes (final day to begin is **13th August**), Day Retreats resume on:

- August: **18, 22, 23, 29 & 31**
- September: **5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19 & 20**

Take time away from the busyness of everyday life for guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal.

Advance booking is essential.

Employment Opportunity

Administrative & Financial Officer

Clonmany Parish

The **Derry Diocesan Trust** invites applications for the position of:

Administrative & Financial Officer

Hours: 9 per week

Application packs are available from:

Bishop's House
St Eugene's Cathedral
Derry BT48 9AP

 028 7126 2302

 recruitment@derrydiocese.org

Closing Date: Tuesday **11th August 2026**

Publications

Reflections Through Poetry

A beautiful collection by **Fr John P. Forbes**

Available from the **Pastoral Office**

Price: £10

All proceeds support **Children in Crossfire** and the **Cause for the Canonisation of Sr Clare Crockett**.

Sharing the Good News

Read the latest weekly Catholic e-zine featuring news, reflections and resources from across Ireland.

Visit [**theway.ie/ezine-2/**](http://theway.ie/ezine-2/).

Closing Prayer

May the Lord bless us with compassionate hearts, generous spirits, and unwavering trust in His providence. May we recognise Christ in those around us, offer Him the little we possess, and witness His abundant blessings multiplying in our families, our parish, and our community.

May Almighty God bless you, the Father, ✠ the Son, and the Holy Spirit. Amen.



PARISH NEWSLETTER

T: 028 7126 2360 E: threepatrons@derrydiocese.org W: threepatrons.org

Fr Micheál McGavigan PP – Fr Roni Zacharias CC – Fr Stephen Ward CC
Sunday 9th August 2026 – Nineteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A

In this Sunday's Gospel, Peter steps out of the boat and begins to walk towards Jesus. But when he focuses on the wind and the waves around him, fear takes over and he begins to sink. It is a powerful reminder of how easily we can lose sight of the Lord amid the worries and pressures of everyday life. The storms we face may be illness, family difficulties, financial concerns, loneliness, grief, or anxiety about an uncertain world. Like Peter, we can find ourselves overwhelmed by what is happening around us. Yet the Gospel offers a message of hope. Jesus does not abandon Peter when he falters. Instead, he reaches out his hand and saves him. God never promises a life without storms, but he does promise that we will never face them alone. Christ remains present in every trial, inviting us to place our trust in him and to pray with confidence: *"Lord, save me."*

WELCOME TO GOD'S FAMILY

Oisín Eanna McGeoghegan; Lochlan Doherty-O'Neill;
 Ellie-Mae Donegan; Jordan James Cooper.

REQUIESCENT IN PACE

We offer our sympathies to the family and friends of:
 Tom Lavy, Ederowen Park; Michael McMahon, Clon Elagh;
 Kay Callaghan, Lisfannon Park; John Donegan, Foyle Fold

ANNIVERSARIES

Mary McNally; Elizabeth Harding; Gary Stewart; Teresa Hurford;
 Brendan Saunders; Bernadette & Jim Sheerin; Martin Tope;
 Fr Jimmy Doherty; Mary Gillespie; Thomas Gillespie; Jim Dunne; Willie Wilson; Emily Villa; Sam Carlin; Margaret Stewart.

VISITATION OF THE SICK & HOUSEBOUND

Fr Stephen Ward will visit those in his care on Monday and Tuesday and Fr Roni will visit those in his care on Thursday and Friday of next week. If you have a relative or neighbour on the list, please let them know to expect a visit. Moreover, if you have a relative or neighbour who would like added to the monthly sick visitation in our Parish, please contact the Parish Office.

A WORD OF THANKS FROM CASEY BURGESS

My month in Three Patrons Parish was a great gift in my formation for priesthood. I learned much from Fr. Micheál, Fr. Stephen, and Fr. Roni, and I was grateful to meet so many of you in the churches, schools, and Life Camp. Derry has helped to form a priestly heart in me, and so I thank all of you for helping me along the way!

THE ASSUMPTION OF THE BLESSED VIRGIN MARY

Mass times for the Solemnity: Friday Vigil: 7pm St Joseph's Church, Galliagh. Saturday: 10am St Patrick's Church, Pennyburn; 11am St Brigid's Church, Carnhill

READINGS FOR SUNDAY 16th AUGUST

1st Isaiah 56:1, 6-7. Psalm: 66:2-3, 5-6, 8, R/v4.
 2nd Romans 11:13-15, 29-32. Gospel Matthew 15: 21-28

WEDDING CONGRATULATIONS!

Emma Smith & Christopher Fagan; Rosie McGinley & Hugh Diver, and Leanne McConnell & Gavin Nicholl, who celebrated the Sacrament of Matrimony recently.

SIMPLE FAMILY PRAYER BOOK

This Sunday begins psalter week 3.

PILGRIMAGE TO CYPRUS

The parish is considering a 7-night pilgrimage to Cyprus from 16–23 May 2027, following in the footsteps of St Paul and St Barnabas. The pilgrimage would include visits to many of Cyprus's most important Christian and historical sites, with the opportunity to celebrate Mass in places closely associated with the early Church. The package includes direct flights from Belfast, full-board accommodation in a four-star seafront hotel, and a guided programme of pilgrimage visits throughout the week. The estimated cost is £1,675 per person. At this stage, we are simply seeking expressions of interest. If you think you may wish to join the pilgrimage, please contact the parish office. Registering your interest is not a commitment to travel.

LAST WEEK'S OFFERTORY COLLECTION

St Patrick's Church: £1,367 - St Brigid's Church: £2,310 - St Joseph's Church: £1,115

2nd Collection (Maintenance & Pastoral Outreach): £1,173.

Thank you for your continued generosity.

BANK DETAILS FOR ONLINE DONATIONS: A/C Name: The Parish of the Three Patrons

Sort Code: 95-06-79 A/C No: 60320021

JOB OPPORTUNITY, DERRY DIOCESAN TRUST:

Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours per week), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hr. For application packs please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 028 7126 2302. Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24 August 2026. Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

MARY'S MEALS – ANNUAL STEP BY STEP WALK

We currently feed over 3 million children a daily school meal across 16 countries. Our 2 Bridges walk (Foyle and Peace Bridges), starts today, Sunday 9th August. at 12noon from Sainsbury's. Visit www.marysmeals.org.uk/step or Caoimhe 07394564065. Keep all walkers in your prayers.

FRANCISCAN FRIARS OF THE RENEWAL

Evangelisation Mission to Sydney, Australia this December. The mission is taking place during the Year of St Francis. The friars cannot do their work without the financial and spiritual aid of the laity, as they take a strict vow of poverty. Your help is greatly appreciated. Donations can be left in Galliagh Chapel or any of the Parish Offices.

'EMBRACE THE GRACE'

Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026 - a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. Saturday 30 August from 9.30am to 6pm with a social afterwards. Tickets €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Further queries contact: deusetpatria@gmail.com

THE NATIONAL NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF KNOCK

Takes place at Knock Shrine from Thursday 13 to Friday 21 August 2026. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3pm and 8pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days. This year's theme is "Sheltered in God's Love." Everyone is very welcome.

See the full programme at: <https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/>

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND

Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

ENCOUNTER SCHOOL OF MINISTRY COURSE

Launching in All Saints Church, Newtowncunningham, Co Donegal in September. This course draws from the richness of our Catholic heritage as we seek to teach, equip, and activate disciples to demonstrate the love of God through the power of the Holy Spirit in their spheres of influence. For further information about this course, or to book a place, please email donegal@encounterschool.org. or www.encounterschool.org

VOCATIONS

For our seminarians and the men considering priesthood that, in moments of doubt, they'll hear Jesus say what He says to the disciples in today's gospel, "Courage! It is I. Do not be afraid!"

PRIVACY NOTICE

Is available on the parish website: threepatrons.org

SAFEGUARDING

If you have any concerns about the Safeguarding of Children or vulnerable adults within the Church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596500793 or at dlp@derrydiocese.org

PARISH GROUPS & MEETINGS (SUMMER)

Monday	After 11am Mass 1pm – 2.30pm 7pm - 9pm	Holy Souls Prayer Group Legion of Mary Woman's Craft Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh Meeting Room, St Joseph's Church, Galliagh Kildare Room, Carnhill
Tuesday	After 11am Mass 11.30am - 2.30pm 7.30pm - 9.30pm	Devotion to the Holy Face St. Pio's Café Living Disciples Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh St Pio Centre, Galliagh St Pio Centre, Galliagh
Thursday	11.30am - 2.30pm 6pm – 7pm 7pm – 8pm 7.30pm - 8.30pm 8.15pm – 10pm	St. Pio's Café Divine Will Prayer Group Holy Hour for the Unborn Youth Prayer Group Be Still – Men's Prayer Group	St. Pio Centre, Galliagh Kildare Room, Carnhill Our Lady's Chapel St. Pio Centre, Galliagh Our Lady's Chapel
Friday	11.30am-12.30pm	Divine Mercy Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh

PARISH SCHEDULE - SUMMER**ST PATRICK'S CHURCH, PENNYBURN**

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 6.15pm; 9.45am
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 10am
Confessions:	Saturday: 5.15pm – 6pm
Baptisms:	Saturday: 4.30pm; Sunday: 1.30pm

ST BRIGID'S CHURCH, CARNHILL

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 5pm; 10.30am & 12.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 9.30am; Saturday: 11am
Confessions:	Saturday after 11.00am Mass and 4pm - 4.45pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Daily: 8.00am – 8.00pm in St Carlo Acutis Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm

ST JOSEPH'S CHURCH, GALLIAGH

Sunday Mass:	11.00am; 12.30pm (<i>An tAifreann Naofa</i>); 6.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 11am
Confessions:	Sunday: 5.30pm – 6.15pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Tuesday: 11.30am – 1pm in Our Lady's Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm

Missing & Online-Only Bulletins

Generated 09/08/2026

The following parishes do not have a downloadable PDF bulletin. Click a link to view the bulletin online.

Claudy: <http://parishofclaudy.com/onewebmedia/NEWSLETTER 9-8-26.docx>

Coleraine (St John): <https://www.parishofstjohncoleraine.com/>

Desertmartin: https://www.desertmartinparish.com/?page_id=6

Greencastle: <https://greencastleparish.com/>

Limavady: <https://www.limavadyparish.org/onewebmedia/9-8-26.pdf>

Long Tower: <https://longtowerchurch.org/>

Malin: <https://malinparish.ie/wp-content/uploads/2026/08/Bulletin-9th-August-2026.pdf>

Star of the Sea (Magilligan):

<https://drive.usercontent.google.com/download?id=1cF4BuBrZCRrSwMQeTT8mJrGNpr5aFGpD&export=download>

Urney and Castlefin: http://urneyandcastlefinparish.com/?page_id=1227

Waterside (& Strathfoyle amalgamated): <https://watersideparish.net/parish-bulletin/>